

THE SHEP:
HEARD'S
CALENDER:

TWELVE AEGLØGUES
PRÒPORTIONABLE TO
THE TWELVE MØNETHES
ENTITLED TO THE NØBLE
AND VERTUOUS GENT:
LEMAN MOST WORTHY
ØF ALL TITLES BØTH ØF
LEARNING & CHIVALRY,
MÅISTER PHILIP SIDNEY.



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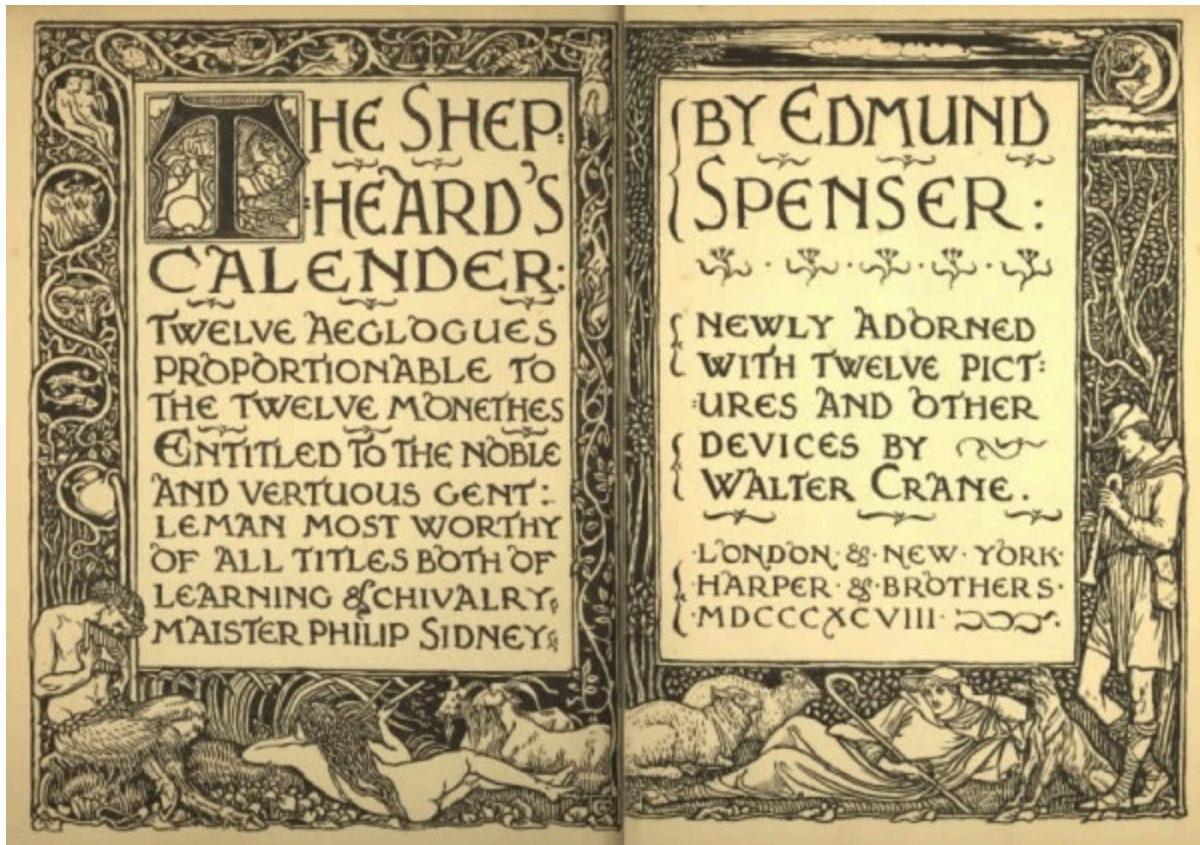
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PROPORTIONABLE TO THE TWELVE MONETHES ***



THE SHEPHEARD'S CALENDER:

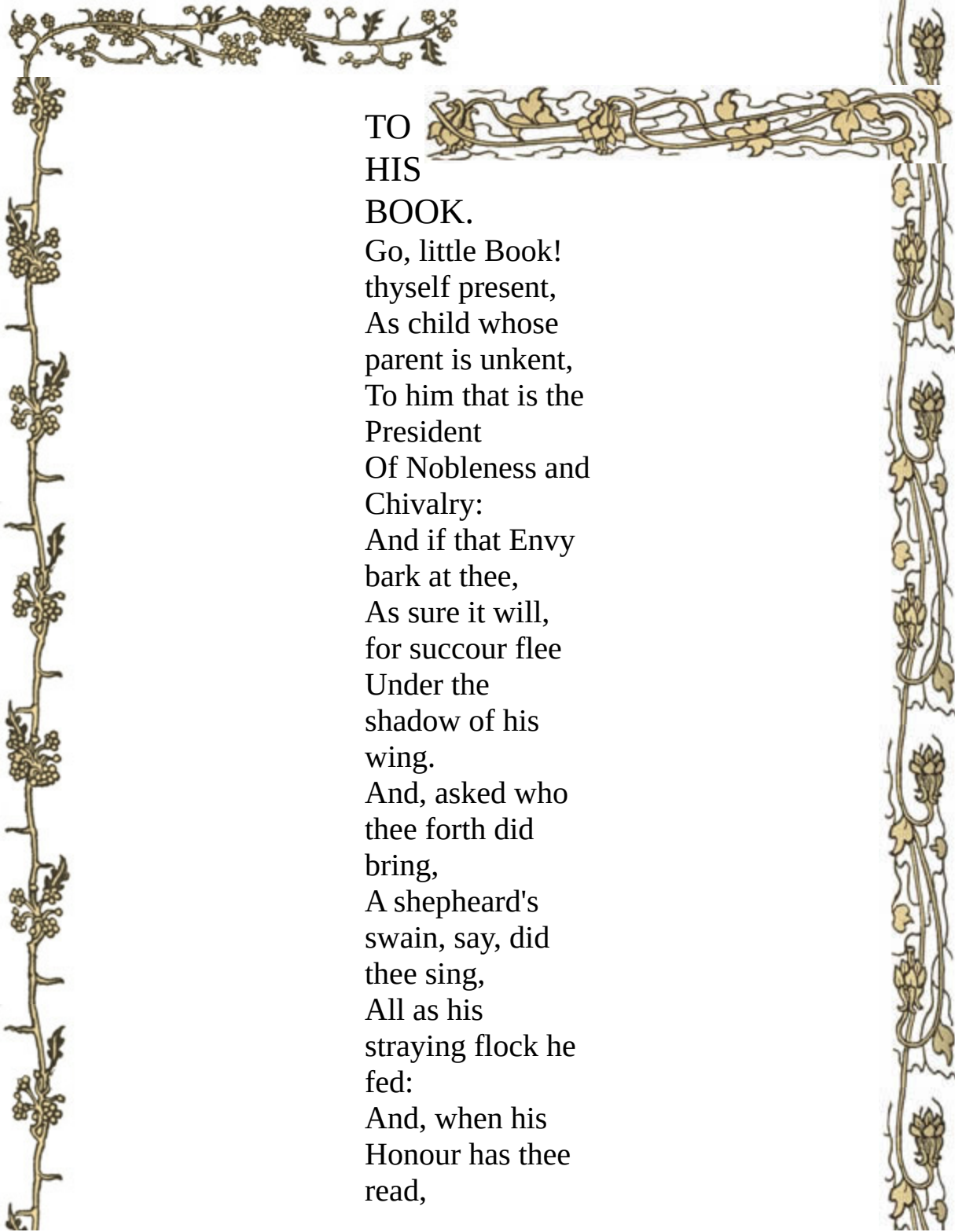
TWELVE AEGLOGUES PROPORTIONABLE TO THE TWELVE
MONETHES

ENTITLED TO THE NOBLE AND VERTUOUS GENTLEMAN MOST
WORTHY OF ALL TITLES BOTH OF LEARNING & CHIVALRY,
MAISTER PHILIP SIDNEY.

BY EDMUND SPENSER:
NEWLY ADORNED

WITH TWELVE PICTURES AND OTHER DEVICES
BY
WALTER CRANE.

LONDON & NEW YORK
HARPER & BROTHERS
MDCCCXCVIII



TO
HIS
BOOK.

Go, little Book!
thyself present,
As child whose
parent is unkent,
To him that is the
President
Of Nobleness and
Chivalry:
And if that Envy
bark at thee,
As sure it will,
for succour flee
Under the
shadow of his
wing.
And, asked who
thee forth did
bring,
A shepherd's
swain, say, did
thee sing,
All as his
straying flock he
fed:
And, when his
Honour has thee
read,



Crave pardon for
thy hardyhed.
But, if that any
ask thy name,
Say, thou wert
base-begot with
blame;
Forthy thereof
thou takest
shame.
And, when thou
art past jeopardy,
Come tell me
what was said of
me,
And I will send
more after thee.

MMERITO.

I

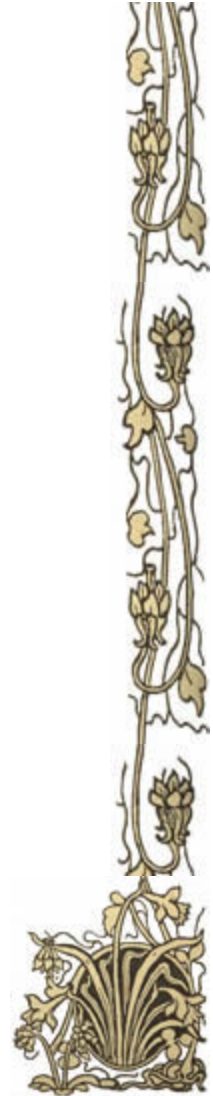
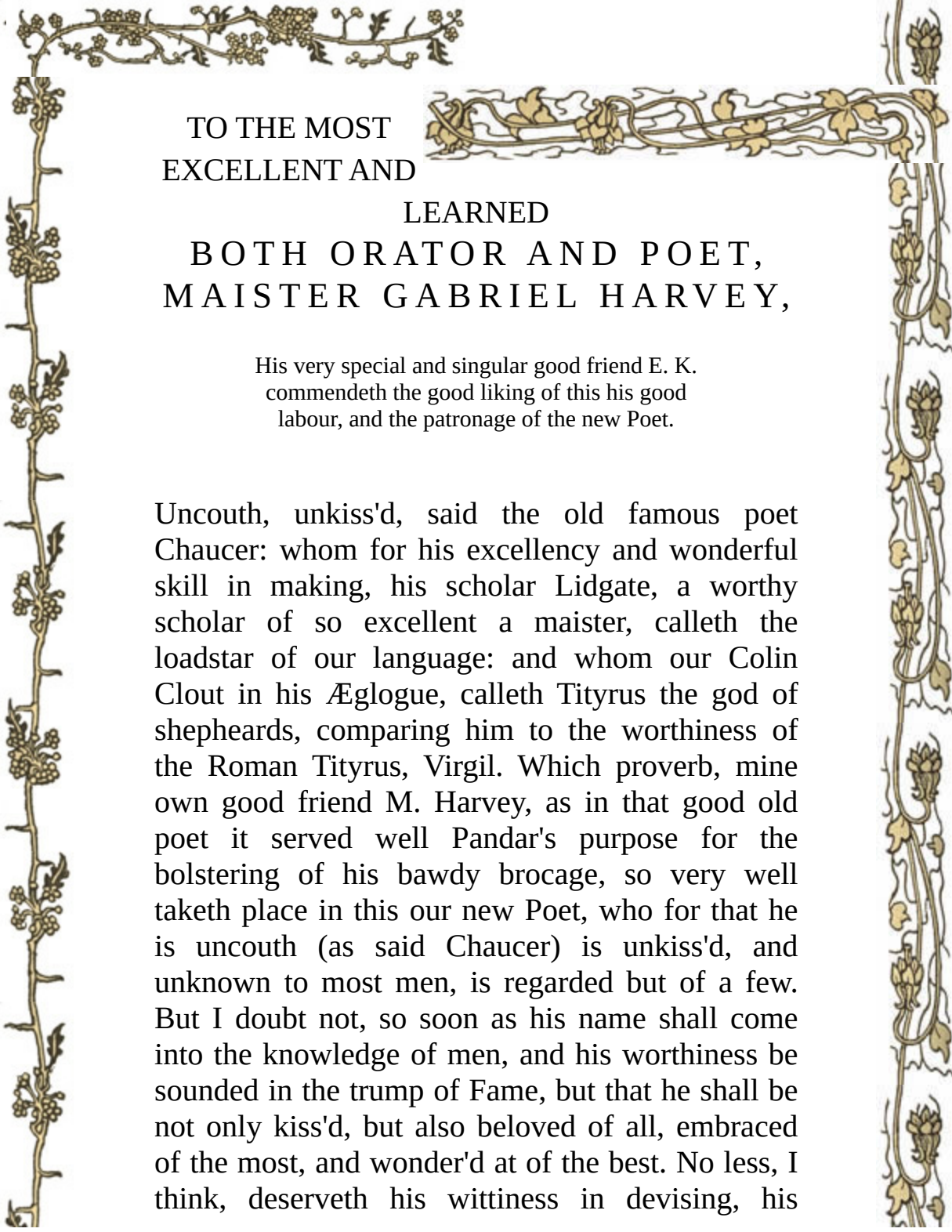


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TO THE MOST
EXCELLENT AND

LEARNED
BOTH ORATOR AND POET,
MAISTER GABRIEL HARVEY,

His very special and singular good friend E. K.
commendeth the good liking of this his good
labour, and the patronage of the new Poet.

Uncouth, unkiss'd, said the old famous poet
Chaucer: whom for his excellency and wonderful
skill in making, his scholar Lidgate, a worthy
scholar of so excellent a maister, calleth the
loadstar of our language: and whom our Colin
Clout in his Æglogue, calleth Tityrus the god of
shepheards, comparing him to the worthiness of
the Roman Tityrus, Virgil. Which proverb, mine
own good friend M. Harvey, as in that good old
poet it served well Pandar's purpose for the
bolstering of his bawdy brocage, so very well
taketh place in this our new Poet, who for that he
is uncouth (as said Chaucer) is unkiss'd, and
unknown to most men, is regarded but of a few.
But I doubt not, so soon as his name shall come
into the knowledge of men, and his worthiness be
sounded in the trump of Fame, but that he shall be
not only kiss'd, but also beloved of all, embraced
of the most, and wonder'd at of the best. No less, I
think, deserveth his wittiness in devising, his

pithiness in uttering, his complaints of love so lovely, his discourses of pleasure so pleasantly, his pastoral rudeness, his moral wiseness, his due observing of decorum every where, in personages, in seasons, in matter, in speech; and generally, in all seemly simplicity of handling his matters, and framing his words: the which of many things which in him be strange, I know will seem the strangest, and words themselves being so ancient, the knitting of them so short and intricate, and the whole period and compass of speech so delightsome for the roundness, and so grave for the strangeness. And first of the words to speak, I grant they be something hard, and of most men unused, yet both English, and also used of most excellent authors, and most famous poets. In whom, when as this our Poet hath been much travailed and thoroughly read, how could it be, (as that worthy orator said) but that walking in the sun, although for other cause he walked, yet needs he must be sunburnt; and, having the sound of those ancient poets still ringing in his ears, he must needs, in singing, hit out some of their tunes. But whether he useth them by such casualty and custom, or of set purpose and choice, as thinking them fittest for such rustical rudeness of shepherds, either for that their rough sound would make his rhymes more ragged and rustical; or else because such old and obsolete words are most used of country folk, sure I think, and think I think not amiss, that they bring great grace, and, as one would say, authority to the verse. For albe, amongst many other faults, it specially be objected of Valla against Livy, and of other against Sallust, that with over much study they affect antiquity, as covering thereby credence and honour of elder years; yet I am of opinion, and eke the best learned



are of the like, that those ancient solemn words are a great ornament, both in the one, and in the other: the one labouring to set forth in his work an eternal image of antiquity, and the other carefully discoursing matters of gravity and importance. For, if my memory fail not, Tully in that book, wherein he endeavoureth to set forth the pattern of a perfect orator, saith that oftentimes an ancient word maketh the style seem grave, and as it were reverend, no otherwise than we honour and reverence gray hairs for a certain religious regard, which we have of old age. Yet neither every where must old words be stuffed in, nor the common dialect and manner of speaking so corrupted thereby, that, as in old buildings, it seem disorderly and ruinous. But all as in most exquisite pictures they use to blaze and pourtray not only the dainty lineaments of beauty, but also round about it to shadow the rude thickets and craggy cliffs, that, by the baseness of such parts, more excellency may accrue to the principal: for oftentimes we find ourselves, I know not how, singularly delighted with the shew of such natural rudeness, and take great pleasure in that disorderly order. Even so do those rough and harsh terms enlumine, and make more clearly to appear, the brightness of brave and glorious words. So oftentimes a discord in music maketh a comely concordance: so great delight took the worthy poet Alceus to behold a blemish in the joint of a well-shaped body. But, if any will rashly blame such his purpose in choice of old and unwonted words, him may I more justly blame and condemn, or of witless headiness in judging, or of heedless hardiness in condemning: for, not marking the compass of his bent, he will judge of the length of his cast: for in my opinion it is one especial praise of many, which are due to this Poet, that he hath





laboured to restore, as to their rightful heritage, such good and natural English words, as have been long time out of use, and almost clean disherited. Which is the only cause, that our mother tongue, which truly of itself is both full enough for prose, and stately enough for verse, hath long time been counted most bare and barren of both. Which default when as some endeavoured to salve and recure, they patched up the holes with pieces and rags of other languages, borrowing here of the French, there of the Italian, every where of the Latin; not weighing how ill those tongues accord with themselves, but much worse with ours: So now they have made our English tongue a gallimaufrey, or hodgepodge of all other speeches. Other some not so well seen in the English tongue, as perhaps in other languages, if they happen to hear an old word, albeit very natural and significant, cry out straightway, that we speak no English, but gibberish, or rather such as in old time Evander's mother spake: whose first shame is, that they are not ashamed, in their own mother tongue, to be counted strangers and aliens. The second shame no less than the first, that what so they understand not, they straightway deem to be senseless, and not at all to be understood. Much like to the mole in Æsop's fable, that, being blind herself, would in no wise be persuaded that any beast could see. The last, more shameful than both, that of their own country and natural speech, which together with their nurse's milk they sucked, they have so base regard and bastard judgment, that they will not only themselves not labour to garnish and beautify it, but also repine, that of other it should be embellished. Like to the dog in the manger, that himself can eat no hay, and yet barketh at the hungry bullock, that so fain would



feed: whose currish kind, though it cannot be kept from barking, yet I conne them thank that they refrain from biting.

Now, for the knitting of sentences, which they call the joints and members thereof, and for all the compass of the speech, it is round without roughness, and learned without hardness, such indeed as may be perceived of the least, understood of the most, but judged only of the learned. For what in most English writers useth to be loose, and as it were unright, in this Author is well grounded, finely framed, and strongly trussed up together. In regard whereof, I scorn and spue out the rakehelly rout of our ragged rhymers (for so themselves use to hunt the letter) which without learning boast, without judgment jangle, without reason rage and foam, as if some instinct of poetical spirit had newly ravished them above the meanness of common capacity. And being, in the midst of all their bravery, suddenly, either for want of matter, or rhyme; or having forgotten their former conceit; they seem to be so pained and travailed in their remembrance, as it were a woman in childbirth, or as that same Pythia, when the trance came upon her. "*Os rabidum fera corda domans*," etc.

Nathless, let them a God's name feed on their own folly, so they seek not to darken the beams of others' glory. As for Colin, under whose person the Author's self is shadowed, how far he is from such vaunted titles and glorious shews, both himself sheweth, where he saith:

"Of Muses, Hobbins, I conne
no skill."





And,

"Enough is me to paint out
my unrest," etc.

And also appeareth by the baseness of the name, wherein it seemeth he chose rather to unfold great matter of argument covertly than, professing it, not suffice thereto accordingly. Which moved him rather in *Æglogues* than otherwise to write, doubting perhaps his ability, which he little needed, or minding to furnish our tongue with this kind, wherein it faulteth; or following the example of the best and most ancient poets, which devised this kind of writing, being both so base for the matter, and homely for the manner, at the first to try their abilities; and as young birds, that be newly crept out of the nest, by little first prove their tender wings, before they make a greater flight. So flew Theocritus, as you may perceive he was already full fledged. So flew Virgil, as not yet well feeling his wings. So flew Mantuane, as not being full somm'd. So Petrarch. So Boccace. So Marot, Sanazarius, and also divers other excellent both Italian and French poets, whose footing this author every where followeth: yet so as few, but they be well scented, can trace him out. So finally flieth this our new Poet as a bird whose principals be scarce grown out, but yet as one that in time shall be able to keep wing with the best. Now, as touching the general drift and purpose of his *Æglogues*, I mind not to say much, himself labouring to conceal it. Only this appeareth, that his unstayed youth had long wander'd in the common labyrinth of love, in which time to mitigate and allay the heat of his passion, or else to





warn (as he saith) the young shepherds, his equals and companions, of his unfortunate folly, he compiled these twelve *Æglogues*, which, for that they be proportioned to the state of the twelve monethes, he termeth it the *Shepherd's Calender*, applying an old name to a new work. Hereunto have I added a certain gloss, or scholion, for the exposition of old words and harder phrases; which manner of glossing and commenting, well I wot, will seem strange and rare in our tongue: yet, for so much as I knew many excellent and proper devices, both in words and matter, would pass in the speedy course of reading either as unknown, or as not marked; and that in this kind, as in other, we might be equal to the learned of other nations; I thought good to take the pains upon me, the rather for that by means of some familiar acquaintance I was made privy to his counsel and secret meaning in them, as also in sundry other works of his. Which albeit I know he nothing so much hateth, as to promulgate, yet thus much have I adventured upon his friendship, himself being for long time far estranged; hoping that this will the rather occasion him to put forth divers other excellent works of his, which sleep in silence; as his *Dreams*, his *Legends*, his *Court of Cupid*, and sundry others, whose commendation to set out were very vain, the things though worthy of many, yet being known to few. These my present pains, if to any they be pleasurable or profitable, be you judge, mine own Maister Harvey, to whom I have both in respect of your worthiness generally, and otherwise upon some particular and special considerations, vowed this my labour, and the maidenhead of this our common friend's poetry; himself having already in the beginning dedicated it to the noble and worthy gentleman, the right





worshipful Maister Philip Sidney, a special
favourer and maintainer of all kind of learning.
Whose cause, I pray you, sir, if envy shall stir up
any wrongful accusation, defend with your mighty
rhetoric and other your rathe gifts of learning, as
you can, and shield with your good will, as you
ought, against the malice and outrage of so many
enemies, as I know will be set on fire with the
sparks of his kindled glory. And thus
recommending the Author unto you, as unto his
most special good friend, and myself unto you
both, as one making singular account of two so
very good and so choice friends, I bid you both
most heartily farewell, and commit you and your
commendable studies to the tuition of the Greatest.

Your own assuredly to be commanded,

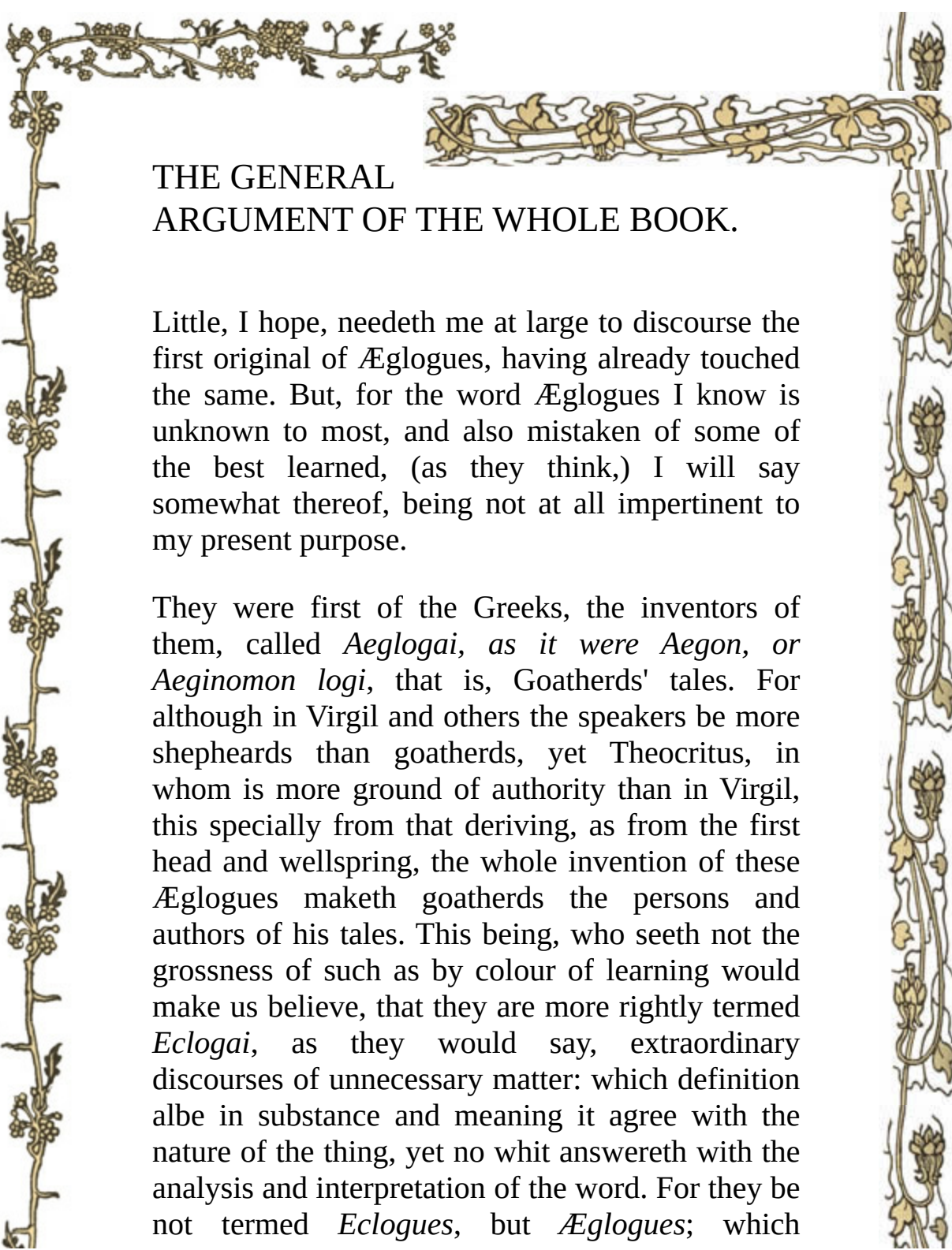
E. K. ¹

P.S.—Now I trust, M. Harvey, that upon sight of
your special friend's and fellow poet's doings, or
else for envy of so many unworthy Quidams,
which catch at the garland which to you alone is
due, you will be persuaded to pluck out of the
hateful darkness those so many excellent English
poems of yours which lie hid, and bring them forth
to eternal light. Trust me, you do both them great
wrong, in depriving them of the desired sun; and
also yourself, in smothering your deserved praises;
and all men generally, in withholding from them so
divine pleasures, which they might conceive of
your gallant English verses, as they have already
done of your Latin poems, which, in my opinion,
both for invention and elocution are very delicate
and super-excellent. And thus again I take my



leave of my good M. Harvey. From my lodging at
London this tenth of April 1579.





THE GENERAL ARGUMENT OF THE WHOLE BOOK.

Little, I hope, needeth me at large to discourse the first original of Æglogues, having already touched the same. But, for the word Æglogues I know is unknown to most, and also mistaken of some of the best learned, (as they think,) I will say somewhat thereof, being not at all impertinent to my present purpose.

They were first of the Greeks, the inventors of them, called *Aeglogai*, as it were *Aegon*, or *Aeginomon logi*, that is, Goatherds' tales. For although in Virgil and others the speakers be more shepherds than goatherds, yet Theocritus, in whom is more ground of authority than in Virgil, this specially from that deriving, as from the first head and wellspring, the whole invention of these Æglogues maketh goatherds the persons and authors of his tales. This being, who seeth not the grossness of such as by colour of learning would make us believe, that they are more rightly termed *Eclogai*, as they would say, extraordinary discourses of unnecessary matter: which definition albe in substance and meaning it agree with the nature of the thing, yet no whit answereth with the analysis and interpretation of the word. For they be not termed *Eclogues*, but *Æglogues*; which



sentence this Author very well observing, upon good judgment, though indeed few goatherds have to do herein, nevertheless doubteth not to call them by the used and best known name. Other curious discourses hereof I reserve to greater occasion.

These twelve Æglogues, every where answering to the seasons of the twelve monethes, may be well divided into three forms or ranks. For either they be plaintive, as the first, the sixth, the eleventh, and the twelfth; or recreative, such as all those be, which contain matter of love, or commendation of special personages; or moral, which for the most part be mixed with some satyirical bitterness; namely, the second, of reverence due to old age; the fifth, of coloured deceit; the seventh and ninth, of dissolute shepherds and pastors; the tenth, of contempt of Poetry and pleasant Wits. And to this division may every thing herein be reasonably applied; a few only except, whose special purpose and meaning I am not privy to. And thus much generally of these twelve Æglogues. Now will we speak particularly of all, and first of the first, which he calleth by the first moneth's name, Januarie: wherein to some he may seem foully to have faulted, in that he erroneously beginneth with that moneth, which beginneth not the year. For it is well known, and stoutly maintained with strong reasons of the learned, that the year beginneth in March; for then the sun reneweth his finished course, and the seasonable spring refresheth the earth, and the pleasance thereof, being buried in the sadness of the dead winter now worn away, reliveth.

This opinion maintain the old Astrologers and Philosophers, namely, the reverend Andalo, and





Macrobius in his *Holy Days of Saturn*; which account also was generally observed both of Grecians and Romans. But, saving the leave of such learned heads, we maintain a custom of counting the seasons from the moneth Januarie, upon a more special cause than the heathen Philosophers ever could conceive, that is, for the Incarnation of our mighty Saviour, and Eternal Redeemer the Lord Christ, who as then renewing the state of the decayed world, and returning the compass of expired years to their former date and first commencement, left to us his heirs a memorial of his birth in the end of the last year and beginning of the next. Which reckoning, beside that eternal monument of our salvation, leaneth also upon good proof of special judgment.

For albeit that in elder times, when as yet the count of the year was not perfected, as afterward it was by Julius Cæsar, they began to tell the monethes from March's beginning, and according to the same, God (as is said in Scripture) commanded the people of the Jews, to count the moneth *Abib*, that which we call March, for the first moneth, in remembrance that in that moneth he brought them out of the land of Egypt: yet, according to tradition of latter times it hath been otherwise observed, both in government of the Church and rule of mightiest realms. For from Julius Cæsar who first observed the leap year, which he called *Bissextilem Annum*, and brought into a more certain course the odd wand'ring days which of the Greeks were called *Hyperbainontes*, of the Romans *Intercalares*, (for in such matter of learning I am forced to use the terms of the learned,) the monethes have been numbered twelve, which in the first ordinance of Romulus were but ten,



counting but 304 days in every year, and beginning with March. But Numa Pompilius, who was the father of all the Roman ceremonies and religion, seeing that reckoning to agree neither with the course of the sun nor the moon, thereunto added two monethes, Januarie and Februarie; wherein it seemeth, that wise king minded upon good reason to begin the year at Januarie, of him therefore so called *tanquam janua anni*, the gate and entrance of the year; or of the name of the god *Janus*, to which god for that the old Paynims attributed the birth and beginning of all creatures new coming into the world, it seemeth that he *therefore* to him assigned the beginning and first entrance of the year. Which account for the most part hath hitherto continued: notwithstanding that the Egyptians begin their year at September; for that, according to the opinion of the best Rabbins and very purpose of the Scripture itself, God made the world in that moneth, that is called of them *Tisri*. And therefore he commanded them to keep the feast of Pavilions in the end of the year, in the xv. day of the seventh moneth, which before that time was the first.

But our author, respecting neither the subtilty of the one part, nor the antiquity of the other, thinketh it fittest, according to the simplicity of common understanding, to begin with Januarie; weening it perhaps no *decorum* that shepherds should be seen in matter of so deep insight, or canvass a case of so doubtful judgment. So therefore beginneth he, and so continueth he throughout.

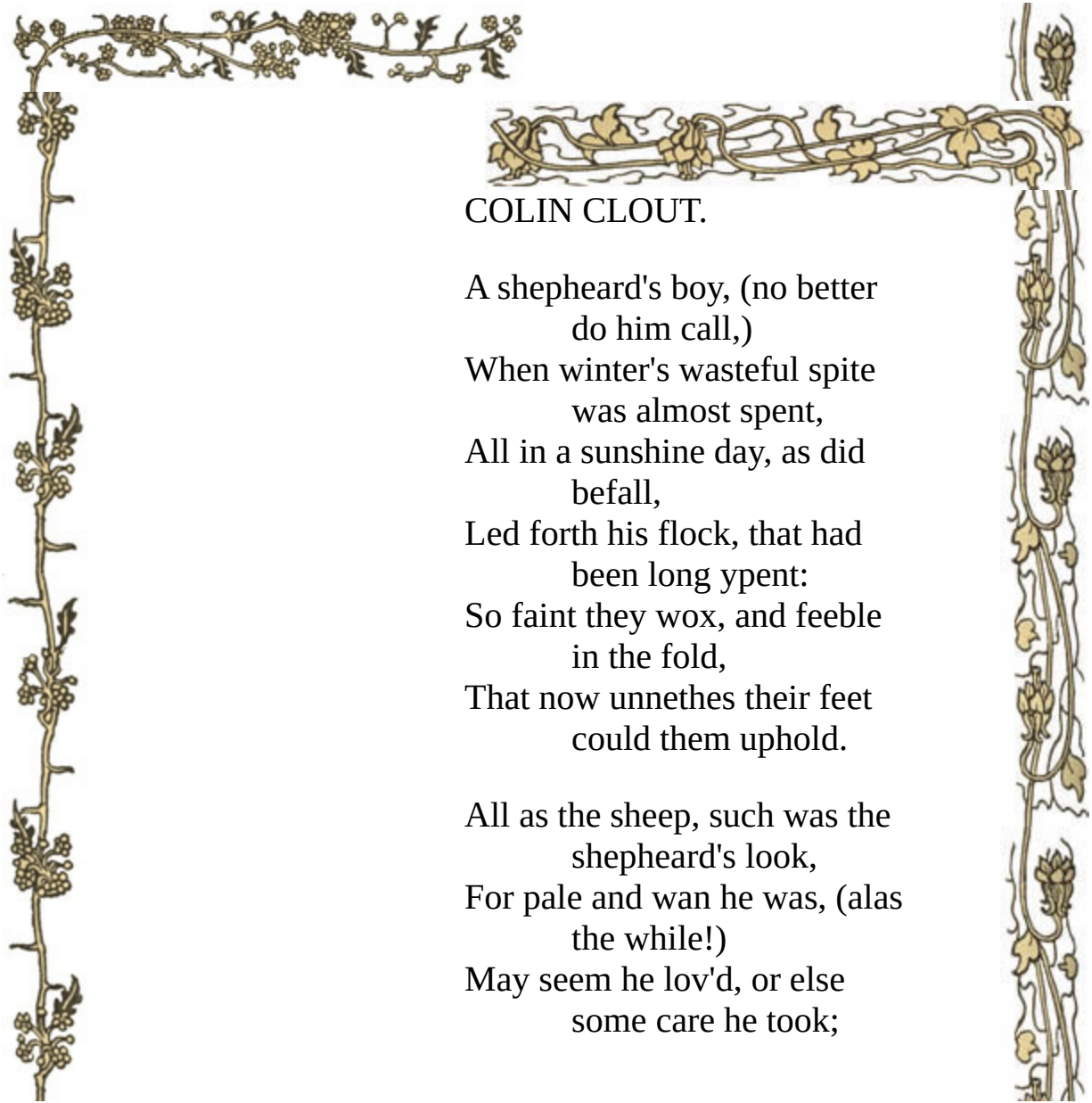


JANUARIE • AEGLOGA PRIMA



JANUARIE. ÆGLOGA PRIMA. ARGUMENT.

In this first Æglogue Colin Clout, a shepherd's boy, complaineth himself of his unfortunate love, being but newly (as seemeth) enamoured of a country lass called Rosalind: with which strong affection being very sore travailed, he compareth his careful case to the sad season of the year, to the frosty ground, to the frozen trees, and to his own winter-beaten flock. And lastly, finding himself robbed of all former pleasance and delight, he breaketh his pipe in pieces, and casteth himself to the ground.



COLIN CLOUT.

A shepherd's boy, (no better
do him call,)
When winter's wasteful spite
was almost spent,
All in a sunshine day, as did
befall,
Led forth his flock, that had
been long ypent:
So faint they wox, and feeble
in the fold,
That now unnethes their feet
could them uphold.

All as the sheep, such was the
shepherd's look,
For pale and wan he was, (alas
the while!)
May seem he lov'd, or else
some care he took;



Well couth he tune his pipe
and frame his style:
Then to a hill his fainting flock
he led,
And thus him plain'd, the
while his sheep there
fed:

"Ye gods of love! that pity
lovers' pain,
(If any gods the pain of lovers
pity,)
Look from above, where you
in joys remain,
And bow your ears unto my
doleful ditty.
And, Pan! thou shepherds'
god, that once didst
love,
Pity the pains that thou thyself
didst prove.

"Thou barren ground, whom
winter's wrath hath
wasted,
Art made a mirror to behold
my plight:
Whilome thy fresh spring
flower'd, and after
hasted
Thy summer proud, with
daffodillies dight;
And now is come thy winter's
stormy state,
Thy mantle marr'd wherein
thou maskedst late.





"Such rage as winter's reigneth
in my heart,
My life-blood freezing with
unkindly cold;
Such stormy stoures do breed
my baleful smart,
As if my year were waste and
waxen old;
And yet, alas! but now my
spring begun,
And yet, alas! it is already
done.

"You naked trees, whose shady
leaves are lost,
Wherein the birds were wont
to build their bower,
And now are cloth'd with moss
and hoary frost,
Instead of blossoms,
wherewith your buds
did flower;
I see your tears that from your
boughs do rain,
Whose drops in dreary icicles
remain.

"All so my lustful leaf is dry
and sere,
My timely buds with wailing
all are wasted;
The blossom which my branch
of youth did bear,
With breathed sighs is blown
away and blasted;
And from mine eyes the
drizzling tears descend,





As on your boughs the icicles
depend.

"Thou feeble flock! whose
fleece is rough and
rent,
Whose knees are weak through
fast and evil fare,
Mayst witness well, by thy ill
government,
Thy master's mind is overcome
with care:
Thou weak, I wan; thou lean, I
quite forlorn:
With mourning pine I; you
with pining mourn.

"A thousand siths I curse that
careful hour
Wherein I long'd the neighbour
town to see,
And eke ten thousand siths I
bless the stoure
Wherein I saw so fair a sight
as she:
Yet all for naught: such sight
hath bred my bane.
Ah, God! that love should
breed both joy and
pain!

"It is not Hobbinol ² wherefore
I plain,
Albe my love he seek with
daily suit;
His clownish gifts and
court'sies I disdain,





His kids, his cracknels, and his
early fruit.
Ah, foolish Hobbinol! thy gifts
be vain;
Colin them gives to Rosalind
again.

"I love thilk lass, (alas! why do
I love?)
And am forlorn, (alas! why am
I lorn?)
She deigns not my good will,
but doth reprove,
And of my rural music holdeth
scorn.
Shepherd's device she hateth
as the snake,
And laughs the songs that
Colin Clout doth make.

"Wherefore, my pipe, albe
rude Pan thou please,
Yet for thou pleasest not where
most I would;
And thou, unlucky Muse, that
wont'st to ease
My musing mind, yet canst not
when thou should;
Both Pipe and Muse shall sore
the while abyе."
So broke his oaten pipe, and
down did lie.

By that, the welked Phœbus
gan availe
His weary wain; and now the
frosty Night

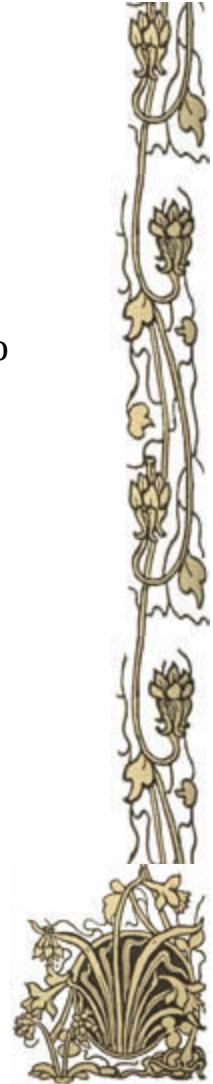


Her mantle black through
 heaven gan overhale:
Which seen, the pensive boy,
 half in despite,
Arose, and homeward drove
 his sunned sheep,
Whose hanging heads did
 seem his careful case to
 weep.

COLIN'S EMBLEME.

Anchora speme.

(Hope is my anchor.)

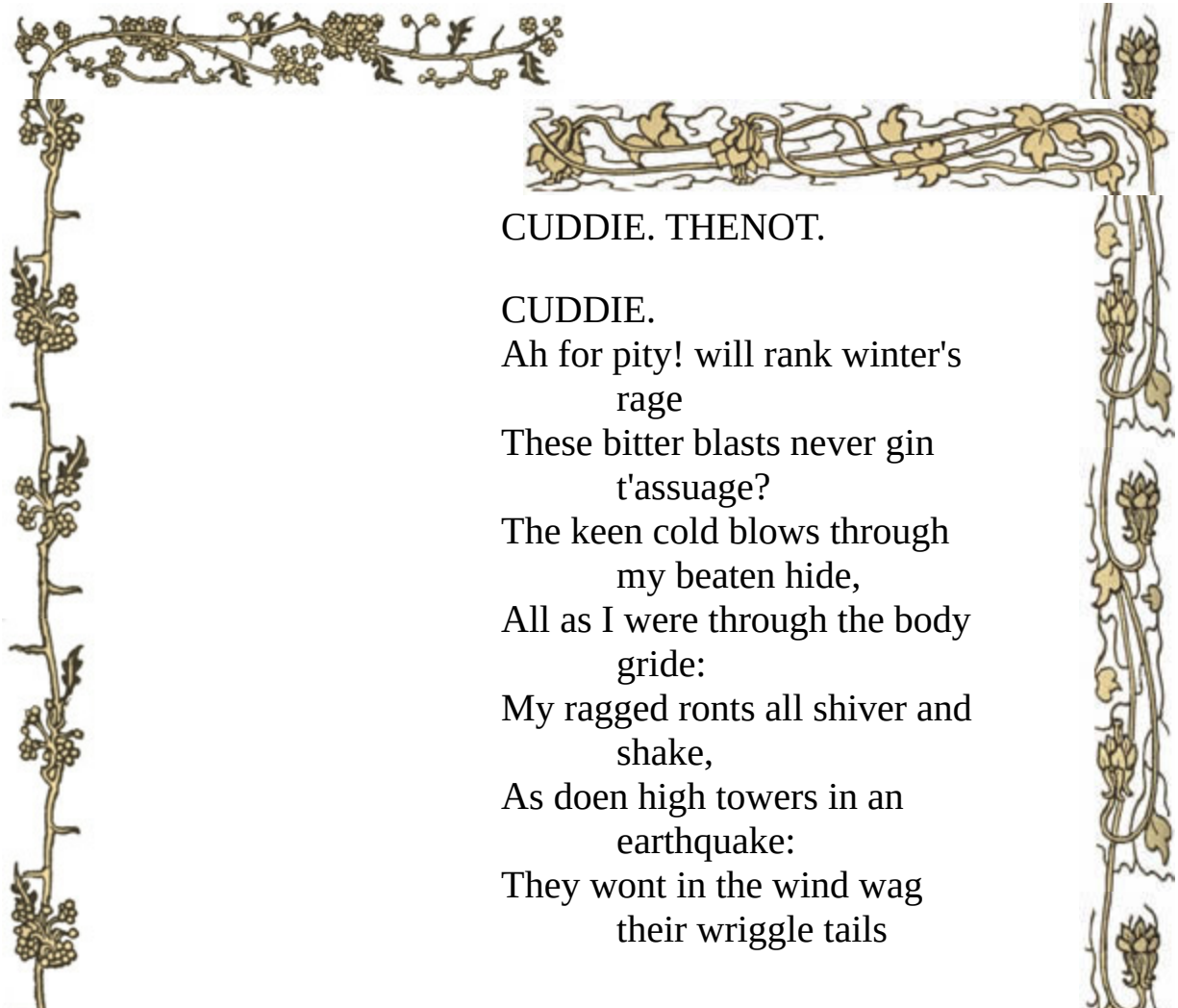


FEBRUARIE • AEGLOGA SECUNDA



FEBRUARIE. ÆGLOGA SECUNDA. ARGUMENT.

This Æglogue is rather moral and general than bent to any secret or particular purpose. It specially containeth a discourse of old age, in the person of Thenot, an old shepheard, who, for his crookedness and unlustiness, is scorned of Cuddie, an unhappy herdman's boy. The matter very well accordeth with the season of the moneth, the year now drooping, and as it were drawing to his last age. For as in this time of year, so then in our bodies, there is a dry and withering cold, which congealeth the curdled blood, and freezeth the weather-beaten flesh, with storms of Fortune and hoar-frosts of Care. To which purpose the old man telleth a tale of the Oak and the Brier, so lively, and so feelingly, as, if the thing were set forth in some picture before our eyes, more plainly could not appear.



CUDDIE. THENOT.

CUDDIE.

Ah for pity! will rank winter's
rage
These bitter blasts never gin
t'assuage?
The keen cold blows through
my beaten hide,
All as I were through the body
gride:
My ragged ronts all shiver and
shake,
As doen high towers in an
earthquake:
They wont in the wind wag
their wriggle tails



Perk as a peacock; but now it
availes.
THE. Lewdly complainest,
thou lazy lad,
Of winter's wrack for making
thee sad.
Must not the world wend in his
common course,
From good to bad, and from
bad to worse,
From worse unto that is worst
of all,
And then return to his former
fall?
Who will not suffer the stormy
time,
Where will he live till the lusty
prime?
Self have I worn out thrice
thirty years,
Some in much joy, many in
many tears,
Yet never complained of cold
nor heat,
Of summer's flame, nor of
winter's threat,
Ne ever was to Fortune
foeman,
But gently took that ungently
came;
And ever my flock was my
chief care;
Winter or summer they might
well fare.
CUD. No marvel, Thenot, if
thou can bear





Cheerfully the winter's
 wrathful cheer;
For age and winter accord full
 nigh,
This chill, that cold; this
 crooked, that wry;
And as the louring weather
 looks down,
So seemest thou like Good
 Friday ³ to frown:
But my flow'ring youth is foe
 to frost,
My ship unwont in storms to
 be tost.
THE. The sovereign of seas he
 blames in vain,
That, once sea-beat, will to sea
 again:
So loit'ring live you little
 herdgrooms,
Keeping your beasts in the
 budded brooms;
And, when the shining sun
 laugheth once,
You deemen, the spring is
 come at once;
Then gin you, fond flies! the
 cold to scorn,
And, crowing in pipes made of
 green corn,
You thinken to be lords of the
 year;
But eft, when ye count you
 freed from fear,
Comes the breme Winter with
 chamfred brows,



Full of wrinkles and frosty
furrows,
Drearly shooting his stormy
dart,
Which curdles the blood and
pricks the heart:
Then is your careless courage
accoyed,
Your careful herds with cold
be annoyed:
Then pay you the price of your
surquedry,
With weeping, and wailing,
and misery.
CUD. Ah! foolish old man! I
scorn thy skill,
That wouldst me my springing
youth to spill:
I deem thy brain emperished
be
Through rusty eld, that hath
rotted thee;
Or sicker thy head very totty
is,
So on thy corb shoulder it
leans amiss.
Now thyself hath lost both lop
and top,
Als my budding branch thou
wouldest crop;
But were thy years green, as
now be mine,
To other delights they would
incline:
Then wouldest thou learn to
carol of love,



And hery with hymns thy
 lass's glove;
Then wouldest thou pipe of
 Phillis' praise;
But Phillis is mine for many
 days;
I won her with a girdle of gelt,
Embossed with bugle about the
 belt:
Such an one shepherds would
 make full fain;
Such an one would make thee
 young again.
THE. Thou art a fon, of thy
 love to boast;
All that is lent to love will be
 lost.
CUD. Seest how brag yond
 bullock bears,
So smirk, so smooth, his
 pricked ears?
His horns be as broad as
 rainbow bent,
His dewlap as lithe as lass of
 Kent:
See how he venteth into the
 wind;
Weenest of love is not his
 mind?
Seemeth thy flock thy counsel
 can,
So lustless be they, so weak, so
 wan;
Clothed with cold, and hoary
 with frost,
Thy flock's father his courage
 hath lost.





Thy ewes, that wont to have
blowen bags,
Like wailful widows hangen
their crags;
The rather lambs be starved
with cold,
All for their master is lustless
and old.
THE. Cuddie, I wot thou kenst
little good,
So vainly to advance thy
heedlesshood;
For youth is a bubble blown up
with breath,
Whose wit is weakness, whose
wage is death,
Whose way is wilderness,
whose inn penance,
And stoop-gallant Age, the
host of Grievance.
But shall I tell thee a tale of
truth,
Which I cond of Tityrus in my
youth,
Keeping his sheep on the hills
of Kent?
CUD. To nought more, Thenot,
my mind is bent
Than to hear novels of his
devise;
They be so well thewed, and
so wise,
Whatever that good old man
bespake.
THE. Many meet tales of
youth did he make,





And some of love, and some of
chivalry;
But none fitter than this to
apply.

Now listen a while and
hearken the end.

"There grew an aged tree on
the green,
A goodly Oak sometime had it
been,

With arms full strong and
largely display'd,
But of their leaves they were
disarray'd:

The body big, and mightily
pight,

Thoroughly rooted, and of
wondrous height;

Whilome had been the king of
the field,

And mochell mast to the
husband did yield,

And with his nuts larded many
swine:

But now the gray moss marred
his rine;

His bared boughs were beaten
with storms,

His top was bald, and wasted
with worms,

His honour decayed, his
branches sere.

"Hard by his side grew a
bragging Brere,
Which proudly thrust into th'
element,





And seemed to threat the
firmament:
It was embellish'd with
blossoms fair,
And thereto aye wanted to
repair
The shepherds' daughters to
gather flowers,
To paint their garlands with his
colours;
And in his small bushes used
to shroud
The sweet nightingale singing
so loud;
Which made this foolish Brere
wax so bold,
That on a time he cast him to
scold
And snebbe the good Oak, for
he was old.

"Why standst there (quoth
he) thou brutish block?
Nor for fruit nor for shadow
serves thy stock;
Seest how fresh my flowers be
spread,
Dyed in lily white and crimson
red,
With leaves engrained in lusty
green;
Colours meet to clothe a
maiden queen?
Thy waste bigness but
cumbers the ground,
And dirks the beauty of my
blossoms round:





The mouldy moss, which thee
accloyeth,
My cinnamon smell too much
annoyeth:
Wherefore soon I rede thee
hence remove,
Lest thou the price of my
displeasure prove.'
So spake this bold Brere with
great disdain:
Little him answered the Oak
again,
But yielded, with shame and
grief adawed,
That of a weed he was
overcrowed.

"It chanced after upon a day,
The husbandman self to come
that way,
Of custom for to surviue his
ground,
And his trees of state in
compass round:
Him when the spiteful Brere
had espied,
Causeless complained, and
loudly cried
Unto his lord, stirring up stern
strife:

"O my liege lord! the god of
my life,
Pleaseth you ponder your
suppliant's plaint,
Caused of wrong and cruel
constraint,
Which I your poor vassal daily
endure;





And, but your goodness the
same recure,
Am like for desperate dool to
die,
Through felonous force of
mine enemy.'
"Greatly aghast with this
piteous plea,
Him rested the goodman on
the lea,
And bade the Brere in his
plaint proceed.
With painted words then gan
this proud weed
(As most usen ambitious folk)
His coloured crime with craft
to cloak.
"Ah, my sovereign! lord of
creatures all,
Thou placer of plants both
humble and tall,
Was not I planted of thine own
hand,
To be the primrose of all thy
land;
With flow'ring blossoms to
furnish the prime,
And scarlet berries in summer
time?
How falls it then that this
faded Oak,
Whose body is sere, whose
branches broke,
Whose naked arms stretch
unto the fire,
Unto such tyranny doth aspire;





Hindering with his shade my
lovely light,
And robbing me of the sweet
sun's sight?
So beat his old boughs my
tender side,
That oft the blood springeth
from woundes wide;
Untimely my flowers forced to
fall,
That be the honour of your
coronal:
And oft he lets his canker-
worms light
Upon my branches, to work
me more spite;
And oft his hoary locks down
doth cast,
Wherewith my fresh flow'rets
be defast:
For this, and many more such
outrage,
Craving your goodlyhead to
assuage
The rancorous rigour of his
might;
Nought ask I, but only to hold
my right;
Submitting me to your good
sufferance,
And praying to be guarded
from grievance.'

"To this this Oak cast him to
reply
Well as he couth; but his
enemy



Had kindled such coals of
displeasure,
That the goodman nould stay
his leisure,
But home him hasted with
furious heat,
Increasing his wrath with
many a threat:
His harmful hatchet he hent in
hand,
(Alas! that it so ready should
stand!)

And to the field alone he
speedeth,
(Aye little help to harm there
needeth!)

Anger nould let him speak to
the tree,
Enaunter his rage might cooled
be;
But to the root bent his sturdy
stroke,
And made many wounds in the
waste Oak.

The axe's edge did oft turn
again,
As half unwilling to cut the
grain;
Seemed, the senseless iron did
fear,
Or to wrong holy eld did
forbear;

For it had been an ancient tree,
Sacred with many a mystery,
And often cross'd with the
priests' crew,





And often hallowed with holy-
water dew:
But sike fancies weren foolery,
And brougten this Oak to this
misery;
For nought might they quitten
him from decay,
For fiercely the goodman at
him did lay.
The block oft groaned under
the blow,
And sighed to see his near
overthrow.
In fine, the steel had pierced
his pith,
Then down to the earth he fell
forthwith.
His wondrous weight made the
ground to quake,
Th' earth shrunk under him,
and seemed to shake:—
There lieth the Oak, pitied of
none!
"Now stands the Brere like a
lord alone,
Puffed up with pride and vain
pleasance;
But all this glee had no
continuance:
For eftsoons winter gan to
approach;
The blust'ring Boreas did
encroach,
And beat upon the solitary
Brere;
For now no succour was seen
him near.





Now gan he repent his pride
too late;
For, naked left and
disconsolate,
The biting frost nipt his stalk
dead,
The watry wet weighed down
his head,
And heaped snow burden'd
him so sore,
That now upright he can stand
no more;
And, being down, is trod in the
durt
Of cattle, and broused, and
sorely hurt.
Such was th' end of this
ambitious Brere,
For scorning eld—"
CUD. Now I pray thee,
shepherd, tell it not
forth:
Here is a long tale, and little
worth.
So long have I listened to thy
speech,
That graffed to the ground is
my breech;
My heartblood is well nigh
frorne I feel,
And my galage grown fast to
my heel;
But little ease of thy lewd tale
I tasted:
Hie thee home, shepherd, the
day is nigh wasted.





THENOT'S EMBLEME. ⁴

*Iddio, perche É vecchio,
Fa suoi al suo essempro.*

CUDDIE'S EMBLEME. ⁴

*Niuno vecchio
Spaventa Iddio.*

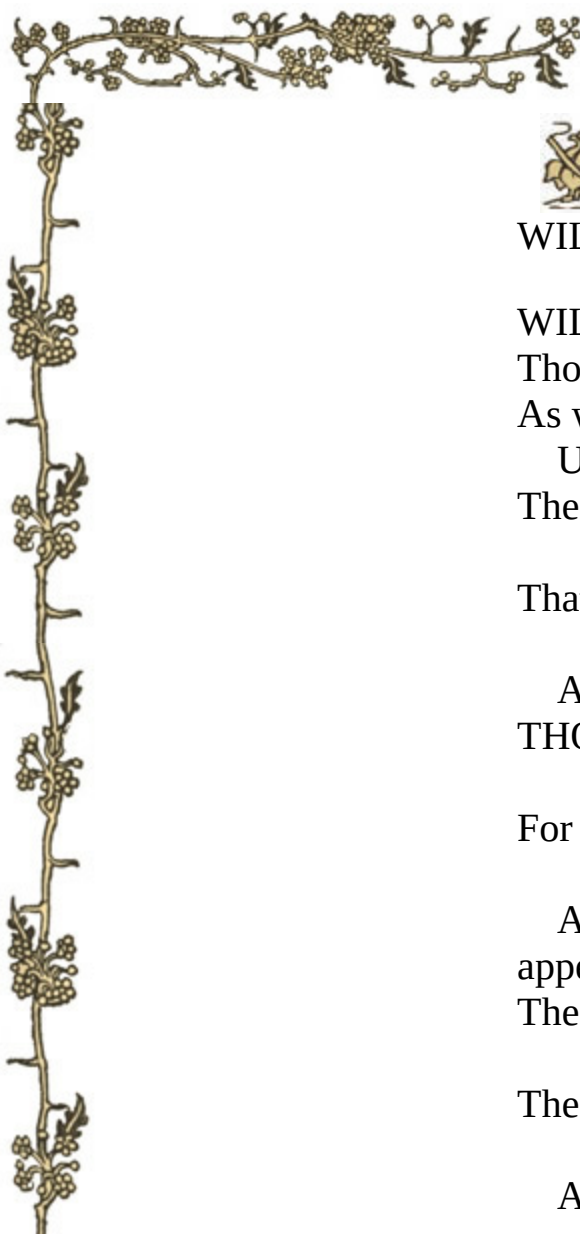


MARCH · AEGLOGA TERTIA



MARCH. ÆGLOGA TERTIA. ARGUMENT.

In this Æglogue two Shepheards' Boys, taking occasion of the season, begin to make purpose of love, and other pleasance which to springtime is most agreeable. The special meaning hereof is, to give certain marks and tokens, to know Cupid the poets' god of Love. But more particularly, I think, in the person of Thomalin, is meant some secret friend, who scorned Love and his knights so long, till at length himself was entangled, and unwares wounded with the dart of some beautiful regard, which is Cupid's arrow.

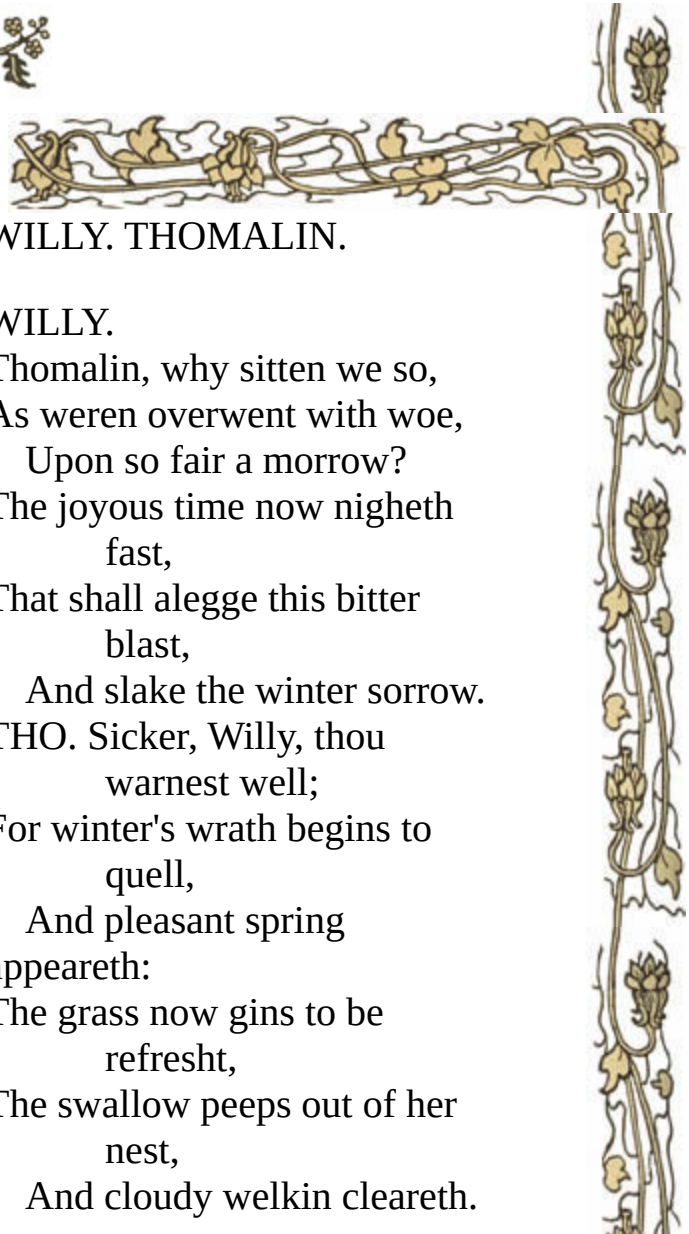


WILLY. THOMALIN.

WILLY.

Thomalin, why sitten we so,
As weren overwent with woe,
Upon so fair a morrow?
The joyous time now nigheth
fast,
That shall alegge this bitter
blast,
And slake the winter sorrow.

THO. Sicker, Willy, thou
warnest well;
For winter's wrath begins to
quell,
And pleasant spring
appeareth:
The grass now gins to be
refresht,
The swallow peeps out of her
nest,
And cloudy welkin cleareth.





WIL. Seest not thilk same
 hawthorn stud,
How bragly it begins to bud,
 And utter his tender head?
Flora now calleth forth each
 flower,
And bids make ready Maia's
 bower
 That new is uprist from bed:
Then shall we sporten in
 delight,
And learn with Lettice to wax
 light,
 That scornfully looks
askance;
Then will we little Love
 awake,
That now sleepeth in Lethe
 lake,
 And pray him leaden our
dance.
THO. Willy, I ween thou be
 assot;
For lusty Love still sleepeth
 not,
 But is abroad at his game.
WIL. How kenst thou that he
 is awoke?
Or hast thyself his slumber
 broke?
 Or made privy to the same?
THO. No; but happily I him
 spied,
Where in a bush he did him
 hide,
 With wings of purple and
blue;





And, were not that my sheep
would stray,
The privy marks I would
bewray,
Whereby by chance I him
knew.
WIL. Thomalin, have no care
forth;
Myself will have a double eye,
Alike to my flock and thine;
For, alas! at home I have a
sire,
A stepdame eke, as hot as fire,
That duly adays counts
mine.
THO. Nay, but thy seeing will
not serve,
My sheep for that may chance
to swerve,
And fall into some mischief:
For sithens is but the third
morrow
That I chanc'd to fall asleep
with sorrow,
And waked again with grief;
The while thilk same unhappy
ewe,
Whose clouted leg her hurt
doth shew,
Fell headlong into a dell,
And there unjointed both her
bones:
Might her neck been jointed
attones,
She should have need no
more spell;





Th' elf was so wanton and so
wood,
(But now I trow can better
good,)
She might ne gang on the
green.
WIL. Let be, as may be, that is
past;
That is to come, let be
forecast:
Now tell us what thou hast
seen.
THO. It was upon a holiday,
When shepherds' grooms
have leave to play,
I cast to go a shooting;
Long wand'ring up and down
the land,
With bow and bolts in either
hand,
For birds in bushes tooting,
At length within the ivy tod,
(There shrouded was the little
god,)
I heard a busy bustling;
I bent my bolt against the
bush,
List'ning if any thing did rush,
But then heard no more
rustling.
Then, peeping close into the
thick,
Might see the moving of some
quick,
Whose shape appeared not;
But were it faery, fiend, or
snake,



My courage yearn'd it to
 awake,
 And manfully thereat shot:
With that sprang forth a naked
 swain;
With spotted wings like
 peacock's train,
 And laughing lope to a tree;
His gilden quiver at his back,
And silver bow, which was but
 slack,
 Which lightly he bent at me:
That seeing, I levell'd again,
And shot at him with might
 and main,
 As thick as it had hailed.
So long I shot, that all was
 spent;
Then pumie stones I hast'ly
 hent,
 And threw; but nought
availed:
He was so wimble and so
 wight,
From bough to bough he
 leaped light,
 And oft the pumies latched:
Therewith afraid I ran away;
But he, that erst seem'd but to
 play,
 A shaft in earnest snatched,
And hit me running in the
 heel:
For then I little smart did feel,
 But soon it sore increased;
And now it rankleth more and
 more,

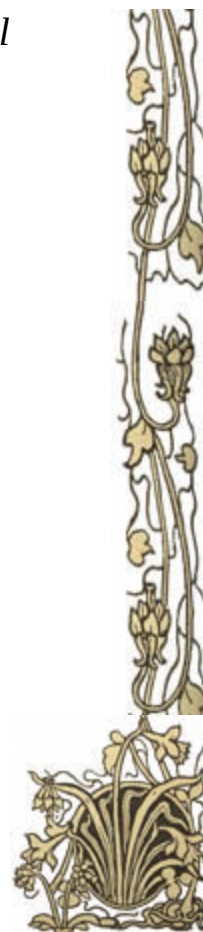




And inwardly it fest'reth sore,
Ne wote I how to cease it.
WIL. Thomalin, I pity thy
 plight,
Perdie with Love thou didest
 fight;
 I know him by a token:
For once I heard my father say,
How he him caught upon a
 day,
 (Whereof he will be
wroken,)
Entangled in a fowling net,
Which he for carrion crows
 had set
 That in our pear-tree
haunted:
Then said, he was a winged
 lad,
But bow and shafts as then
 none had,
 Else had he sore been
daunted.
But see, the welkin thicks
 apace,
And stooping Phœbus steeps
 his face;
 It's time to haste us
homeward.
WILLY'S EMBLEME.
*To be wise and eke to love,
Is granted scarce to gods
above.*
THOMALIN'S EMBLEME.
*Of honey and of gall in love
there is store;*



*The honey is much, but the gall
is more.*

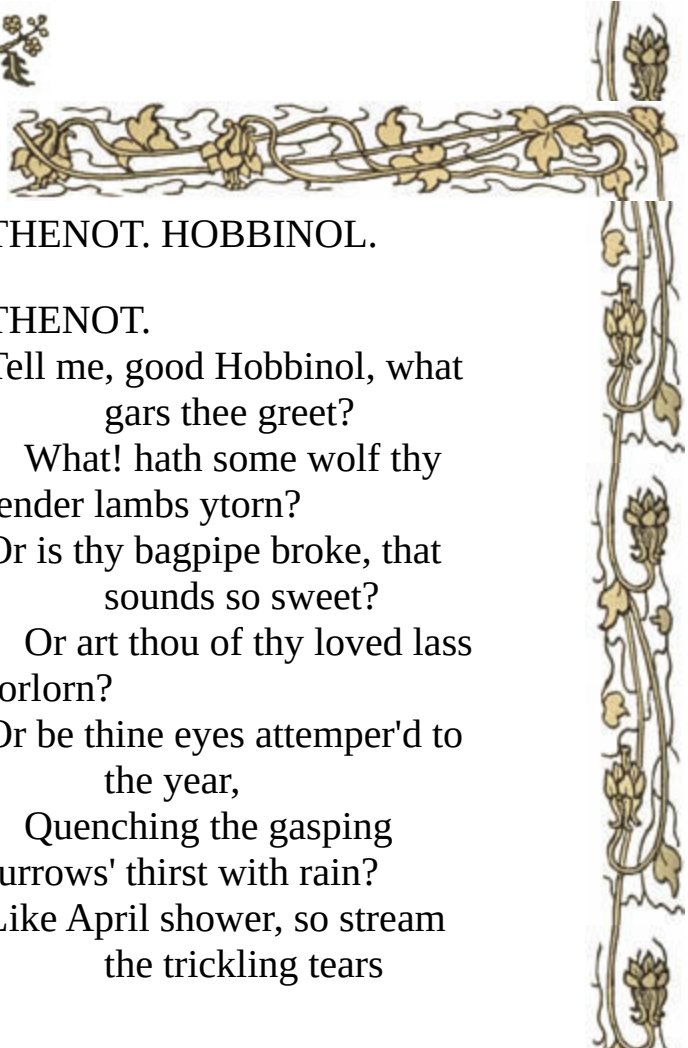
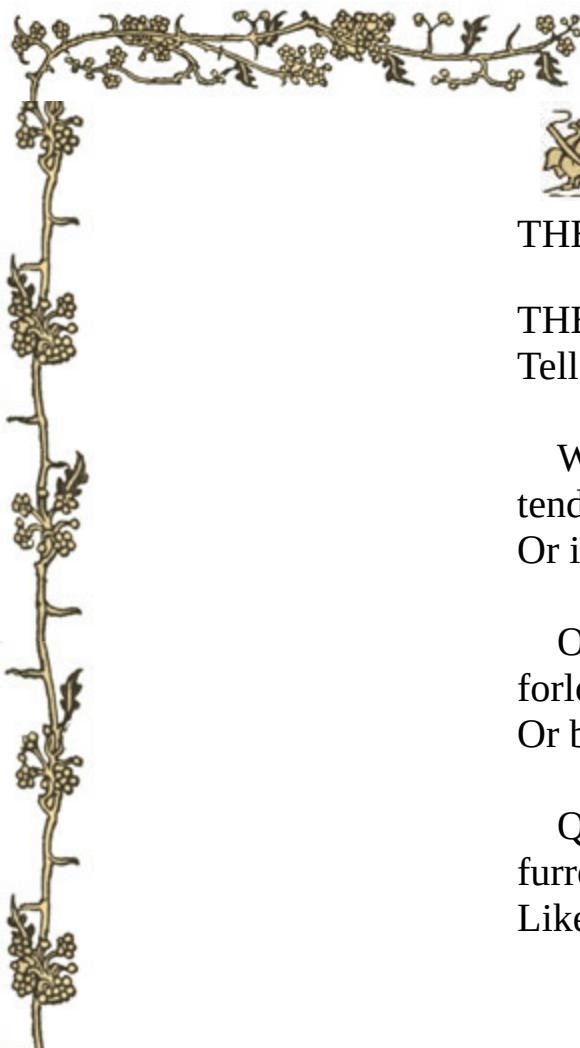


APRIL • AEGLOGA QUARTA



APRIL. ÆGLOGA QUARTA. ARGUMENT.

This Æglogue is purposely intended to the honour and praise of our most gracious sovereign, Queen Elizabeth. The speakers hereof be Hobbinol and Thenot, two shepherds: the which Hobbinol, being beforementioned greatly to have loved Colin, is here set forth more largely, complaining him of that boy's great misadventure in love; whereby his mind was alienated and withdrawn not only from him, who most loved him, but also from all former delights and studies, as well in pleasant piping, as cunning rhyming and singing, and other his laudable exercises. Whereby he taketh occasion, for proof of his more excellency and skill in poetry, to record a song, which the said Colin sometime made in honour of her Majesty, whom abruptly he termeth Elisa.



THENOT. HOBBINOL.

THENOT.

Tell me, good Hobbinol, what
gars thee greet?

What! hath some wolf thy
tender lambs ytorn?

Or is thy bagpipe broke, that
sounds so sweet?

Or art thou of thy loved lass
forlorn?

Or be thine eyes attemper'd to
the year,

Quenching the gasping
furrows' thirst with rain?

Like April shower, so stream
the trickling tears



Adown thy cheek, to quench
thy thirsty pain.

HOB. Nor this, nor that, so
much doth make me
mourn,

But for the lad, whom long I
lov'd so dear,
Now loves a lass that all his
love doth scorn:

He, plunged in pain, his
tressed locks doth tear;
Shepherd's delights he doth
them all forswear;

His pleasant pipe, which
made us merriment,
He wilfully hath broke, and
doth forbear

His wonted songs wherein
he all outwent.

THE. What is he for a lad you
so lament?

Is love such pinching pain to
them that prove?

And hath he skill to make so
excellent,

Yet hath so little skill to
bridle love?

HOB. Colin thou kenst, the
southern shepherd's
boy;

Him Love hath wounded
with a deadly dart:

Whilome on him was all my
care and joy,

Forcing with gifts to win his
wanton heart.





But now from me his madding
mind is start,
And wooes the widow's
daughter of the glen;
So now fair Rosalind hath bred
his smart;

So now his friend is
changed for a frenne.

THE. But if his ditties be so
trimly dight,

I pray thee, Hobbinol,
record some one,
The whiles our flocks do graze
about in sight,

And we close shrouded in
this shade alone.

HOB. Contented I: then will I
sing his lay

Of fair Elisa, queen of
shepherds all,

Which once he made as by a
spring he lay,

And tuned it unto the
waters' fall.

"Ye dainty Nymphs, that in
this blessed brook

Do bathe your breast,
Forsake your watry bowers,
and hither look,

At my request.

And eke you virgins, that on
Parnass dwell,

Whence floweth Helicon, the
learned well,

Help me to blaze
Her worthy praise,





Which in her sex doth all
excel.

"Of fair Elisa be your silver
song,
That blessed wight,
The flower of virgins; may she
flourish long
In princely plight!
For she is Syrinx' daughter
without spot,
Which Pan, the shepherds'
god, of her begot:
So sprung her grace
Of heavenly race,
No mortal blemish may her
blot.

"See, where she sits upon the
grassy green,
(O seemly sight!)
Yclad in scarlet, like a maiden
queen,
And ermines white:
Upon her head a crimson
coronet,
With damask roses and
daffadillies set;
Bay leaves between,
And primroses green,
Embellish the sweet violet.

"Tell me, have ye seen her
angelic face,
Like Phœbe fair?
Her heavenly haveour, her
princely grace,





Can you well compare?
The red rose medled with the
white yfere,
In either cheek depeincten
lively cheer:
Her modest eye,
Her majesty,
Where have you seen the like
but there?

"I saw Phœbus; thrust out his
golden head,
Upon her to gaze;
But, when he saw how broad
her beams did spread,
It did him amaze.
He blush'd to see another sun
below,
Ne durst again his fiery face
out show.
Let him, if he dare,
His brightness compare
With hers, to have the
overthrow.

"Shew thyself, Cynthia, with
thy silver rays,
And be not abash'd:
When she the beams of her
beauty displays,
O how art thou dash'd!
But I will not match her with
Latona's seed;
Such folly great sorrow to
Niobe did breed.
And she is a stone,
And makes daily moan,





Warning all other to take heed.

"Pan may be proud that ever
 he begot
 Such a bellibone;
And Syrinx rejoice, that ever
 was her lot
 To bear such an one.
Soon as my younglings crying
 for the dam,
To her will I offer a milkwhite
 lamb;
 She is my goddess plain,
 And I her shepherd's
swain,
Albe forswonk and forswat I
 am.

"I see Calliope speed her to the
 place,
 Where my goddess shines;
And after her the other Muses
 trace,
 With their violins.
Be they not bay-branches
 which they do bear,
All for Elisa in her hand to
 wear?
 So sweetly they play,
 And sing all the way,
That it a heaven is to hear.

"Lo, how finely the Graces can
 it foot
 To the instrument:
They dancen deftly, and singen
 soote,





In their merriment.
Wants not a fourth Grace, to
 make the dance even?
Let that room to my Lady be
 yeven
 She shall be a Grace,
 To fill the fourth place,
And reign with the rest in
 heaven.

"And whither runs this bevy of
 ladies bright,
 Ranged in a row?
They be all Ladies of the Lake
 behight,
 That unto her go.
Chloris, that is the chiefest
 nymph of all,
Of olive branches bears a
 coronal:
 Olives be for peace
 When wars do surcease:
Such for a princess be
 principal.

"Ye shepherds' daughters, that
 dwell on the green,
 Hie you there apace:
Let none come there but that
 virgins bene,
 To adorn her grace:
And, when you come whereas
 she is in place,
See that your rudeness do not
 you disgrace:
 Bind your fillets fast,
And gird in your waist,





For more fineness, with a
tawdry ⁵ lace.

"Bring hither the pink and
purple columbine,
With gelliflowers;
Bring coronations, and sops-
in-wine,
Worn of paramours:
Strow me the ground with
daffadowndillies,
And cowslips, and kingcups,
and loved lillies:
The pretty pounce,
And the chevisance,
Shall match with the fair
flower delice.

"Now rise up, Elisa, decked as
thou art
In royal array;
And now ye dainty damsels
may depart
Each one her way.
I fear I have troubled your
troops too long;
Let Dame Elisa thank you for
her song:
And, if you come hither
When damsines I gather,
I will part them all you
among."

THE. And was thilk same song
of Colin's own
making?



Ah! foolish boy! that is with
love yblent;

Great pity is, he be in such
taking,

For naught caren that be so
lewdly bent.

HOB. Sicker I hold him for a
greater fon,

That loves the thing he
cannot purchase.

But let us homeward, for night
draweth on,

And twinkling stars the
daylight hence chase.

THENOT'S EMBLEME. ⁶

O quam et memorem virgo!

HOBBINOL'S EMBLEME.

O Dea certe!

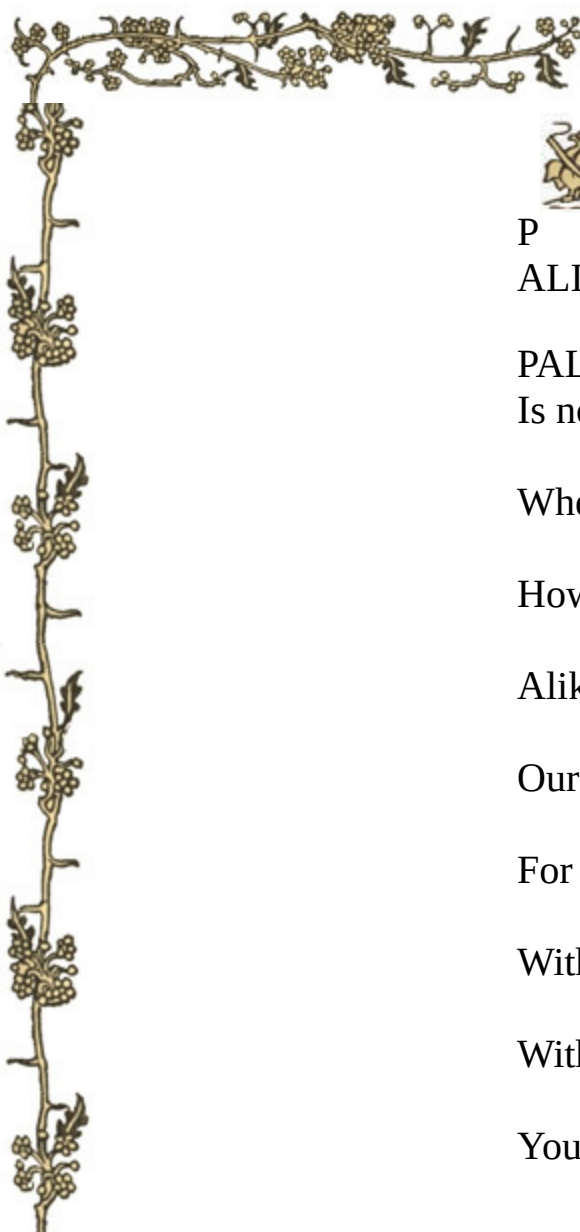


MAY • AEGLOGA QUINTA



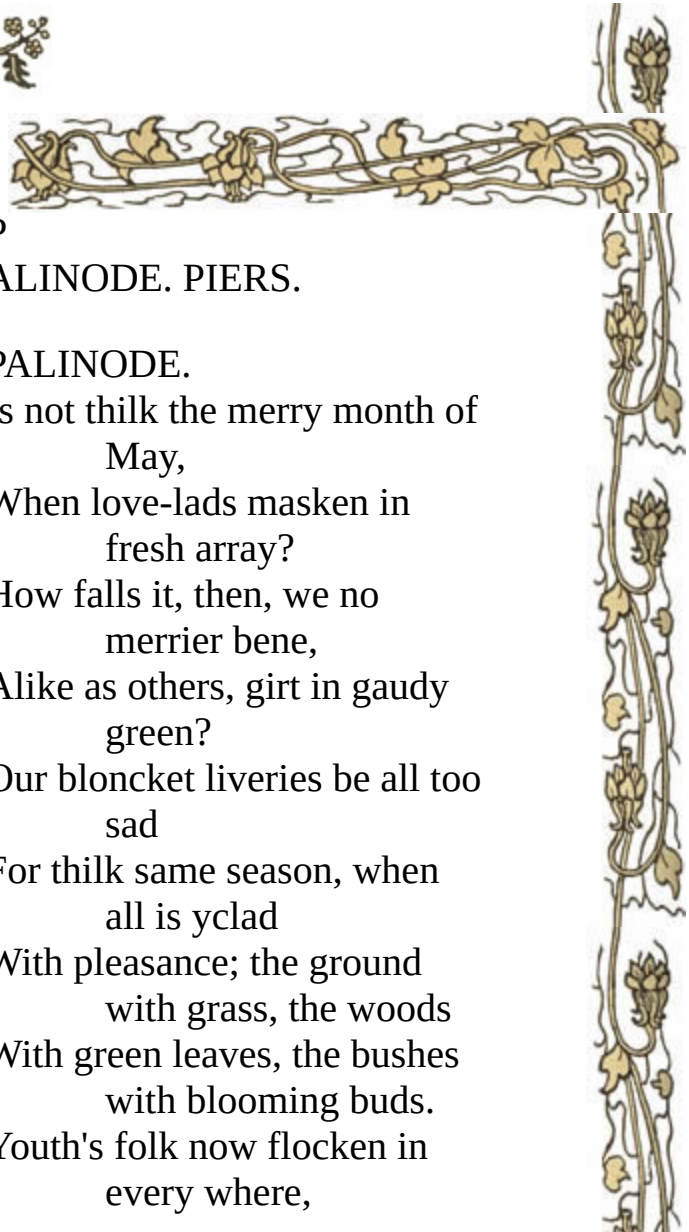
MAY. ÆGLOGA QUINTA. ARGUMENT.

In this fifth Æglogue, under the person of two shepherds, Piers and Palinode, be represented two forms of Pastors or Ministers, or the Protestant and the Catholic; whose chief talk standeth in reasoning, whether the life of the one must be like the other; with whom having shewed, that it is dangerous to maintain any fellowship, or give too much credit to their colourable and feigned good-will, he telleth him a tale of the Fox, that, by such a counterpoint of craftiness, deceived and devoured the credulous Kid.



P
ALINODE. PIERS.

PALINODE.
Is not thilk the merry month of
 May,
When love-lads masken in
 fresh array?
How falls it, then, we no
 merrier bene,
Alike as others, girt in gaudy
 green?
Our bloncket liveries be all too
 sad
For thilk same season, when
 all is yclad
With pleasance; the ground
 with grass, the woods
With green leaves, the bushes
 with blooming buds.
Youth's folk now flocken in
 every where,





To gather May-baskets and
 smelling brere;
And home they hasten the
 posts to dight,
And all the kirk-pillars ere
 day-light,
With hawthorn buds, and
 sweet eglantine,
And garlands of roses, and
 sops-in-wine.
Such merrimake holy saints
 doth queme,
But we here sitten as drown'd
 in dream.
PIERS. For younkers,
 Palinode, such follies
 fit,
But we tway be men of elder
 wit.
PAL. Sicker this morrow, no
 longer ago,
I saw a shoal of shepherds
 outgo
With singing, and shouting,
 and jolly cheer:
Before them yode a lusty
 tabrere,
That to the many a horn-pipe
 play'd,
Whereto they dancen each one
 with his maid.
To see those folks make such
 jovisance,
Made my heart after the pipe
 to dance:
Then to the green wood they
 speeden them all,





To fetchen home May with
their musical;
And home they bringen in a
royal throne,
Crowned as king; and his
queen attone
Was Lady Flora, on whom did
attend
A fair flock of faeries, and a
fresh bend
Of lovely nymphs. (O that I
were there,
To helpen the ladies their
Maybush bear!)
Ah! Piers, be not thy teeth on
edge, to think
How great sport they gainen
with little swink?
PIERS. Perdie, so far am I
from envy,
That their fondness inly I pity:
Those faitours little regarden
their charge,
While they, letting their sheep
run at large,
Passen their time, that should
be sparely spent,
In lustihed and wanton
merriment.
Thilk same be shepherds for
the devil's stead,
That playen while their flocks
be unfed:
Well it is seen their sheep be
not their own,
That letten them run at random
alone:





But they be hired for little pay
Of other, that caren as little as
they,
What fallen the flock, so they
have the fleece,
And get all the gain, paying
but a piece.
I muse, what account both
these will make;
The one for the hire, which he
doth take,
And th' other for leaving his
Lord's task,
When great Pan account of
shepherds shall ask.
PAL. Sicker, now I see thou
speakest of spite,
All for thou lackest somdele
their delight.
I (as I am) had rather be
envied,
All were it of my foe, than
fonly pitied;
And yet, if need were, pitied
would be,
Rather than other should scorn
at me;
For pitied is mishap that n'as
remedy,
But scorned be deeds of fond
foolery.
What shoulde shepherds
other things tend,
Than, sith their God his good
does them send,
Reapen the fruit thereof, that is
pleasure,





The while they here liven at
ease and leisure?
For, when they be dead, their
good is ygoe,
They sleepen in rest, well as
other moe:
Then with them wends what
they spent in cost,
But what they left behind them
is lost.
Good is no good, but if it be
spend;
God giveth good for none
other end.
PIERS. Ah! Palinode, thou art
a world's child:
Who touches pitch, must needs
be defil'd;
But shepherds (as Algrind ^z
used to say)
Must not live alike as men of
the lay.
With them it sits to care for
their heir,
Enaunter their heritage do
impair:
They must provide for means
of maintenance,
And to continue their wont
countenance:
But shepherd must walk
another way,
Sike worldly sovenance he
must for-say.
The son of his loins why
should he regard



To leave enriched with that he
hath spar'd?
Should not thilk God, that
gave him that good,
Eke cherish his child, if in his
ways he stood?
For if he mislive in lewdness
and lust,
Little boots all the wealth, and
the trust,
That his father left by
inheritance;
All will be soon wasted with
misgovernance:
But through this, and other
their miscreance,
They maken many a wrong
chevisance,
Heaping up waves of wealth
and woe,
The floods whereof shall them
overflow.
Sike men's folly I cannot
compare
Better than to the ape's foolish
care,
That is so enamoured of her
young one,
(And yet, God wot, such cause
had she none,)
That with her hard hold, and
strait embracing,
She stoppeth the breath of her
youngling.
So oftentimes, whenas good is
meant,
Evil ensueth of wrong intent.



The time was once, and may
again return,
(For ought may happen, that
hath been beforne,)
When shepherds had none
inheritance,
Ne of land nor fee in
sufferance,
But what might arise of the
bare sheep,
(Were it more or less) which
they did keep.
Well ywis was it with
shepherds then:
Nought having, nought feared
they to forego;
For Pan himself was their
inheritance,
And little them served for their
maintenance.
The shepherds' God so well
them guided,
That of nought they were
unprovided;
Butter enough, honey, milk,
and whey,
And their flocks' fleeces them
to array:
But tract of time, and long
prosperity,
(That nurse of vice, this of
insolency,)
Lulled the shepherds in such
security,
That, not content with loyal
obeisance,





Some gan to gape for greedy
governance,
And match them self with
mighty potentates,
Lovers of lordship, and
troublers of states:
Then gan shepherds' swains
to look aloft,
And leave to live hard, and
learn to ligg soft:
Then, under colour of
shepherds, sometime
There crept in wolves, full of
fraud and guile,
That often devoured their own
sheep,
And often the shepherds that
did them keep:
This was the first source of
shepherds' sorrow,
That now nill be quit with bail
nor borrow.
PAL. Three things to bear be
very burdenous,
But the fourth to forbear is
outrageous:
Women, that of love's longing
once lust,
Hardly forbearen, but have it
they must:
So when choler is inflamed
with rage,
Wanting revenge, is hard to
assuage:
And who can counsel a thirsty
soul,





With patience to forbear the
offer'd bowl?
But of all burdens, that a man
can bear,
Most is, a fool's talk to bear
and to hear.
I ween the giant has not such a
weight,
That bears on his shoulders the
heaven's height.
Thou findest fault where n'is to
be found,
And buildest strong work upon
a weak ground:
Thou railest on right withouten
reason,
And blamest them much for
small encheason.
How shouldest shepherds live,
if not so?
What? should they pinen in
pain and woe?
Nay, say I thereto, by my dear
borrow,
If I may rest, I nill live in
sorrow.
Sorrow ne need be hastened
on,
For he will come, without
calling, anon,
While times endure of
tranquillity,
Usen we freely our felicity;
For, when approachen the
stormy stowres,
We must with our shoulders
bear off the sharp





showers;
And, sooth to sayn, nought
 seemeth sike strife,
That shepheards so witen each
 other's life,
And layen their faults the
 worlds befor,
The while their foes do each of
 them scorn.
Let none mislike of that may
 not be mended;
So contest soon by concord
 might be ended.
PIERS. Shepheard, I list no
 accordance make
With shepheard, that does the
 right way forsake;
And of the twain, if choice
 were to me,
Had lever my foe than my
 friend he be;
For what concord have light
 and dark sam?
Or what peace has the lion
 with the lamb?
Such faitours, when their false
 hearts be hid,
Will do as did the Fox by the
 Kid. [8](#)
PAL. Now, Piers, of
 fellowship, tell us that
 saying;
For the lad can keep both our
 flocks from straying.
PIERS. Thilk same Kid (as I
 can well devise)





Was too very foolish and
unwise;
For on a time, in summer
season,
The Goat her dam, that had
good reason,
Yode forth abroad unto the
green wood,
To brouze, or play, or what she
thought good:
But, for she had a motherly
care
Of her young son, and wit to
beware,
She set her youngling before
her knee,
That was both fresh and lovely
to see,
And full of favour as kid might
be.
His velvet head began to shoot
out,
And his wreathed horns gan
newly sprout;
The blossoms of lust to bud
did begin,
And spring forth rankly under
his chin.
"My son," (quoth she, and with
that gan weep;
For careful thoughts in her
heart did creep;)
"God bless thee, poor orphan!
as he might me,
And send thee joy of thy
jollity.



Thy father," (that word she
spake with pain,
For a sigh had nigh rent her
heart in twain,)
"Thy father, had he lived this
day,
To see the branch of his body
display,
How would he have joyed at
this sweet sight?
But ah! false Fortune such joy
did him spite,
And cut off his days with
untimely woe,
Betraying him into the trains
of his foe.
Now I, a wailful widow
behight,
Of my old age have this one
delight,
To see thee succeed in thy
father's stead,
And flourish in flowers of
lustihead;
For even so thy father his head
upheld,
And so his haughty horns did
he weld."

Then marking him with
melting eyes,
A thrilling throb from her heart
did arise,
And interrupted all her other
speech
With some old sorrow that
made a new breach;





Seemed she saw in her
 youngling's face
The old lineaments of his
 father's grace.
At last her sullen silence she
 broke,
And gan his new-budded beard
 to stroke.
"Kiddie," (quoeth she,) "thou
 kenst the great care
I have of thy health and thy
 welfare,
Which many wild beasts
 liggen in wait
For to entrap in thy tender
 state:
But most the Fox, master of
 collusion;
For he has vowed thy last
 confusion.
Forthy, my Kiddie, be rul'd by
 me,
And never give trust to his
 treachery;
And, if he chance come when I
 am abroad,
Sperr the gate fast, for fear of
 fraud;
Ne for all his worst, nor for his
 best,
Open the door at his request."
 So schooled the Goat her
wanton son,
That answer'd his mother, all
 should be done.
Then went the pensive dam out
 of door,



And chanc'd to stumble at the
threshold floor;
Her stumbling step somewhat
her amazed,
(For such, as signs of ill luck,
be dispraised;)
Yet forth she yode, thereat half
aghast;
And Kiddie the door sperred
after her fast.
It was not long, after she was
gone,
But the false Fox came to the
door anone;
Not as a fox, for then he had
be kend,
But all as a poor pedlar he did
wend,
Bearing a truss of trifles at his
back,
As bells, and babes, and
glasses, in his pack:
A biggen he had got about his
brain,
For in his headpiece he felt a
sore pain:
His hinder heel was wrapt in a
clout,
For with great cold he had got
the gout:
There at the door he cast me
down his pack,
And laid him down, and
groaned, "Alack!
alack!
Ah! dear Lord! and sweet
Saint Charity!





That some good body would
once pity me!"

Well heard Kiddie all this
sore constraint,
And long'd to know the cause
of his complaint;
Then, creeping close behind
the wicket's clink,
Privily he peeped out through
a chink,
Yet not so privily but the Fox
him spied;
For deceitful meaning is
double-eyed.

"Ah! good young master,"
(then gan he cry,)
"Jesus bless that sweet face I
espy,
And keep your corpse from the
careful stounds
That in my carrion carcase
abounds."

The Kid, pitying his
heaviness,
Asked the cause of his great
distress,
And also who, and whence
that he were.

Then he, that had well
yconn'd his lere,
Thus medled his talk with
many a tear:
"Sick, sick, alas! and little lack
of dead,
But I be relieved by your
beastlyhead."





I am a poor sheep, albe my
colour dun,
For with long travel I am brent
in the sun;
And if that, my grandsire me
said, be true,
Sicker, I am very sib to you;
So be your goodlihead do not
disdain
The base kindred of so simple
swain.
Of mercy and favour then I
you pray,
With your aid to forestall my
near decay."

Then out of his pack a glass
he took,
Wherein while Kiddie unwares
did look,
He was so enamoured with the
newell,
That nought he deemed dear
for the jewel:
Then opened he the door, and
in came
The false Fox, as he were stark
lame:
His tail he clapt betwixt his
legs twain,
Lest he should be descried by
his train.

Being within, the Kid made
him good glee,
All for the love of the glass he
did see.
After his cheer, the pedlar gan
chat,





And tell many leasings of this
and that,
And how he could shew many
a fine knack;
Then shewed his ware and
opened his pack,
All save a bell, which he left
behind
In the basket for the Kid to
find;
Which when the Kid stooped
down to catch,
He popt him in, and his basket
did latch;
Ne stayed he once the door to
make fast,
But ran away with him in all
hast.

Home when the doubtful
dame had her hied,
She might see the door stand
open wide;
All aghast, loudly she gan to
call
Her Kid; but he nould answer
at all:
Then on the floor she saw the
merchandice
Of which her son had set too
dear a price.
What help! her Kid she knew
well was gone:
She weeped, and wailed, and
made great moan.
Such end had the Kid, for he
nould warned be





Of craft, coloured with
simplicity;
And such end, perdie, does all
them remain,
That of such falsers' friendship
be fain.

PAL. Truly, Piers, thou art
beside thy wit,
Furthest fro the mark, weening
it to hit.

Now, I pray thee, let me thy
tale borrow

For our Sir John, ⁹ to say to-
morrow

At the kirk when it is holiday;
For well he means, but little
can say.

But, and if foxes be so crafty
as so,

Much needeth all shepherds
them to know.

PIERS. Of their falsehood
more could I recount,
But now the bright sun ginneth
to dismount;

And, for the dewy night now
doth nigh,

I hold it best for us home to
hie.

PALINODE'S EMBLEME.

Πᾶς μὲν ἀπίστος ἀπίσται
(Every one without faith is
suspicious.)

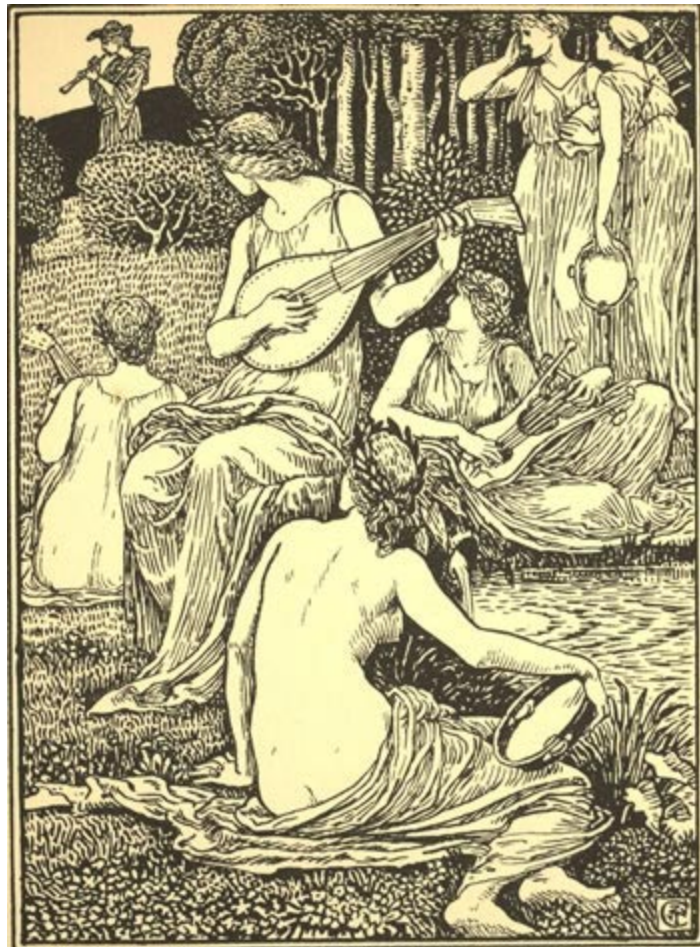
PIERS, HIS EMBLEME.

Τίς δ' ἀρὰ πιστὶς ἀπίστὸς
What faith, then, in the
faithless?)



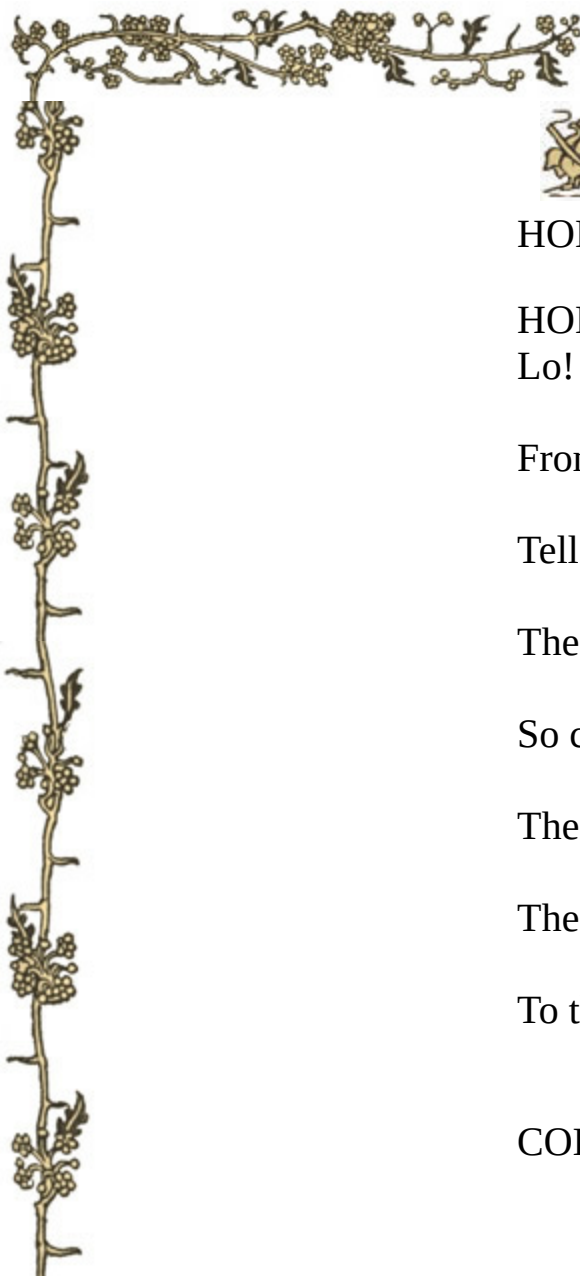


JUNE • AEGLOGA SEXTA



JUNE. ÆGLOGA SEXTA. ARGUMENT.

This Æglogue is wholly vowed to the complaining of Colin's ill success in his love. For being (as is aforesaid) enamoured of a country lass Rosalind, and having (as seemeth) found place in her heart, he lamenteth to his dear friend Hobbinol, that he is now forsaken unfaithfully, and in his stead Menalcas, another shepheard, received disloyally. And this is the whole Argument of this Æglogue.

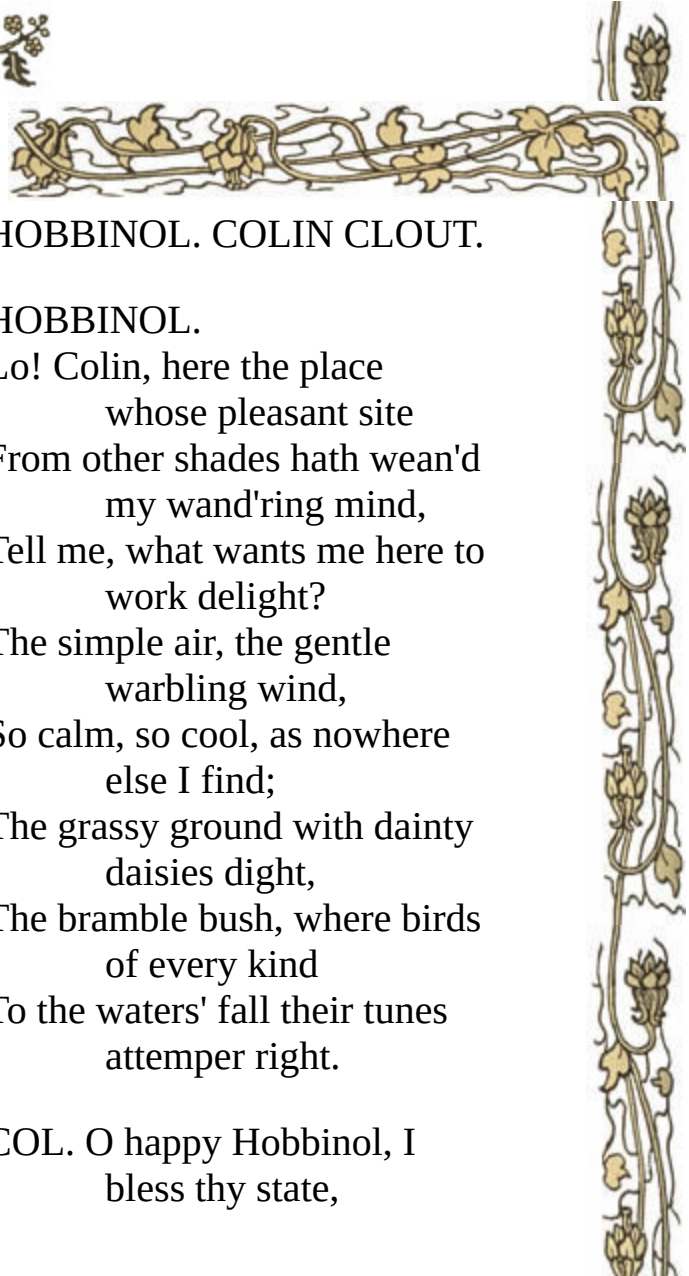


HOBBINOL. COLIN CLOUT.

HOBBINOL.

Lo! Colin, here the place
 whose pleasant site
From other shades hath wean'd
 my wand'ring mind,
Tell me, what wants me here to
 work delight?
The simple air, the gentle
 warbling wind,
So calm, so cool, as nowhere
 else I find;
The grassy ground with dainty
 daisies dight,
The bramble bush, where birds
 of every kind
To the waters' fall their tunes
 attemper right.

COL. O happy Hobbinol, I
 bless thy state,





That Paradise hast found
which Adam lost:
Here wander may thy flock
early or late,
Withouten dread of wolves to
be ytost;
Thy lovely lays here mayst
thou freely boast:
But I, unhappy man! whom
cruel Fate
And angry gods pursue from
coast to coast,
Can nowhere find to shroud
my luckless pate.

HOB. Then, if by me thou list
advised be,
Forsake the soil that so doth
thee bewitch;
Leave me those hills were
harbrough n'is to see,
Nor holly-bush, nor briar, nor
winding ditch;
And to the dales resort, where
shepherds rich,
And fruitful flocks, be every
where to see:
Here no night-ravens lodge,
more black than pitch,
Nor elvish ghosts, nor ghastly
owls do flee;

But friendly Faeries, met with
many Graces,
And lightfoot Nymphs, can
chase the ling'ring
Night



With heydeguyes, and trimly
trodden traces,
Whilst Sisters Nine, which
dwell on Parnass
height,
Do make them music for their
more delight;
And Pan himself to kiss their
crystal faces
Will pipe and dance, when
Phœbe shineth bright:
Such peerless pleasures have
we in these places.

COL. And I, whilst youth, and
course of careless
years,
Did let me walk withouten
links of love,
In such delights did joy
amongst my peers;
But riper age such pleasures
doth reprove:
My fancy eke from former
follies move
To stayed steps; for time in
passing wears,
(As garments do, which waxen
old above,)
And draweth new delights
with hoary hairs.

Then couth I sing of love, and
tune my pipe
Unto my plaintive pleas in
verses made;



Then would I seek for queen-
apples unripe;
To give my Rosalind, and in
summer shade
Dight gaudy garlands was my
common trade,
To crown her golden locks; but
years more ripe,
And loss of her, whose love as
life I weigh'd,
Those weary wanton toys
away did wipe.

HOB. Colin, to hear thy
rhymes and roundelays,
Which thou wert wont on
wasteful hills to sing,
I more delight than lark in
summer days,
Whose echo made the
neighbour groves to
ring,
And taught the birds, which in
the lower spring
Did shroud in shady leaves
from sunny rays,
Frame to thy song their
cheerful chirruping,
Or hold their peace, for shame
of thy sweet lays.

I saw Calliope with Muses
moe,
Soon as thy oaten pipe began
to sound,
Their ivory lutes and
tambourins forgo,



And from the fountain, where
they sat around,
Run after hastily thy silver
sound;
But, when they came where
thou thy skill didst
shew,
They drew aback, as half with
shame confound
Shepherd to see, them in their
art outgo.

COL. Of Muses, Hobbinol, I
con no skill,
For they be daughters of the
highest Jove,
And holden scorn of homely
shepherd's quill;
For sith I heard that Pan with
Phœbus strove,
Which him to much rebuke
and danger drove,
I never list presume to Parnass
hill,
But, piping low in shade of
lowly grove,
I play to please myself, all be
it ill.

Nought weigh I, who my song
doth praise or blame,
Ne strive to win renown, or
pass the rest:
With shepherd sits not follow
flying Fame,
But feed his flock in fields
where falls them best.



I wot my rhymes be rough, and
rudely drest;
The fitter they my careful case
to frame:
Enough is me to paint out my
unrest,
And pour my piteous plaints
out in the same.

The god of shepherds,
Tityrus, [10](#) is dead,
Who taught me homely, as I
can, to make:
He, whilst he lived, was the
sovereign head
Of shepherds all that be with
love ytake;
Well couth he wail his woes,
and lightly slake
The flames which love within
his heart had bred,
And tell us merry tales to keep
us wake,
The while our sheep about us
safely fed.

Now dead he is, and lieth
wrapt in lead,
(O why should Death on him
such outrage shew!)
And all his passing skill with
him is fled,
The fame whereof doth daily
greater grow.
But, if on me some little drops
would flow



Of that the spring was in his
learned head,
I soon would learn these
woods to wail my woe,
And teach the trees their
trickling tears to shed.

Then should my complaints, caus'd
of discourtesy,
As messengers of this my
painful plight,
Fly to my love where ever that
she be,
And pierce her heart with point
of worthy wite,
As she deserves, that wrought
so deadly spite.
And thou, Menalcas! that by
treachery
Didst underfong my lass to
wax so light,
Shouldst well be known for
such thy villany.

But since I am not as I wish I
were,
Ye gentle shepherds! which
your flocks do feed,
Whether on hills, or dales, or
other where,
Bear witness all of this so
wicked deed;
And tell the lass, whose flower
is wox a weed,
And faultless faith is turn'd to
faithless fear,



That she the truest shepherd's
heart made bleed
That lives on earth, and loved
her most dear.

HOB. O! careful Colin, I
lament thy case;
Thy tears would make the
hardest flint to flow!
Ah! faithless Rosalind, and
void of grace,
That art the root of all this
ruthful woe!
But now is time, I guess,
homeward to go:
Then rise, ye blessed flocks!
and home apace,
Lest night with stealing steps
do you foreslow,
And wet your tender lambs
that by you trace.

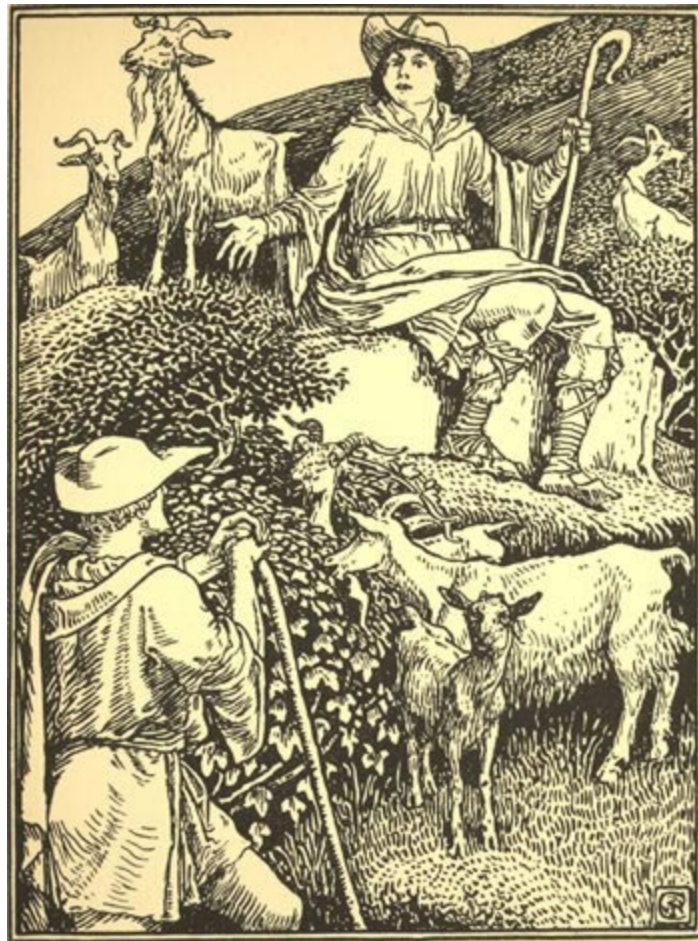
COLIN'S EMBLEME.

Gia speme spenta.

(Already hope is lost.)

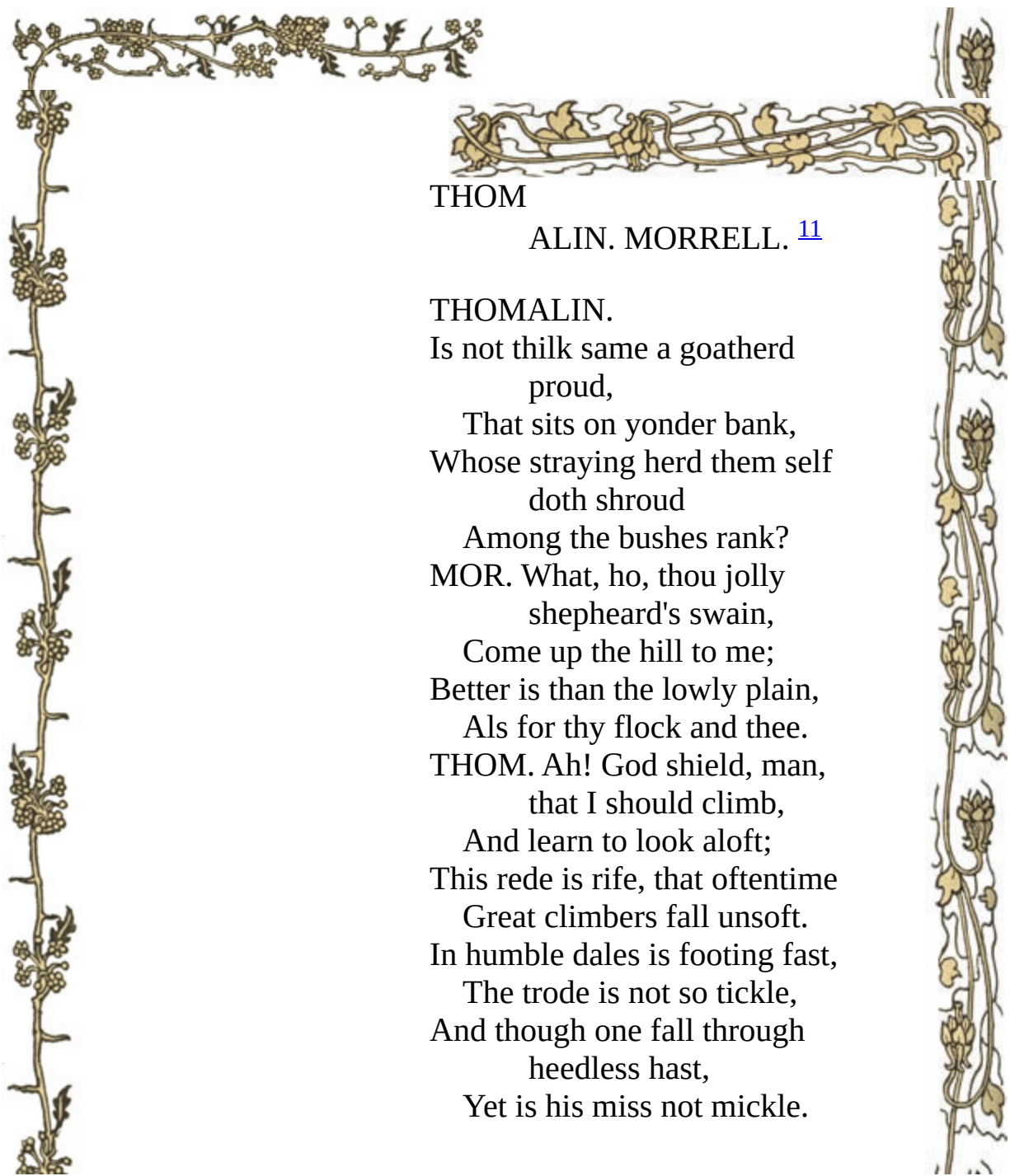


JULY • AEGLOGA SEPTIMA



JULY. ÆGLOGA SEPTIMA. ARGUMENT.

This Æglogue is made in the honour and commendation of good shepherds, and to the shame and dispraise of proud and ambitious pastors: such as Morrell is here imagined to be.



THOM

ALIN. MORRELL. [11](#)

THOMALIN.

Is not thilk same a goatherd
proud,

That sits on yonder bank,
Whose straying herd them self
doth shroud

Among the bushes rank?

MOR. What, ho, thou jolly
shepherd's swain,

Come up the hill to me;
Better is than the lowly plain,
Als for thy flock and thee.

THOM. Ah! God shield, man,
that I should climb,

And learn to look aloft;
This rede is rife, that oftentime
Great climbers fall unsoft.

In humble dales is footing fast,
The trode is not so tickle,
And though one fall through
heedless hast,

Yet is his miss not mickle.



And now the Sun ¹² hath
 reared up
 His fiery-footed team,
Making his way between the
 Cup
 And golden Diademe;
The rampant Lion hunts he
 fast,
 With dogs of noisome
breath,
Whose baleful barking brings
 in hast
 Pine, plagues, and dreary
death.
Against his cruel scorching
 heat,
 Where thou hast coverture,
The wasteful hills unto his
 threat
 Is a plain overture:
But, if thee list to holden chat
 With seely shepherd's
swain,
Come down, and learn the
 little what,
 That Thomalin can sayn.
MOR. Siker thou's but a lazy
 loord,
 And recks much of thy
swink,
That with fond terms, and
 witless words,
 To blear mine eyes dost
think.
In evil hour thou hentst in
 hand
 Thus holy hills to blame,



For sacred unto saints they
stand,
And of them have their
name.
St. Michel's Mount who does
not know,
That wards the Western
coast?
And of St. Bridget's Bower I
trow
All Kent can rightly boast:
And they that con of Muses'
skill
Sayn most-what, that they
dwell
(As goatherds wont) upon a
hill,
Beside a learned well.
And wonned not the great
good Pan
Upon Mount Olivet,
Feeding the blessed flock of
Dan,
Which did himself beget?
THOM. O blessed Sheep! O
Shepherd great!
That bought his flock so
dear,
And them did save with
bloody sweat
From wolves that would
them tear.
MOR. Beside, as holy Fathers
sayn,
There is a holy place
Where Titan riseth from the
main





To run his daily race,
Upon whose top the stars be
 stay'd,
 And all the sky doth lean;
There is the cave where Phœbe
 laid
 The shepherd long to
dream.
Whilome there used
 shepherds all
 To feed their flocks at will,
Till by his folly one did fall,
 That all the rest did spill.
And, sithens shepherds be
 foresaid
 From places of delight,
Forthy I ween thou be afraid
 To climb this hillës height.
Of Sinai can I tell thee more,
 And of our Lady's Bower;
But little needs to strow my
 store,
 Suffice this hill of our.
Here have the holy Fauns
 recourse,
 And Sylvans haunten rathe;
Here has the salt Medway his
 source,
 Wherein the Nymphs do
bathe;
The salt Medway, that trickling
 streams
 Adown the dales of Kent,
Till with his elder brother
 Themes
 His brackish waves be ment.





Here grows melampode every
where,
And terebinth, good for
goats;
The one my madding kids to
smear,
The next to heal their
throats.
Hereto, the hills be nigher
heaven,
And then the passage eath;
As well can prove the piercing
levin,
That seldom falls beneath.
THOM. Siker thou speaks like
a lewd lorrell,
Of heaven to deemen so;
How be I am but rude and
borrell,
Yet nearer ways I know.
To kirk the narre, from God
more far,
Has been an old-said saw;
And he, that strives to touch a
star,
Oft stumbles at a straw.
As soon may shepherd climb
to sky
That leads in lowly dales,
As goatherd proud, that, sitting
high,
Upon the mountain sails.
My seely sheep like well
below,
They need not melampode,
For they be hale enough, I
trow,





And liken their abode;
But, if they with thy goats
should yede,
They soon might be
corrupted,
Or like not of the frowy feed,
Or with the weeds be
glutted.
The hills, where dwelled holy
saints,
I reverence and adore,
Not for themself, but for the
saints
Which have been dead of
yore.
And now they be to heaven
forewent,
Their good is with them go;
Their sample only to us lent,
That als we might do so.
Shepherds they weren of the
best,
And lived in lowly leas;
And, sith they souls be now at
rest,
Why do we them disease?
Such one he was (as I have
heard
Old Algrind often sayn)
That whilome was the first
shepherd,
And lived with little gain:
And meek he was, as meek
might be,
Simple as simple sheep;
Humble, and like in each
degree



The flock which he did
keep.
Often he used of his keep
A sacrifice to bring,
Now with a kid, now with a
sheep,
The altars hallowing.
So louted he unto his Lord,
Such favour couth he find,
That never sithens was
abhorr'd
The simple shepherds'
kind.
And such, I ween, the brethren
were
That came from Canaän,
The brethren Twelve, that kept
yfere
The flocks of mighty Pan.
But nothing such thilk
shepherd was
Whom Ida hill did bear,
That left his flock to fetch a
lass,
Whose love he bought too
dear.
For he was proud, that ill was
paid,
(No such must shepherds
be!)

And with lewd lust was
overlaid;
Two things doen ill agree.
But shepherd must be meek
and mild,
Well-eyed, as Argus was,
With fleshly follies undefiled,





And stout as steed of brass.
Such one (said Algrind) Moses
was,
That saw his Maker's face,
His face, more clear then
crystal glass,
And spake to him in place.
This had a brother, (his name I
knew,)
The first of all his cote,
A shepherd true, yet not so
true
As he that erst I hote.
Whilome all these were low
and lief,
And loved their flocks to
feed;
They never stroven to be chief,
And simple was their weed:
But now (thanked be God
therefore!)
The world is well amend,
Their weeds be not so nighly
wore;
Such simplese might them
shend!
They be yclad in purple and
pall,
So hath their God them
blist;
They reign and ruln over all,
And lord it as they list;
Ygirt with belts of glittering
gold,
(Might they good
shepherds been!)





 Their Pan their sheep to them
 has sold,
 I say as some have seen.
For Palinode (if thou him ken)
 Yode late on pilgrimage
To Rome, (if such be Rome,)
 and then
 He saw thilk misusage;
For shepheards (said he) there
 doen lead,
 As lords done other where;
Their sheep have crusts, and
 they the bread;
 The chips, and they the
cheer:
They have the fleece, and eke
 the flesh,
 (O seely sheep the while!)
The corn is theirs, let others
 thresh,
 Their hands they may not
file.
They have great store and
 thrifty stocks,
 Great friends and feeble
foes;
What need them caren for their
 flocks,
 Their boys can look to
those.
These wisards welter in
 wealth's waves,
 Pamper'd in pleasures deep;
They have fat kerns, and leany
 knaves,
 Their fasting flocks to keep.





Sike mister men be all
misgone,
They heapen hills of wrath;
Such surly shepherds have we
none,
They keepen all the path.
MOR. Here is a great deal of
good matter
Lost for lack of telling;
Now sicker I see thou dost but
clatter,
Harm may come of melling.
Thou meddlest more than shall
have thank,
To witen shepherds'
wealth;
When folk be fat, and riches
rank,
It is a sign of health.
But say me, what is Algrind,
he
That is so oft benempt?
THOM. He is a shepherd
great in gree,
But hath been long ypent:
One day he sat upon a hill,
As now thou wouldest me;
But I am taught, by Algrind's
ill,
To love the low degree;
For sitting so with bared scalp,
An eagle [13](#) soared high,
That, weening his white head
was chalk,
A shell-fish down let fly;
She ween'd the shell-fish to
have broke,

But therewith bruis'd his
brain;
So now, astonied with the
stroke,
He lies in lingering pain.
MOR. Ah! good Algrind! his
hap was ill,
But shall be better in time.
Now farewell, shepheard, sith
this hill

Thou hast such doubt to
climb.

PALINODE'S EMBLEME.

In medio virtus.

(Virtue dwells in the middle
place.)

MORRELL'S EMBLEME.

In summo felicitas.

(Happiness in the highest.)

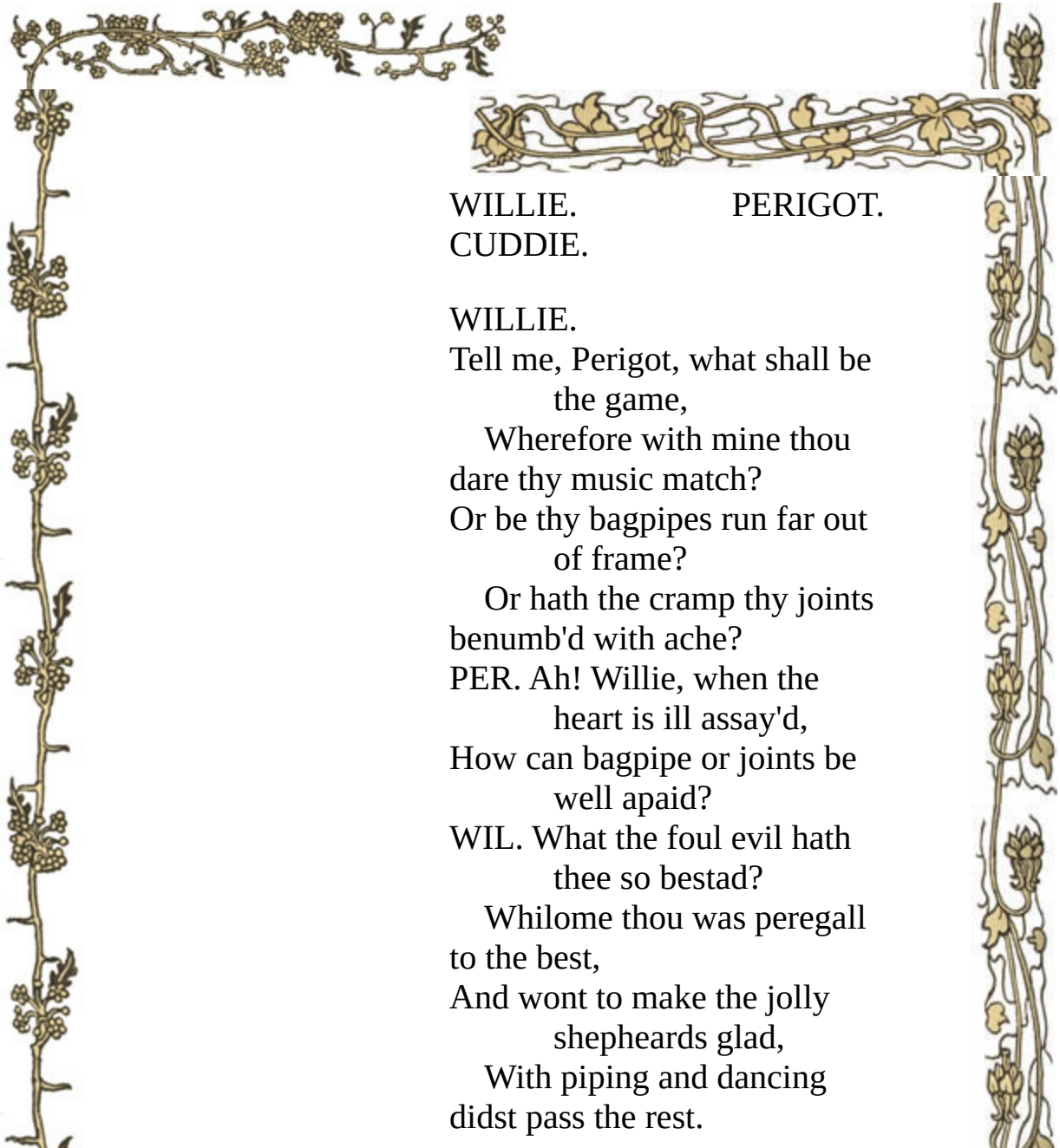


AUGUST · AEGLOGA OCTAVA



AUGUST. ÆGLOGA OCTAVA. ARGUMENT.

In this Æglogue is set forth a delectable controversy, made in imitation of that in Theocritus: whereto also Virgil fashioned his third and seventh Æglogue. They chose for umpire of their strife, Cuddy, a neat-herd's boy; who, having ended their cause, reciteth also himself a proper song, whereof Colin he saith was author.



WILLIE. PERIGOT.
CUDDIE.

WILLIE.
Tell me, Perigot, what shall be
 the game,
 Wherefore with mine thou
dare thy music match?
Or be thy bagpipes run far out
 of frame?

 Or hath the cramp thy joints
benumb'd with ache?

PER. Ah! Willie, when the
 heart is ill assay'd,
How can bagpipe or joints be
 well apaid?

WIL. What the foul evil hath
 thee so bestad?

 Whilome thou was peregall
to the best,

And wont to make the jolly
 shepheards glad,

 With piping and dancing
didst pass the rest.



PER. Ah! Willie, now I have
learn'd a new dance;
My old music marr'd by a new
mischance.

WIL. Mischief might to that
mischance befall,
That so hath reft us of our
merriment;

But rede me what pain doth
thee so appal;

Or lovest thou, or be thy
younglings miswent?

PER. Love hath misled both
my younglings and me;
I pine for pain, and they my
pain to see.

WIL. Perdie, and wellaway! ill
may they thrive;

Never knew I lover's sheep
in good plight:

But and if in rhymes with me
thou dare strive,

Such fond fantasies shall
soon be put to flight.

PER. That shall I do, though
mochell worse I fared:
Never shall be said that Perigot
was dared.

WIL. Then lo, Perigot, the
pledge which I plight,

A mazer ywrought of the
maple warre,

Wherein is enchased many a
fair sight

Of bears and tigers, that
maken fierce war;





And over them spread a
 goodly wild vine,
Entrailed with a wanton ivy
 twine.
Thereby is a lamb in the
 wolvës jaws;
 But see, how fast runneth
the shepherd swain
To save the innocent from the
 beast's paws,
 And here with his
sheephook hath him slain.
Tell me, such a cup hast thou
 ever seen?
Well might it beseem any
 harvest queen.
PER. Thereto will I pawn
 yonder spotted lamb;
 Of all my flock there n'is
such another,
For I brought him up without
 the dam;
 But Colin Clout reft me of
his brother,
That he purchas'd of me in the
 plain field;
Sore against my will was I
 forc'd to yield.
WIL. Sicker, make like
 account of his brother;
 But who shall judge the
wager won or lost?
PER. That shall yonder
 herdgroom and none
 other,
 Which over the pease
hitherward doth post.





WIL. But, for the sunbeam so
sore doth us beat,
Were not better to shun the
scorching heat?

PER. Well agreed, Willie; then
set thee down, swain;
Such a song never heardest
thou but Colin sing.

CUD. 'Gin, when ye list, ye
jolly shepherds twain;
Such a judge, as Cuddie,
were for a king.

PER. It fell upon a holy eve,

WIL. Hey, ho, holiday!

PER. When holy Fathers wont
to shrieve;

WIL. Now ginneth this
roundelay.

PER. Sitting upon a hill so
high,

WIL. Hey, ho, the high hill!

PER. The while my flock did
feed thereby;

WIL. The while the shepherd
self did spill;

PER. I saw the bouncing
Bellibone,

WIL. Hey, ho, Bonnibell!

PER. Tripping over the dale
alone;

WIL. She can trip it very well.

PER. Well decked in a frock of
gray,

WIL. Hey, ho, gray is greet!

PER. And in a kirtle of green
saye,





WIL. The green is for maidens
meet.

PER. A chapelet on her head
she wore,

WIL. Hey, ho, chapelet!

PER. Of sweet violets therein
was store,

WIL. She sweeter than the
violet.

PER. My sheep did leave their
wonted food,

WIL. Hey, ho, seely sheep!

PER. And gaz'd on her as they
were wood,

WIL. Wood as he that did
them keep.

PER. As the bonilass passed
by,

WIL. Hey, ho, bonilass!

PER. She rov'd at me with
glancing eye,

WIL. As clear as the crystal
glass:

PER. All as the sunny beam so
bright,

WIL. Hey, ho, the sun-beam!

PER. Glanceth from Phœbus'
face forthright,

WIL. So love into thy heart did
stream:

PER. Or as the thunder cleaves
the clouds,

WIL. Hey, ho, the thunder!

PER. Wherein the lightsome
levin shrouds,

WIL. So cleaves thy soul
asunder:





PER. Or as Dame Cynthia's
silver ray,
WIL. Hey, ho, the moonlight!
PER. Upon the glittering wave
doth play,
WIL. Such play is a piteous
plight.
PER. The glance into my heart
did glide,
WIL. Hey, ho, the glider!
PER. Therewith my soul was
sharply gryde,
WIL. Such wounds soon
waxen wider.
PER. Hasting to wrench the
arrow out,
WIL. Hey, ho, Perigot!
PER. I left the head in my
heart-root,
WIL. It was a desperate shot.
PER. There it rankleth aye
more and more,
WIL. Hey, ho, the arrow!
PER. Ne can I find salve for
my sore,
WIL. Love is a careless
sorrow.
PER. And though my bale with
death I bought,
WIL. Hey, ho, heavy cheer!
PER. Yet should thilk lass not
from my thought,
WIL. So you may buy gold too
dear.
PER. But whether in painful
love I pine,
WIL. Hey, ho, pinching pain!





PER. Or thrive in wealth, she
shall be mine,
WIL. But if thou can her
obtain.
PER. And if for graceless grief
I die,
WIL. Hey, ho, graceless grief!
PER. Witness she slew me
with her eye,
WIL. Let thy folly be the prief.
PER. And you, that saw it,
simple sheep,
WIL. Hey, ho, the fair flock!
PER. For prief thereof, my
death shall weep,
WIL. And moan with many a
mock.
PER. So learn'd I love on a
holy eve,
WIL. Hey, ho, holy-day!
PER. That ever since my heart
did grieve,
WIL. Now endeth our
roundelay."
CUD. Sicker, such a roundel
never heard I none;
Little lacketh Perigot of the
best,
And Willie is not greatly
overgone,
So weren his under-songs
well address.
WIL. Herdgroom, I fear me
thou have a squint eye;
Arede uprightly, who has the
victory.





CUD. Faith of my soul, I deem
each have gained;

Forthy let the lamb be Willie
his own;

And for Perigot, so well hath
him pained,

To him be the wroughten
mazer alone.

PER. Perigot is well pleased
with the doom,

Ne can Willie wite the witeless
herdgroom.

WIL. Never dempt more right
of beauty, I ween,

The shepheard of Ida that
judged Beauty's queen.

CUD. But tell me, shepherds,
should it not yshend

Your roundels fresh, to hear
a doleful verse

Of Rosalind (who knows not
Rosalind?)

That Colin made? ilk can I
you rehearse.

PER. Now say it, Cuddie, as
thou art a lad;

With merry thing it's good
to medle sad.

WIL. Faith of my soul, thou
shalt ycrowned be

In Colin's stead, if thou this
song arede;

For never thing on earth so
pleaseth me

As him to hear, or matter of
his deed.





CUD. Then listen each unto
my heavy lay,
And tune your pipes as ruthful
as ye may.

"Ye wasteful Woods! bear
witness of my woe,
Wherein my plaints did
oftentimes resound;
Ye careless Birds are privy to
my cries,
Which in your songs were
wont to make a part:
Thou, pleasant Spring, hast
lull'd me oft asleep,
Whose streams my trickling
tears did oft augment!

"Resort of people doth my
griefs augment,
The walled towns do work my
greater woe;
The forest wide is fitter to
resound
The hollow echo of my careful
cries.
I hate the house, since thence
my love did part,
Whose wailful want debars
mine eyes of sleep.

"Let streams of tears supply
the place of sleep;
Let all, that sweet is, void; and
all, that may augment
My dole, draw near! More
meet to wail my woe





Be the wild woods, my
sorrows to resound,
Than bed, nor bower, both
which I fill with cries,
When I them see so waste, and
find no part

"Of pleasure past. Here will I
dwell apart
In gastful grove therefore, till
my last sleep
Do close mine eyes; so shall I
not augment
With sight of such as change
my restless woe.
Help me, ye baneful Birds!
whose shrieking sound
Is sign of dreary death, my
deadly cries

"Most ruthfully to tune: and as
my cries
(Which of my woe cannot
bewray least part)
You hear all night, when
Nature craveth sleep,
Increase, so let your irksome
yells augment.
Thus all the nights in plaints,
the day in woe,
I vowed have to waste, till safe
and sound

"She home return, whose
voice's silver sound
To cheerful songs can change
my cheerless cries.





Hence with the nightingale
will I take part,
That blessed bird, that spends
her time of sleep
In songs and plaintive pleas,
the more t' augment
The memory of his misdeed
that bred her woe.

"And you that feel no woe,
when as the sound
Of these my nightly cries ye
hear apart,
Let break your sounder sleep,
and pity augment."

PER. O Colin, Colin! the
shepherds' joy,
How I admire each turning
of thy verse;
And Cuddie, fresh Cuddie, the
liefest boy,
How dolefully his dole thou
didst rehearse!

CUD. Then blow your pipes,
shepherds, till you be
at home;
The night hieth fast, it's time to
be gone.

PERIGOT HIS EMBLEME. [14](#)
Vincenti gloria victi.

(To the conqueror belongs the
glory of the conquered.)

WILLIE'S EMBLEME. [14](#)
Vinto non vitto.

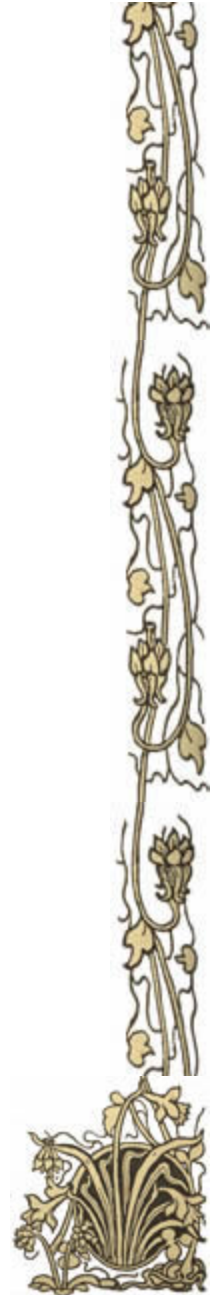
(Conquered, not overcome.)



CUDDIE'S EMBLEME. ¹⁴

Felice chi puo.

(He is happy who can.)

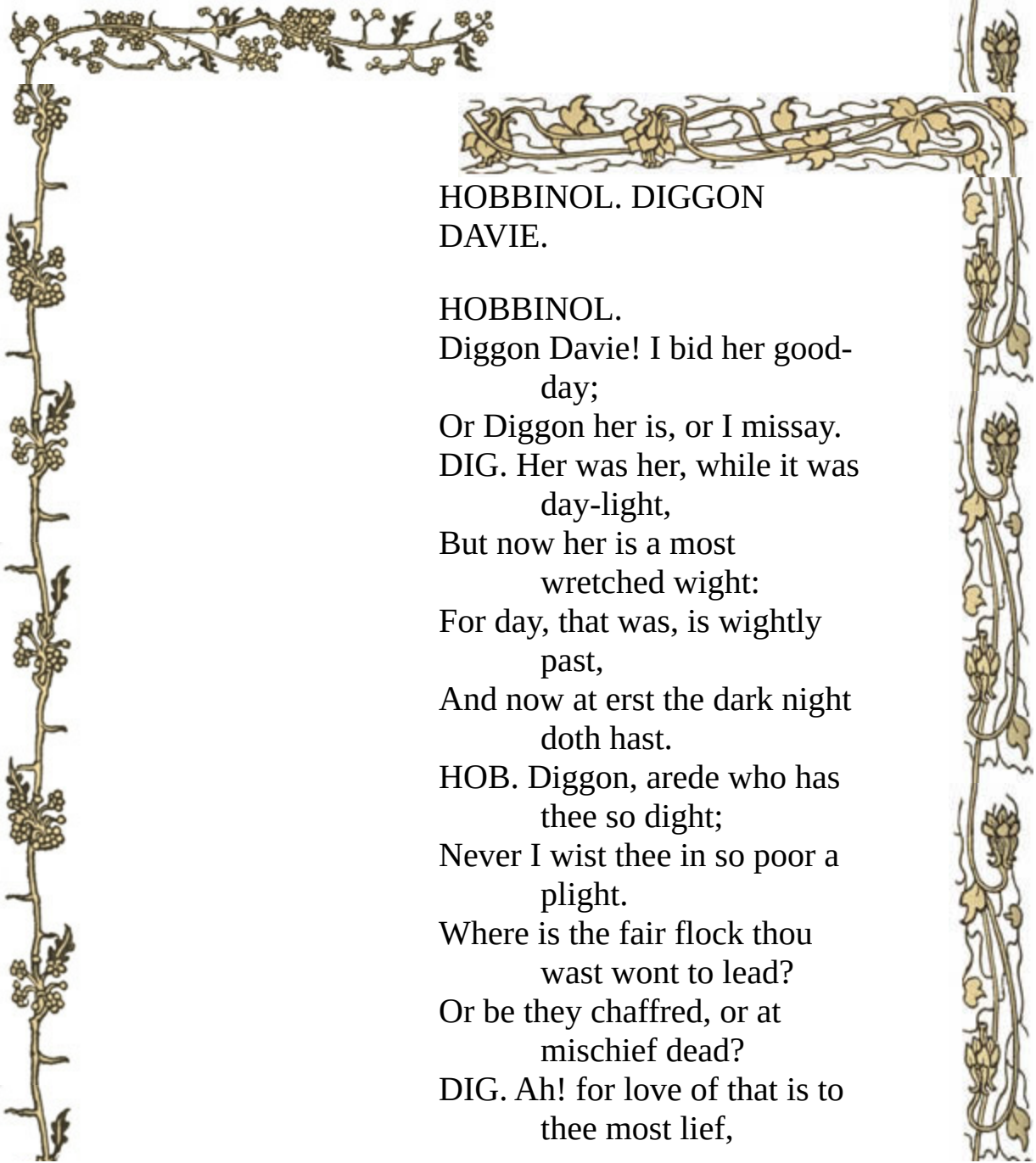


SEPTEMBER · AEGLOGA NONA



SEPTEMBER. ÆGLOGA NONA. ARGUMENT.

Herein Diggon Davie is devised to be a shepheard that, in hope of more gain, drove his sheep into a far country. The abuses whereof, and loose living of Popish prelates, by occasion of Hobbinol's demand, he discourseth at large.



HOBBINOL. DIGGON
DAVIE.

HOBBINOL.
Diggon Davie! I bid her good-
day;
Or Diggon her is, or I missay.
DIG. Her was her, while it was
day-light,
But now her is a most
wretched wight:
For day, that was, is wightly
past,
And now at erst the dark night
doth hast.

HOB. Diggon, arede who has
thee so dight;
Never I wist thee in so poor a
plight.

Where is the fair flock thou
wast wont to lead?
Or be they chaffred, or at
mischief dead?

DIG. Ah! for love of that is to
thee most lief,



Hobbinol, I pray thee gall not
my old grief;
Such question rippeth up cause
of new woe,
For one, opened, might unfold
many moe.
HOB. Nay, but sorrow close
shrouded in heart,
I know, to keep is a burdensome
smart:
Each thing imparted is more
eath to bear:
When the rain is fallen, the
clouds waxen clear.
And now, sithence I saw thy
head last,
Thrice three moons be fully
spent and past;
Since when thou hast
measured much
ground,
And wandered well about the
world round,
So as thou can many things
relate;
But tell me first of thy flock's
estate.
DIG. My sheep be wasted;
(woe is me therefore!)
The jolly shepheard that was
of yore,
Is now nor jolly, nor shepheard
more.
In foreign coasts men said was
plenty;
And so there is, but all of
misery:





I deem'd there much to have
 eked my store,
But such eking hath made my
 heart sore.
In those countries, whereas I
 have been,
No being for those that truly
 mean;
But for such, as of guile maken
 gain,
No such country as there to
 remain;
They setten to sale their shops
 of shame,
And maken a mart of their
 good name:
The shepheards there robben
 one another,
And layen baits to beguile
 their brother;
Or they will buy his sheep out
 of the cote,
Or they will carven the
 shepherd's throat.
The shepherd's swain you
 cannot well ken,
But it be by his pride, from
 other men;
They looken big as bulls that
 be bate,
And bearen the crag so stiff
 and so state,
As cock on his dunghill
 crowing crank.
HOB. Diggon, I am so stiff
 and so stank,



that uneath may I stand any
more;
And now the western wind
bloweth sore,
That now is in his chief
sovereignty,
Beating the withered leaf from
the tree;
Sit we down here under the
hill;
Then may we talk and tellen
our fill,
And make a mock at the
blustering blast:
Now say on, Diggon, whatever
thou hast.
DIG. Hobbin, ah Hobbin! I
curse the stound
That ever I cast to have lorn
this ground:
Well-away the while I was so
fond
To leave the good, that I had in
hond,
In hope of better that was
uncouth,
So lost the dog the flesh in his
mouth.
My silly sheep (ah! silly
sheep!)
That here by there I whilome
us'd to keep,
All were they lusty as thou
didest see,
Be all starved with pine and
penury;



Hardly myself escaped thilk
pain,
Driven for need to come home
again.
HOB. Ah! fon, now by thy loss
art taught
That seldom change the better
brought:
Content who lives with tried
state,
Need fear no change of
frowning Fate;
But who will seek for
unknown gain,
Oft lives by loss, and leaves
with pain.
DIG. I wot ne, Hobbin, how I
was bewitch'd
With vain desire and hope to
be enrich'd:
But, sicker, so it is, as the
bright star
Seemeth aye greater when it is
far:
I thought the soil would have
made me rich,
But now I wot it is nothing
sich;
For either the shepheards be
idle and still,
And led of their sheep what
way they will,
Or they be false, and full of
covetise,
And casten to compass many
wrong emprise:





But the more be fraught with
fraud and spite,
Ne in good nor goodness taken
delight,
But kindle coals of contest and
ire,
Wherewith they set all the
world on fire;
Which when they thinken
again to quench,
With holy water they do them
all drench.
They say they con to heaven
the highway,
But by my soul I dare
undersay
They never set foot in that
same troad,
But balk the right way, and
strayen abroad.
They boast they have the devil
at command,
But ask them therefore what
they have pawn'd:
Marry! that great Pan bought
with dear borrow,
To quit it from the black bower
of sorrow.
But they have sold thilk same
long ago,
For they woulden draw with
them many moe.
But let them gang alone a
God's name;
As they have brewed, so let
them bear blame.





HOB. Diggon, I pray thee
 speak not so dirk;
Such mister saying me
 seemeth to mirk.
DIG. Then, plainly to speak of
 shepheards' most what,
Bad is the best; (this English is
 flat)
Their ill haviour gars men
 missay
Both of their doctrine, and
 their fay.
They sayn the world is much
 war than it wont,
All for her shepheards be
 beastly and blont.
Other sayn, but how truly I
 n'ote,
All for they holden shame of
 their cote:
Some stick not to say, (hot coal
 on their tongue!)
That such mischief graseth
 them among,
All for they casten too much of
 world's care,
To deck their dame, and enrich
 their heir;
For such encheason, if you go
 nigh,
Few chimneys reeking you
 shall espy.
The fat ox, that wont lig in the
 stall,
Is now fast stalled in their
 crumenall.





Thus chatten the people in
their steads,
Alike as a monster of many
heads:
But they, that shooten nearest
the prick,
Sayn, other the fat from their
beards doen lick:
For big bulls of Bashan brace
them about,
That with their horns butten
the more stout;
But the lean souls treaden
under foot,
And to seek redress might little
boot;
For liker be they to pluck away
more,
Than ought of the gotten good
to restore:
For they be like foul
quagmires overgrass'd,
That, if thy galage once
sticketh fast,
The more to wind it out thou
dost swink,
Thou must aye deeper and
deeper sink.
Yet better leave off with a little
loss,
Than by much wrestling to
lose the gross.
HOB. Now, Diggon, I see thou
speakest too plain;
Better it were a little to feign,
And cleanly cover that cannot
be cured;





Such ill, as is forced, must
needs be endured.
But of such pastors how do the
flocks creep?
DIG. Such as the shepherds,
such be their sheep,
For they nill listen to the
shepherd's voice;
But if he call them, at their
good choice
They wander at will and stay
at pleasure,
And to their folds yede at their
own leisure.
But they had be better come at
their call;
For many have unto mischief
fall,
And been of ravenous wolves
yrent,
All for they nould be buxom
and bent.
HOB. Fie on thee, Diggon, and
all thy foul leasing;
Well is known that, sith the
Saxon king, ¹⁵
Never was wolf seen, many
nor some,
Nor in all Kent, nor in
Christendom;
But the fewer wolves (the
sooth to sayn)
The more be the foxes that
here remain.
DIG. Yes, but they gang in
more secret wise,





And with sheeps' clothing
doen them disguise.
They walk not widely as they
were wont,
For fear of rangers and the
great hunt,
But privily prowling to and
fro,
Enaunter they might be inly
know.
HOB. Or privy or pert if any
bin,
We have great bandogs will
tear their skin.
DIG. Indeed thy Ball is a bold
big cur,
And could make a jolly hole in
their fur:
But not good dogs them
needeth to chase,
But heedy shepherds to
discern their face;
For all their craft is in their
countenance,
They be so grave and full of
maintenance.
But shall I tell thee what
myself know
Chanced to Roffin not long
ago?
HOB. Say it out, Diggon,
whatever it hight,
For not but well might him
betight:
He is so meek, wise, and
merciable,





And with his word his work is
convenable.
Colin Clout, I ween, be his self
boy,
(Ah, for Colin! he whilome my
joy:)
Shepheards such, God might
us many send,
That doen so carefully their
flocks tend.
DIG. Thilk same shepheard
might I well mark,
He has a dog to bite or to bark;
Never had shepheard so keen a
cur,
That waketh and if but a leaf
stur.
Whilome there wonned a
wicked wolf,
That with many a lamb had
gutted his gulf,
And ever at night wont to
repair
Unto the flock, when the
welkin shone fair,
Yclad in clothing of silly
sheep,
When the good old man used
to sleep;
Then at midnight he would
bark and bawl,
(For he had eft learned a curre's
call,)
As if a wolf were among the
sheep:
With that the shepheard would
break his sleep,





And send out Lowder (for so
his dog hote)
To range the fields with wide
open throat.
Then, when as Lowder was far
away,
This wolvisch sheep would
catchen his prey,
A lamb, or a kid, or a weanel
wast;
With that to the wood would
he speed him fast.
Long time he used this
slippery prank,
Ere Roffy could for his labour
him thank.
At end, the shepheard his
practice spied,
(For Roffy is wise, and as
Argus eyed,)
And, when at even he came to
the flock,
Fast in their folds he did them
lock,
And took out the wolf in his
counterfeit coat,
And let out the sheep's blood
at his throat.
HOB. Marry, Diggon, what
should him affray
To take his own where ever it
lay?
For, had his weasand been a
little widder,
He would have devoured both
hiddier and shidder.





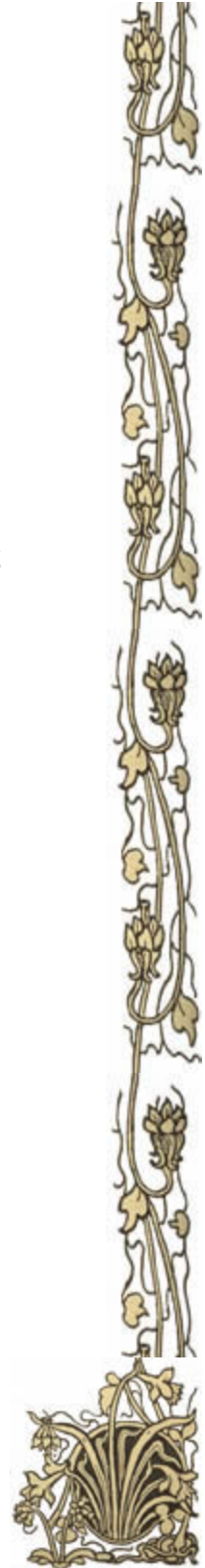
DIG. Mischief light on him,
and God's great curse,
Too good for him had been a
great deal worse;
For it was a perilous beast
above all,
And eke had he cond the
shepherd's call,
And oft in the night came to
the sheep-cote,
And called Lowder, with a
hollow throat,
As if the old man self had
been:
The dog his master's voice did
it ween,
Yet half in doubt he opened the
door,
And ran out as he was wont of
yore.
No sooner was out, but, swifter
than thought,
Fast by the hide the wolf
Lowder caught;
And, had not Roffy run to the
steven,
Lowder had been slain thilk
same even.
HOB. God shield, man, he
should so ill have
thrive,
All for he did his devoir
belive.
If such be wolves, as thou hast
told,
How might we, Diggon, them
behold?



DIG. How, but, with heed and
watchfulness,
Forstallen them of their
wiliness:
Forthy with shepheard sits not
play,
Or sleep, as some doen, all the
long day;
But ever liggen in watch and
ward,
From sudden force their flocks
for to guard.
HOB. Ah! Diggon, thilk same
rule were too strait,
All the cold season to watch
and wait:
We be of flesh, men as other
be,
Why should we be bound to
such misery?
Whatever thing lacketh
changeable rest,
Must needs decay, when it is at
best.
DIG. Ah! but, Hobbinol, all
this long tale
Nought easeth the care that
doth me forhaile;
What shall I do? what way
shall I wend,
My piteous plight and loss to
amend?
Ah! good Hobbinol, might I
thee pray
Of aid or counsel in my decay?
HOB. Now by my soul,
Diggon, I lament



The hapless mischief that has
thee hent;
Natheless thou seest my lowly
sail,
That froward Fortune doth
ever availe:
But, were Hobbinol as God
might please,
Diggon should soon find
favour and ease:
But if to my cottage thou wilt
resort,
So as I can I will thee comfort;
There mayst thou lig in a
vetchy bed,
Till fairer Fortune shew forth
his head.
DIG. Ah! Hobbinol, God may
it thee requite;
Diggon on few such friends
did ever light.
DIGGON'S EMBLEME.
Inopem me copia fecit.
(Plenty has made me poor.)

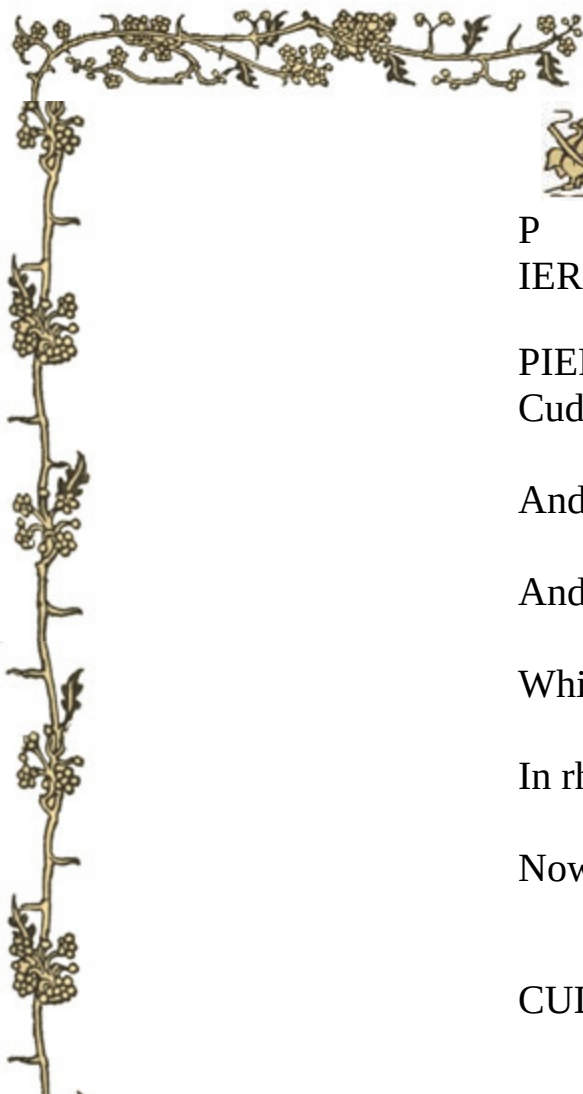


OCTOBER • AEGLOGA DECIMA



OCTOBER. ÆGLOGA DECIMA. ARGUMENT.

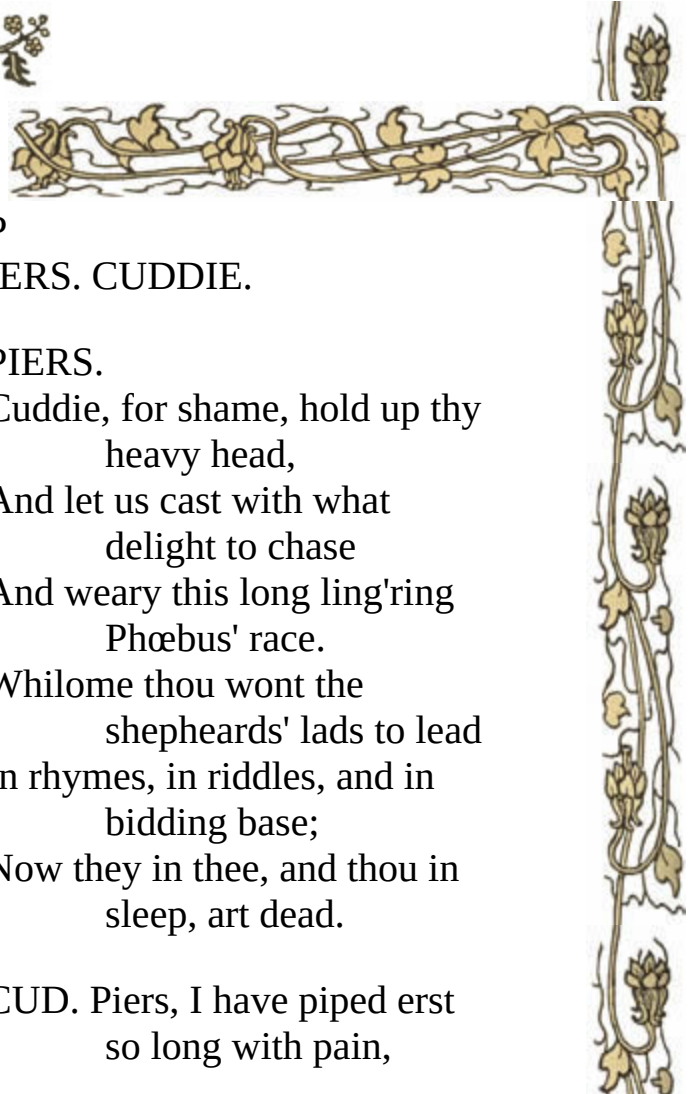
In Cuddie is set out the perfect pattern of a Poet, which, finding no maintenance of his state and studies, complaineth of the contempt of Poetry, and the causes thereof: specially having been in all ages, and even amongst the most barbarous, always of singular account and honour, and being indeed so worthy and commendable an art; or rather no art, but a divine gift and heavenly instinct not to be gotten by labour and learning, but adorned with both; and poured into the wit by a certain Enthousiasmos and celestial inspiration, as the Author hereof elsewhere at large discourseth in his book called *The English Poet*, which book being lately come to my hands, I mind also by God's grace, upon further advisement, to publish.



P
IERS. CUDDIE.

PIERS.
Cuddie, for shame, hold up thy
 heavy head,
And let us cast with what
 delight to chase
And weary this long ling'ring
 Phœbus' race.
Whilome thou wont the
 shepherds' lads to lead
In rhymes, in riddles, and in
 bidding base;
Now they in thee, and thou in
 sleep, art dead.

CUD. Piers, I have piped erst
 so long with pain,





That all mine oaten reeds be
rent and wore,
And my poor Muse hath spent
her spared store,
Yet little good hath got, and
much less gain.
Such pleasance makes the
grasshopper so poor,
And lig so laid, when winter
doth her strain.

The dapper ditties, that I wont
devise,
To feed youth's fancy, and the
flocking fry,
Delighten much; what I the
bett forthy?
They have the pleasure, I a
slender prise:
I beat the bush, the birds to
them do fly:
What good thereof to Cuddie
can arise?

PIERS. Cuddie, the praise is
better than the price,
The glory eke much greater
than the gain:
O what an honour is it, to
restrain
The lust of lawless youth with
good advice,
Or prick them forth with
pleasance of thy vein,
Whereto thou list their trained
wills entice!



Soon as thou 'ginn'st to set thy
notes in frame,
O how the rural routs to thee
do cleave!
Seemeth thou dost their soul of
sense bereave,
All as the shepherd that did
fetch his dame
From Pluto's baleful bower
withouten leave;
His music's might the hellish
hound did tame.

CUD. So praisen babes the
peacock's spotted train,
And wondren at bright Argus'
blazing eye;
But who rewards him e'er the
more forthy,
Or feeds him once the fuller by
a grain?
Such praise is smoke, that
sheddeth in the sky;
Such words be wind, and
wasten soon in vain.

PIERS. Abandon then the base
and viler clown;
Lift up thyself out of the lowly
dust,
And sing of bloody Mars, of
wars, of giusts;
Turn thee to those that wield
the awful crown,
To doubted knights, whose
woundless armour
rusts,





And helms unbruised waxen
daily brown.

There may thy Muse display
her flutt'ring wing,
And stretch herself at large
from east to west;
Whither thou list in fair
Elisa [16](#) rest,
Or, if thee please in bigger
notes to sing,
Advance the Worthy whom
she loveth best,
That first the White Bear to the
stake did bring.

And, when the stubborn stroke
of stronger stounds
Has somewhat slack'd the
tenor of thy string,
Of love and lustihead then
mayst thou sing,
And carol loud, and lead the
Miller's round,
All were Elisa one of thilk
same ring;
So might our Cuddie's name to
heaven sound.

CUD. Indeed the Romish
Tityrus, I hear,
Through his Mecænas left his
oaten reed,
Whereon he erst had taught his
flocks to feed,
And laboured lands to yield
the timely ear,





And eft did sing of wars and
deadly dreed
So as the heavens did quake
his verse to hear.

But ah! Mecænas is yclad in
clay,
And great Augustus long ago
is dead,
And all the worthies ligger
wrapt in lead,
That matter made for poets on
to play:
For ever, who in derring-do
were dread,
The lofty verse of them was
loved aye.

But after Virtue gan for age to
stoop,
And mighty Manhood brought
a bed of ease,
The vaunting poets found
nought worth a pease
To put in press among the
learned troop;
Then gan the streams of
flowing wits to cease,
And sunbright honour penn'd
in shameful coop.

And if that any buds of Poesy,
Yet of the old stock, gan to
shoot again,
Or it men's follies must to-
force to feign,





And roll with rest in rhymes of
 ribaudry;
Or, as it sprung, it wither must
 again;
Tom Piper makes us better
 melody.

PIERS. O peerless Po'sy!
 where is then thy
 place?
If nor in princes' palace thou
 dost sit,
(And yet is princes' palace the
 most fit,)
Ne breast of baser birth doth
 thee embrace,
Then make thee wings of thine
 aspiring wit,
And, whence thou cam'st, fly
 back to heaven apace.

CUD. Ah! Percy, it is all-to
 weak and wan,
So high to soar and make so
 large a flight;
Her pieced pinions be not so in
 plight:
For Colin fits such famous
 flight to scan;
He, were he not with love so
 ill bedight,
Would mount as high and sing
 as sweet as swan.

PIERS. Ah! fon; for Love does
 teach him climb so
 high,





And lifts him up out of the
loathsome mire;
Such immortal mirror, as he
doth admire,
Would raise one's mind above
the starry sky,
And cause a caitiff courage to
aspire;
For lofty love doth loathe a
lowly eye.

CUD. All otherwise the state
of Poet stands;
For lordly Love is such a
tyrant fell,
That, where he rules, all power
he doth expel;
The vaunted verse a vacant
head demands,
Ne wont with crabbed care the
Muses dwell:
Unwisely weaves, that takes
two webs in hand.

Who ever casts to compass
weighty prize,
And thinks to throw out
thund'ring words of
threat,
Let pour in lavish cups and
thrifty bits of meat,
For Bacchus' fruit is friend to
Phœbus wise;
And, when with wine the brain
begins to sweat,
The numbers flow as fast as
spring doth rise.



Thou kenst not, Percie, how
the rhyme should rage;
O if my temples were distain'd
with wine,
And girt in garlands of wild
ivy twine,
How I could rear the Muse on
stately stage,
And teach her tread aloft in
buskin fine,
With quaint Bellona in her
equipage!

But ah! my courage cools ere
it be warm:
Forthy content us in this
humble shade,
Where no such troublous tides
have us assay'd;
Here we our slender pipes may
safely charm.

PIERS. And, when my goats
shall have their bellies
laid,
Cuddie shall have a kid to
store his farm.

CUDDIE'S EMBLEME. [17](#)
Agitante calescimus illo, etc.

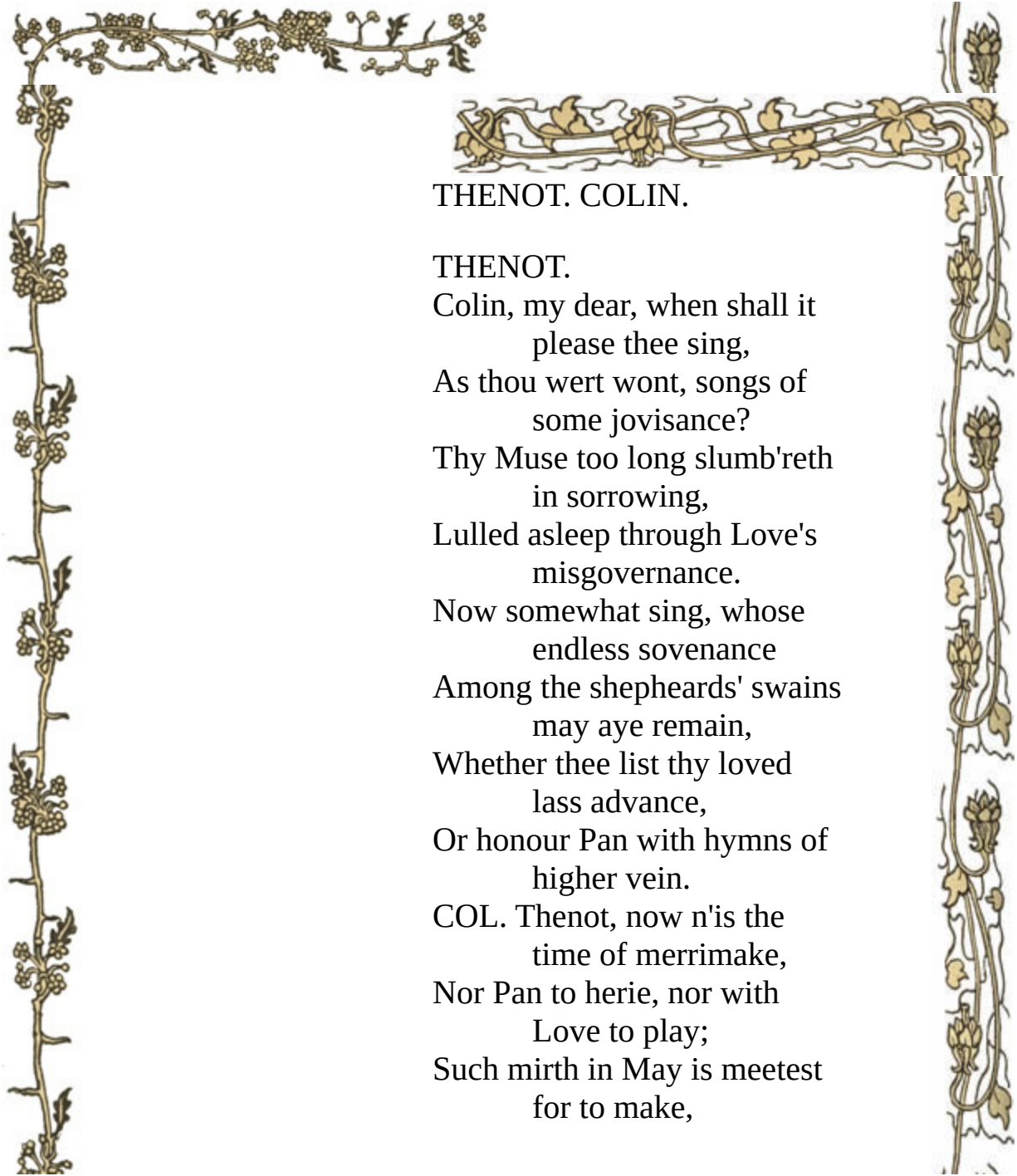


NOVEMBER · AEGLOGA UNDECIMA



NOVEMBER. ÆGLOGA UNDECIMA. ARGUMENT.

In this xi. Æglogue he bewaileth the death of some maiden of great blood, whom he calleth Dido. The personage is secret, and to me altogether unknown, albeit of himself I often required the same. This Æglogue is made in imitation of Marot his song, which he made upon the death of Loyes the French Queen; but far passing his reach, and in mine opinion all other the Æglogues of this Book.



THENOT. COLIN.

THENOT.

Colin, my dear, when shall it
 please thee sing,
As thou wert wont, songs of
 some jovisance?
Thy Muse too long slumb'reth
 in sorrowing,
Lulled asleep through Love's
 misgovernance.
Now somewhat sing, whose
 endless sovenance
Among the shepherds' swains
 may aye remain,
Whether thee list thy loved
 lass advance,
Or honour Pan with hymns of
 higher vein.

COL. Thenot, now n'is the
 time of merrimake,
Nor Pan to herie, nor with
 Love to play;
Such mirth in May is meetest
 for to make,



Or summer shade, under the
 cocked hay.
But now sad winter welked
 hath the day,
And Phœbus, weary of his
 yearly task,
Ystabled hath his steeds in
 lowly lay,
And taken up his inn in
 Fishes' [18](#) hask:
Thilk sullen season sadder
 plight doth ask,
And loatheth such delights as
 thou dost praise:
The mournful Muse in mirth
 now list ne mask,
As she was wont in youth and
 summer-days;
But if thou algate lust light
 virelays,
And looser songs of love to
 underfong,
Who but thyself deserves such
 poets' praise?
Relieve thy oaten pipes that
 sleepen long.
THE. The nightingale is
 sovereign of song,
Before him sits the titmouse
 silent be;
And I, unfit to thrust in skilful
 throng,
Should Colin make judge of
 my foolery.
Nay, better learn of them that
 learned be,





And have been watered at the
Muses' well;
The kindly dew drops from the
higher tree,
And wets the little plants that
lowly dwell:
But if sad winter's wrath, and
season chill,
Accord not with thy Muse's
merriment,
To sadder times thou mayst
attune thy quill,
And sing of sorrow and death's
dreariment;
For dead is Dido, ¹⁹ dead, alas!
and drent,
Dido! the great shepherd his
daughter sheen:
The fairest may she was that
ever went,
Her like she has not left
behind, I ween:
And, if thou wilt bewail my
woful teen,
I shall thee give yond cosset
for thy pain;
And, if thy rhymes as round
and rueful been
As those that did thy Rosalind
complain,
Much greater gifts for guerdon
thou shalt gain.
Than kid or cosset, which I
thee benempt:
Then up, I say, thou jolly
shepherd swain,





Let not my small demand be
so contempt.

COL. Thenot, to that I chose
thou dost me tempt;
But ah! too well I wot my
humble vein,
And how my rhymes be
rugged and unkempt;
Yet, as I con, my conning I
will strain.

"Up, then, Melpomene! the
mournful'st Muse of
Nine,
Such cause of mourning never
hadst afore;
Up, grisly ghosts! and up my
rueful rhyme!
Matter of mirth now shalt thou
have no more;
For dead she is, that mirth thee
made of yore.
Dido, my dear, alas! is dead,
Dead, and lieth wrapt in
lead.

O heavy herse!
Let streaming tears be poured
out in store;
O careful verse!

"Shepherds, that by your
flocks of Kentish
downs abide,
Wail ye this woful waste of
Nature's wark;
Wail we the wight, whose
presence was our pride;





Wail we the wight, whose
absence is our cark;
The sun of all the world is dim
and dark;
The earth now lacks her
wonted light,
And all we dwell in deadly
night.

O heavy herse!
Break we our pipes, that
shrill'd as loud as lark;
O careful verse!

"Why do we longer live, (ah!
why live we so long?)
Whose better days Death hath
shut up in woe?
The fairest flower our garland
all among
Is faded quite, and into dust
ygo.

Sing now, ye shepherds'
daughters, sing no moe
The songs that Colin made
you in her praise,
But into weeping turn your
wanton lays.

O heavy herse!
Now is time to die: nay, time
was long ago:
O careful verse!

"Whence is it, that the flowret
of the field doth fade,
And lieth buried long in
Winter's bale;





Yet, soon as Spring his mantle
hath display'd,
It flow'reth fresh, as it should
never fail?
But thing on earth that is of
most avail,
As virtue's branch and
beauty's bud,
Reliven not for any good.
O heavy herse!
The branch once dead, the bud
eke needs must quail;
O careful verse!

"She, while she was, (that was,
a woful word to sayn!)
For beauty's praise and
pleasance had no peer;
So well she couth the
shepheards entertain
With cakes and cracknels, and
such country cheer:
Ne would she scorn the simple
shepherd's swain;
For she would call him often
heme,
And give him curds and
clouted cream.
O heavy herse!
Als Colin Clout she would not
once disdain;
O careful verse!

"But now such happy cheer is
turn'd to heavy chance,
Such pleasance now displac'd
by dolor's dint;





All music sleeps, where Death
doth lead the dance,
And shepherds' wonted
solace is extinct.
The blue in black, the green in
gray, is tinct;
The gaudy garlands deck
her grave,
The faded flowers her corse
embrace.

O heavy herse!
Mourn now, my Muse, now
mourn with tears
besprint;
O careful verse!

"O thou great shepherd,
Lobbin, how great is
thy grief?
Where be the nosegays that
she dight for thee?
The coloured chaplets wrought
with a chief, [20](#)
The knotted rush-rings, and
gilt rosemary?
For she deemed nothing too
dear for thee.

Ah! they be all yclad in
clay;
One bitter blast blew all
away.

O heavy herse!
Thereof nought remains but
the memory;
O careful verse!





"Ah me! that dreary death
 should strike so mortal
 stroke,
That can undo Dame Nature's
 kindly course;
The faded locks fall from the
 lofty oak,
The floods do gasp, for dried is
 their source,
And floods of tears flow in
 their stead perforce:
 The mantled meadows
mourn,
 Their sundry colours turn.
 O heavy herse!
The heavens do melt in tears
 without remorse;
 O careful verse!

"The feeble flocks in field
 refuse their former
 food,
And hang their heads as they
 would learn to weep;
The beasts in forest wail as
 they were wood,
Except the wolves, that chase
 the wand'ring sheep,
Now she is gone that safely
 did them keep:
 The turtle on the bared
branch
 Laments the wound that
Death did launch.
 O heavy herse!
And Philomele her song with
 tears doth steep;





O careful verse!

"The water nymphs, that wont
with her to sing and
dance,
And for her garland olive
branches bear,
Now baleful boughs of cypress
do advance;
The Muses, that were wont
green bays to wear,
Now bringen bitter elder
branches sere;
The Fatal Sisters eke repent
Her vital thread so soon was
spent.

O heavy herse!
Mourn now, my Muse, now
mourn with heavy
cheer;
O careful verse!

"O trustless state of earthly
things, and slipper
hope
Of mortal men, that swink and
sweat for nought,
And, shooting wide, doth miss
the marked scope;
Now have I learn'd (a lesson
dearly bought)
That n'is on earth assurance to
be sought;
For what might be in earthly
mould,
That did her buried body
hold?





O heavy herse!
Yet saw I on the bier when it
was brought;
O careful verse!

"But maugre Death, and
dreaded Sisters' deadly
spite,
And gates of hell, and fiery
Furies' force,
She hath the bonds broke of
eternal night,
Her soul unbodied of the
burdenous corse.
Why then weeps Lobbin so
without remorse?

O Lobb! thy loss no longer
lament;

Dido is dead, but into
heaven hent.

O happy herse!
Cease now, my Muse, now
cease thy sorrows'
source,
O joyful verse!

"Why wail we then? why
weary we the gods with
plaints,

As if some evil were to her
betight?

She reigns a goddess now
among the saints,
That whilome was the saint of
shepherds light,
And is installed now in
heavens' height,





I see thee, blessed soul! I
see

Walk in Elysian fields so
free.

O happy herse!
Might I once come to thee, (O
that I might!)
O joyful verse!

"Unwise and wretched men, to
weet what's good or ill,
We deem of death as doom of
ill desert;
But knew we, fools, what it us
brings until,
Die would we daily, once it to
expert!
No danger there the shepherd
can assert;
air fields and pleasant lays
there bene;
The fields aye fresh, the
grass aye green.

O happy herse!
Make haste, ye shepherds,
thither to revert.
O joyful verse!

"Dido is gone afore; (whose
turn shall be the next?)
There lives she with the
blessed gods in bliss,
There drinks she nectar with
ambrosia mixt,
And joys enjoys that mortal
men do miss.



The honour now of highest
 gods she is,
That whilome was poor
shepherds' pride,
While here on earth she did
abide.

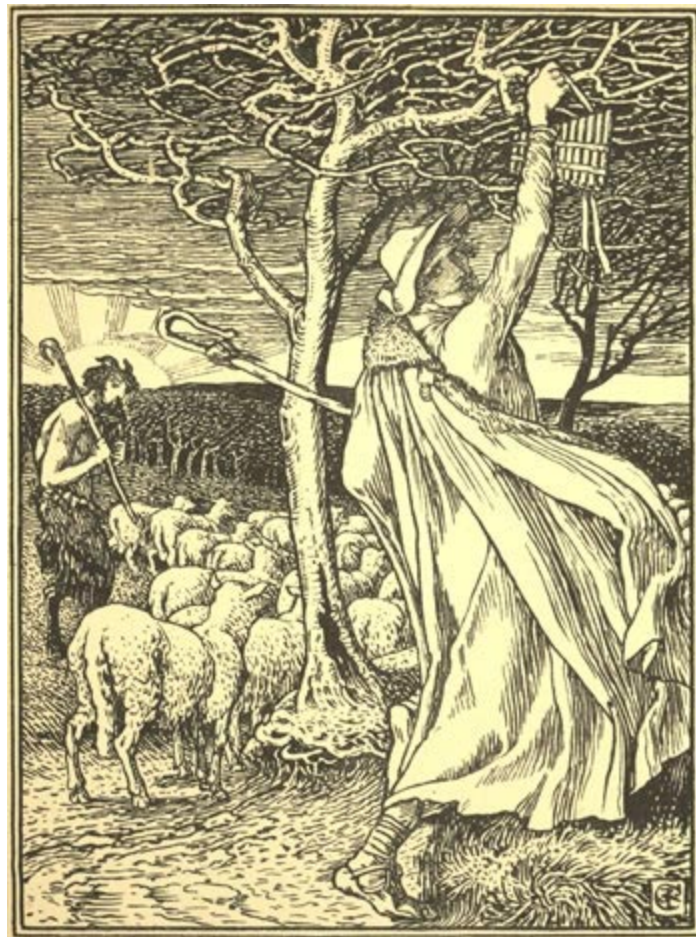
O happy herse!
Cease now, my song, my woe
 now wasted is;
O joyful verse!"

THE. Ay, frank shepherd,
 how be thy verses
 meint
With doleful pleasance, so as I
 ne wot
Whether rejoyce or weep for
 great constraint!
Thine be the cosset, well hast
 thou it got.
Up, Colin, up, enough thou
 mourned hast;
Now 'gins to mizzle, his we
 homeward fast.
COLIN'S EMBLEME.
La mort ny mord.
(Death has lost its sting.)



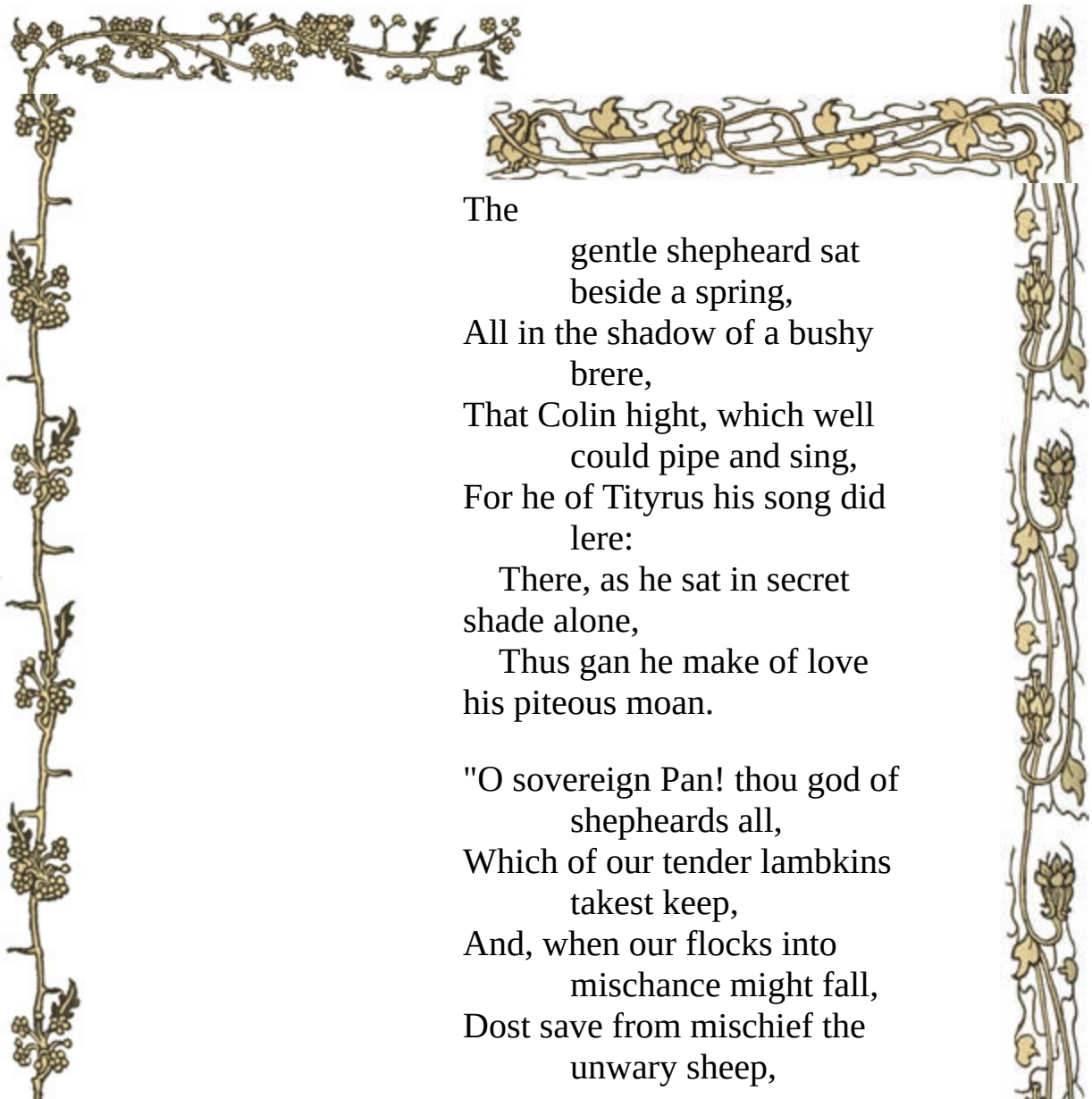


DECEMBER · AEGLOGA DUODECIMA



DECEMBER. ÆGLOGA DUODECIMA [21](#). ARGUMENT.

This Æglogue (even as the first began) is ended with a complaint of Colin to god Pan; wherein, as weary of his former ways, he proportioned his life to the four seasons of the year; comparing his youth to the spring time, when he was fresh and free from love's folly. His manhood to the summer, which, he saith, was consumed with great heat and excessive drouth, caused through a comet or blazing star, by which he meaneth love; which passion is commonly compared to such flames and immoderate heat. His ripest years he resembleth to an unseasonable harvest, wherein the fruits fall ere they be ripe. His latter age to winter's chill and frosty season, now drawing near to his last end.



The
gentle shepherd sat
beside a spring,
All in the shadow of a bushy
brere,
That Colin hight, which well
could pipe and sing,
For he of Tityrus his song did
lere:

There, as he sat in secret
shade alone,

Thus gan he make of love
his piteous moan.

"O sovereign Pan! thou god of
shepherds all,
Which of our tender lambkins
takest keep,
And, when our flocks into
mischance might fall,
Dost save from mischief the
unwary sheep,



Als of their masters hast no
less regard

Than of the flocks, which
thou dost watch and ward;

"I thee beseech (so be thou
deign to hear
Rude ditties, tun'd to
shepherd's oaten reed,
Or if I ever sonnet sung so
clear,
As it with pleasance might thy
fancy feed,)

Hearken a while, from thy
green cabinet,
The rural song of careful
Colinet.

"Whilome in youth, when
flower'd my joyful
spring,
Like swallow swift I wander'd
here and there;
For heat of heedless lust me so
did sting,
That I of doubted danger had
no fear:

I went the wasteful woods
and forest wide,
Withouten dread of wolves
to be espied.

"I wont to range amid the
mazy thicket,
And gather nuts to make my
Christmas-game,





And joyed oft to chase the
trembling pricket,
Or hunt the heartless hare till
she were tame.

What recked I of wintry
age's waste?—

Then deemed I my spring
would ever last.

"How often have I scaled the
craggy oak,
All to dislodge the raven of her
nest?

How have I wearied, with
many a stroke,
The stately walnut-tree, the
while the rest

Under the tree fell all for
nuts at strife?

For like to me was liberty
and life.

"And for I was in thilk same
looser years,

(Whether the Muse so wrought
me from my birth,

Or I too much believ'd my
shepherd peers,)

Somedele ybent to song and
music's mirth,

A good old shepheard,
Wrenock was his name,

Made me by art more
cunning in the same.

"Fro thence I durst in derring
to compare





With shepherd's swain
 whatever fed in field;
And, if that Hobbinol right
 judgment bare,
To Pan his own self pipe I
 need not yield:
 For, if the flocking nymphs
did follow Pan,
 The wiser Muses after Colin
ran.

"But, ah! such pride at length
 was ill repaid;
The shepherd's god (perdie,
 god was he none)
My hurtless pleasance did me
 ill upbraid,
My freedom lorn, my life he
 left to moan.

 Love they him called that
gave me check-mate,
 But better might they have
behote him Hate.

"Then gan my lovely spring
 bid me farewell,
And summer season sped him
 to display
(For Love then in the Lion's
 house did dwell,)
The raging fire that kindled at
 his ray.

 A comet stirr'd up that
unkindly heat,
 That reigned (as men said)
in Venus' seat.





"Forth was I led, not as I wont
 afore,
When choice I had to choose
 my wand'ring way,
But whether luck and love's
 unbridled lore
Would lead me forth on
 Fancy's bit to play:
 The bush my bed, the
bramble was my bower,
 The woods can witness
many a woful stowre.

"Where I was wont to seek the
 honey bee,
Working her formal rooms in
 waxen frame,
The grisly toadstool grown
 there might I see,
And loathed paddocks lording
 on the same:
 And, where the chanting
birds lull'd me asleep,
 The ghastly owl her
grievous inn doth keep.

"Then as the spring gives place
 to elder Time,
And bringeth forth the fruit of
 summer's pride;
All so my age, now passed
 youthly prime,
To things of riper season self
 applied,
 And learn'd of lighter timber
cotes to frame,





Such as might save my
sheep and me fro shame.

"To make fine cages for the
 nightingale,
And baskets of bulrushes, was
 my wont:

Who to entrap the fish in
 winding sale
Was better seen, or hurtful
 beasts to hont?

I learned als the signs of
heaven to ken,

How Phœbus fails, where
Venus sets, and when.

"And tried time yet taught me
 greater things;
The sudden rising of the raging
 seas,
The sooth of birds by beating
 of their wings,
The power of herbs, both
 which can hurt and
 ease,

And which be wont t' enrage
the restless sheep,

And which be wont to work
eternal sleep.

"But, ah! unwise and witless
 Colin Clout,
That kydst the hidden kinds of
 many a weed,
Yet kydst not one to cure thy
 sore heart-root,





Whose rankling wound as yet
does rifely bleed.

Why livest thou still, and
yet hast thy death's wound?

Why diest thou still, and yet
alive art found?

"Thus is my summer worn
away and wasted,
Thus is my harvest hastened
all-to rathe;
The ear that budded fair is
burnt and blasted,
And all my hoped gain is
turn'd to scathe.

Of all the seed, that in my
youth was sown,

Was none but brakes and
brambles to be mown.

"My boughs with blooms that
crowned were at first,
And promised of timely fruit
such store,
Are left both bare and barren
now at erst;
The flattering fruit is fallen to
ground before,
And rotted ere they were
half mellow ripe;

My harvest, waste, my hope
away did wipe.

"The fragrant flowers, that in
my garden grew,
Be withered, as they had been
gathered long:





Their roots be dried up for lack
of dew,
Yet dewed with tears they have
been ever among.

Ah! who has wrought my
Rosalind this spite,
To spoil the flowers that
should her garland dight?

"And I, that whilome wont to
frame my pipe
Unto the shifting of the
shepherd's foot,
Such follies now have
gathered as too ripe,
And cast them out as rotten
and unsoote.

The looser lass I cast to
please no more;
One if I please, enough is
me therefore.

"And thus of all my harvest-
hope I have
Nought reaped but a weedy
crop of care;
Which, when I thought have
thresh'd in swelling
sheave,
Cockle for corn, and chaff for
barley, bare:

Soon as the chaff should in
the fan be fin'd,
All was blown away of the
wavering wind.





"So now my year draws to his
latter term,
My spring is spent, my
summer burnt up quite;
My harvest hastes to stir up
Winter stern,
And bids him claim with
rigorous rage his right:
So now he storms with
many a sturdy stour;
So now his blust'ring blast
each coast doth scour.

"The careful cold hath nipt my
rugged rind,
And in my face deep furrows
eld hath pight:
My head besprent with hoary
frost I find,
And by mine eye the crow his
claw doth write:
Delight is laid abed; and
pleasure past;
No sun now shines; clouds
have all overcast.

"Now leave, ye shepherds'
boys, your merry glee;
My Muse is hoarse and weary
of this stound:
Here will I hang my pipe upon
this tree,
Was never pipe of reed did
better sound:
Winter is come that blows
the bitter blast,





And after winter dreary
death does hast.

"Gather together, ye my little
flock,
My little flock, that was to me
so lief;
Let me, ah! let me in your
folds ye lock,
Ere the breme winter breed
you greater grief.

Winter is come, that blows
the baleful breath,

And after winter cometh
timely death.

"Adieu, delights, that lulled me
asleep;

Adieu, my dear, whose love I
bought so dear;

Adieu, my little lambs and
loved sheep;

Adieu, ye woods, that oft my
witness were:

Adieu, good Hobbinol, that
was so true,

Tell Rosalind, her Colin bids
her adieu."

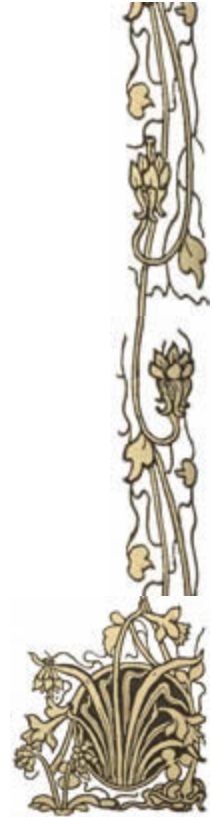


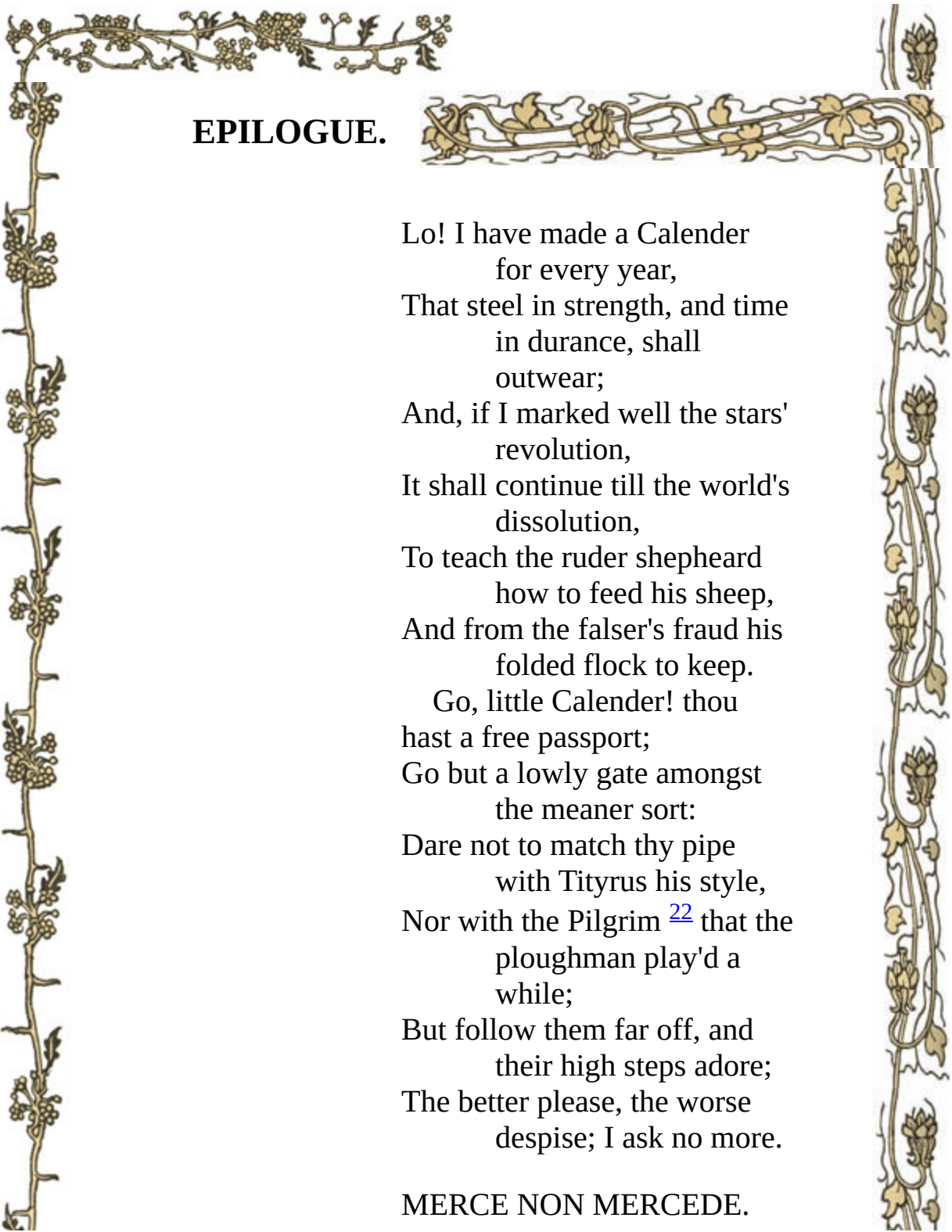


COLIN'S EMBLEME.

*Vivitur ingenio: cætera mortis
erunt.*

(The creations of genius live;
other things shall be the prey
of death.)





EPILOGUE.

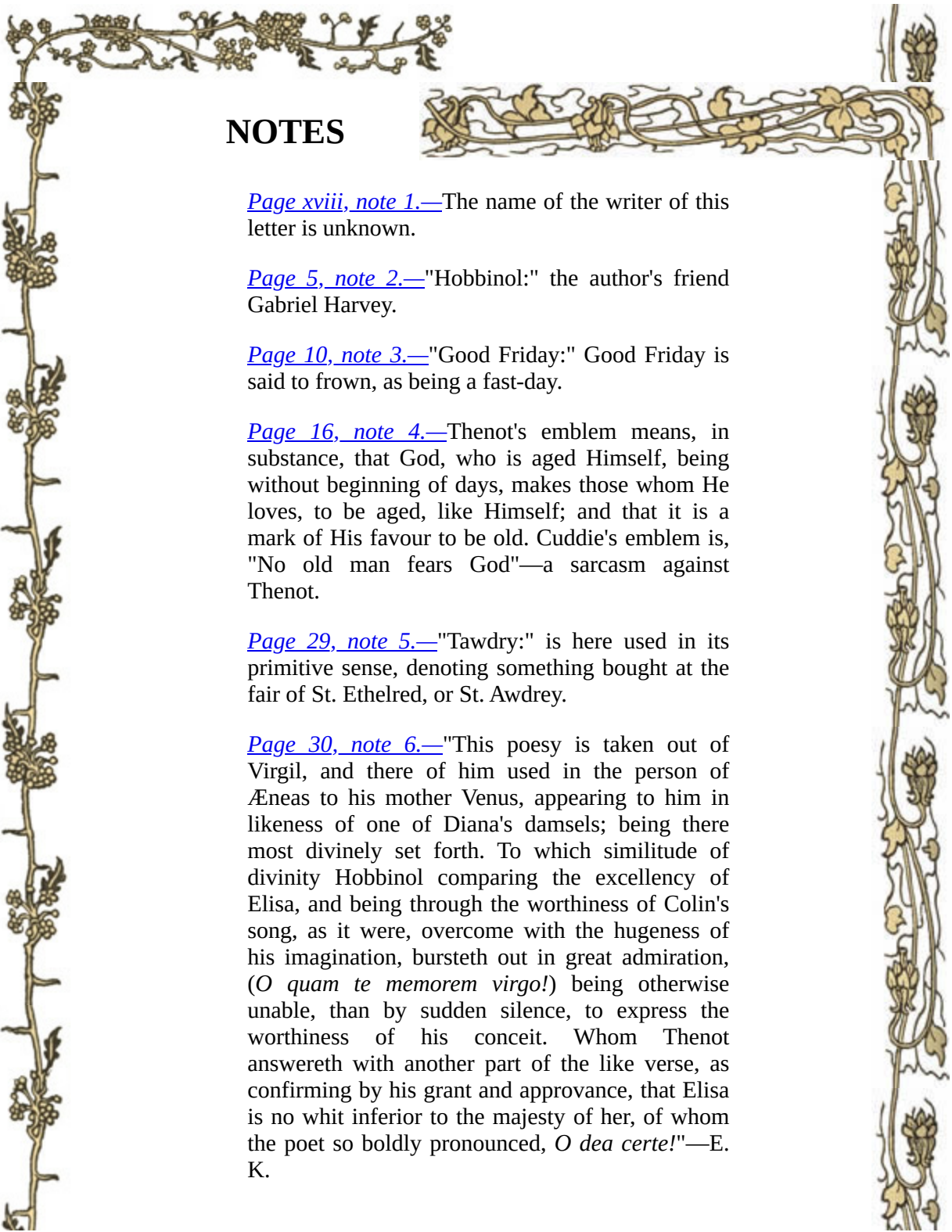
Lo! I have made a Calender
for every year,
That steel in strength, and time
in durance, shall
outwear;
And, if I marked well the stars'
revolution,
It shall continue till the world's
dissolution,
To teach the ruder shepheard
how to feed his sheep,
And from the falser's fraud his
folded flock to keep.
Go, little Calender! thou
hast a free passport;
Go but a lowly gate amongst
the meaner sort:
Dare not to match thy pipe
with Tityrus his style,
Nor with the Pilgrim [22](#) that the
ploughman play'd a
while;
But follow them far off, and
their high steps adore;
The better please, the worse
despise; I ask no more.

MERCE NON MERCEDE.



(For recompense, but not for
hire.)





NOTES

Page xviii, note 1.—The name of the writer of this letter is unknown.

Page 5, note 2.—"Hobbinol:" the author's friend Gabriel Harvey.

Page 10, note 3.—"Good Friday:" Good Friday is said to frown, as being a fast-day.

Page 16, note 4.—Thenot's emblem means, in substance, that God, who is aged Himself, being without beginning of days, makes those whom He loves, to be aged, like Himself; and that it is a mark of His favour to be old. Cuddie's emblem is, "No old man fears God"—a sarcasm against Thenot.

Page 29, note 5.—"Tawdry:" is here used in its primitive sense, denoting something bought at the fair of St. Ethelred, or St. Awdrey.

Page 30, note 6.—"This poesy is taken out of Virgil, and there of him used in the person of Æneas to his mother Venus, appearing to him in likeness of one of Diana's damsels; being there most divinely set forth. To which similitude of divinity Hobbinol comparing the excellency of Elisa, and being through the worthiness of Colin's song, as it were, overcome with the hugeness of his imagination, bursteth out in great admiration, (*O quam te memorem virgo!*) being otherwise unable, than by sudden silence, to express the worthiness of his conceit. Whom Thenot answereth with another part of the like verse, as confirming by his grant and approvance, that Elisa is no whit inferior to the majesty of her, of whom the poet so boldly pronounced, *O dea certe!*"—E. K.



[Page 35, note 7.](#)—"Algrind:" Archbishop Grindall.

[Page 37, note 8.](#)—"Fox," "Kid:" "By the Kid may be understood the simple sort of the faithful and true Christians; by his dam, Christ, that hath already with careful watchwords (as here doth the Goat) warned her little ones to beware of such doubling deceit; by the Fox, the false and faithless Papists, to whom is no credit to be given, nor fellowship to be used."—E. K.

[Page 41, note 9.](#)—"Sir John:" a name applied to a Popish priest.

[Page 47, note 10.](#)—"Tityrus:" Chaucer is meant.

[Page 53, note 11.](#)—"Morrell:" supposed to be Elmer, or Aylmer, Bishop of London.

[Page 53, note 12.](#)—"The sun:" the sun enters Leo in July.

[Page 59, note 13.](#)—"An eagle:" the same story is told of the death of Eschylus.

[Pages 68, 69, note 14.](#)—"The meaning hereof is very ambiguous: for Perigot by his posy claiming the conquest, and Willie not yielding, Cuddie the arbiter of their cause, and patron of his own, seemeth to challenge it, as his due, saying, that he is happy which can; so abruptly ending; but he meaneth either him, that can win the best, or moderate himself being best, and leave off with the best."—E. K.

[Page 77, note 15.](#)—"Saxon king:" King Edgar, in whose reign wolves are said to have disappeared in England.

[Page 84, note 16.](#)—"Elisa:" Queen Elizabeth; the "Worthy" is the Earl of Leicester.

[Page 87, note 17.](#)—This emblem is portion of a Latin verse, expressing the thought of the pastoral, that poetry is a fervid glow of inspiration which animates and kindles.

[Page 91, note 18.](#)—"Fishes:" the sun enters the constellation Pisces in November.

[Page 92, note 19.](#)—"Dido" and "great shepherd" both refer to real persons unknown.



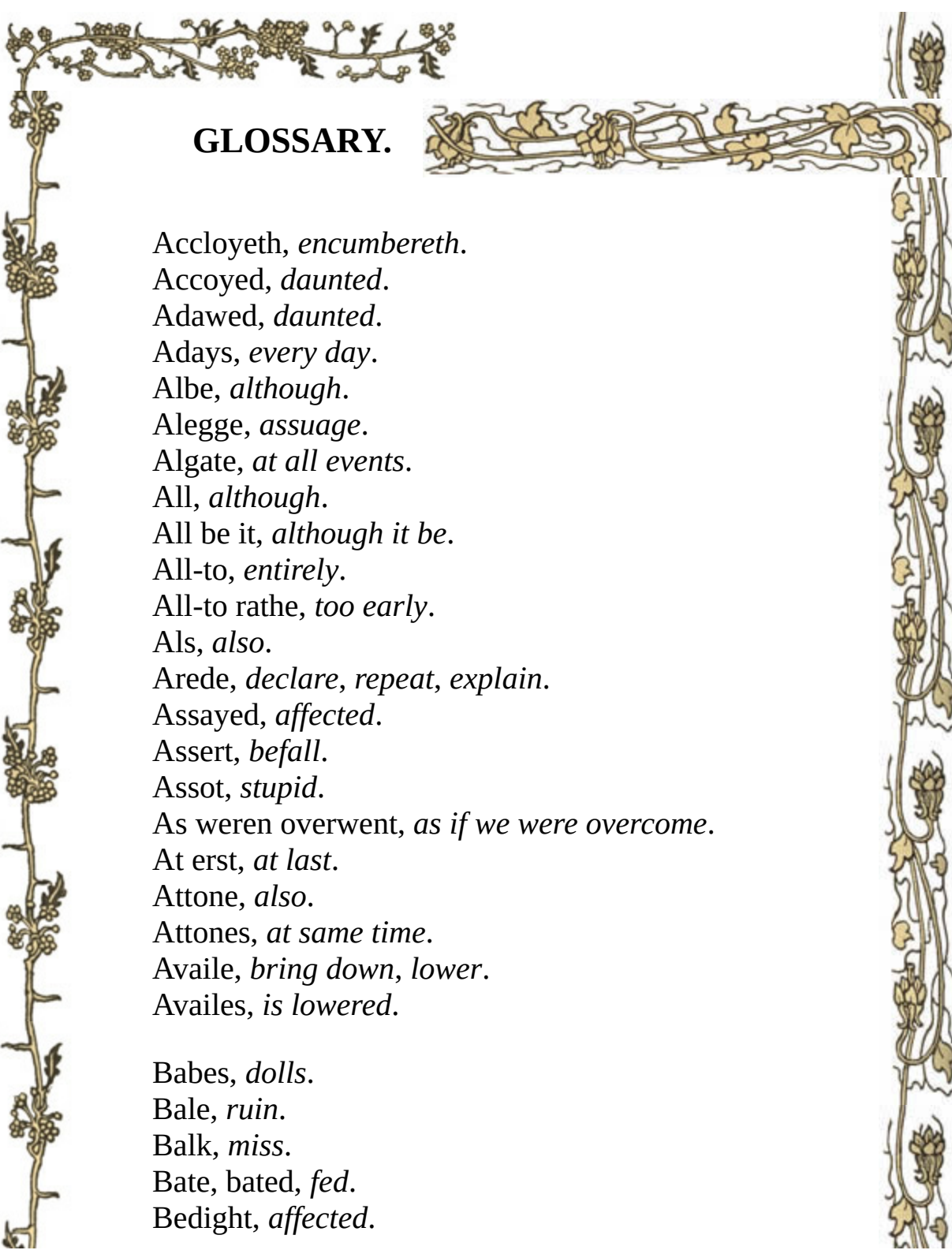


[Page 94, note 20.](#)—"Wrought with a chief:" wrought into a head, like a nosegay.

[Page 101, note 21.](#)—Translated freely from the French of Marot.

[Page 107, note 22.](#)—"The pilgrim:" perhaps the author of the "Visions of Pierce Ploughman."





GLOSSARY.

Accloyeth, *encumbereth*.
Accoyed, *daunted*.
Adawed, *daunted*.
Adays, *every day*.
Albe, *although*.
Alegge, *assuage*.
Algate, *at all events*.
All, *although*.
All be it, *although it be*.
All-to, *entirely*.
All-to rathe, *too early*.
Als, *also*.
Arede, *declare, repeat, explain*.
Assayed, *affected*.
Assert, *befall*.
Assot, *stupid*.
As weren overwent, *as if we were overcome*.
At erst, *at last*.
Attone, *also*.
Attones, *at same time*.
Availe, *bring down, lower*.
Availes, *is lowered*.

Babes, *dolls*.
Bale, *ruin*.
Balk, *miss*.
Bate, bated, *fed*.
Bedight, *affected*.



Behight, behote, *called*.
Belive, *promptly*.
Bellibone (*belle et bonne*), *good and beautiful one*.
Bend, *band*.
Bene, *are*.
Benempt, *named, mentioned*.
Bent, *obedient*.
Besprint, besprent, *besprinkled*.
Betight, *betide, happened*.
Bett, *better*.
Bidding base, *game of prison base*.
Biggen, *cap*.
Bin, *be*.
Black bower, *i.e., hell*.
Bloncket liveries, *gray coats*.
Blont, *unpolished*.
Borrell, *rustic*.
Borrow, *pledge, surety, Saviour*.
Brace, *compass*.
Brag, bragly, *proudly*.
Breme, *sharp*.
Brent, *burnt*.
Brere, *brier*.
Brochage, *pimping*.
Bugle, *beads*.
But, *unless*.
Buxom, *yielding*.

Can, *knows*.
Careful, *sorrowful*.
Careful case, *unhappy condition*.
Cark, *sorrow*.
Chaffred, *sold or exchanged*.
Chamfred, *wrinkled*.
Charm, *temper, tune*.
Chevisance, *performance, result, bargain*.
Chips, *fragments*.





Collusion, *cunning*.
Con, *know*.
Cond, *learned*.
Confusion, *destruction*.
Contempt, *contemned*.
Convenable, *conformable*.
Corb, *crooked*.
Cosset, *lamb*.
Cote, *sheepfold*.
Courage, *mind*.
Couth, *knew how, could*.
Cracknels, *biscuits*.
Crag, *neck*.
Crank, *courageous*.
Crumenall, *purse*.

Dapper ditties, *pretty songs*.
Deed, *doing, composing*.
Defast, *defaced*.
Dempt, *deemed*.
Depeincten, *painted*.
Derring, *manly deeds*.
Derring-do, *daring deeds*.
Devoir, *duty*.
Dight, *adorn, prepare; adorned, prepared, dealt with*.
Dint, *pang of grief*.
Dirk, *darkly*.
Dirks, *darkens*.
Disease, *disturb*.
Dole, dool, *sorrow, grief*.
Doom, *judgment*.
Doubted, *redoubted*.
Drent, *drowned, perished*.

Eath, *easy*.
Eft, *quickly, soon*.



Eftsoons, *immediately*.

Eked, *increased*.

Eld, *age*.

Embrave, *adorn*.

Emprise, *enterprise*.

Enaunter, *lest, lest that*.

Enchased, *engraved*.

Encheason, *occasion*.

Entrailed, *intwined*.

Erst, *before, at once*.

Expert, *experience*.

Faitours, *villains, vagabonds*.

Falsers, *deceivers*.

Fay, *faith*.

File, *defile*.

Fined, *sifted*.

Fon, *fool*.

Fond, *foolish*.

Fondness, *folly*.

Fonly, *foolishly*.

Foresaid, *banished*.

Foreslow, *impede, obstruct*.

Forestall, *prevent*.

Forhaile, *distress*.

For-say, *forsake*.

Forswat, *spent with heat*.

Forswonk, *overlaboured*.

Forthy, *therefore, on that account*.

Frenne, *stranger*.

Frome, *frozen*.

Frowy, *musty*.

Galage, *wooden shoe*.

Gang, *go*.

Gars, *makes*.

Gastful, *dreary*.





Gate, way.
Gelt, *a gilded girdle*.
Giant, *Atlas*.
Giusts, *tournaments*.
Go, *gone*.
Gree, *degree*.
Greet, *weep; mourning*.
Gride, *gryde, pierced*.
Gross, *whole*.

Harbrough, *habitation*.
Hask, *basket*.
Haveour, *demeanour*.
Heme, *home*.
Hent, *took, taken*.
Hentst, *takest*.
Herdgrooms, *herdsmen*.
Herie, *hery, honour, praise*.
Herse, *rehearsal, tale*.
Heydeguyes, *dances*.
Hidder and shidder, *him and her*.
Hight, *purports; was named*.
Hote, *mentioned; was called*.

If, *unless*.
Ilk, *the same*.
Inly, *inwardly*.
Inn, *abode*.

Jovisance, *joyousness*.

Keep, *care, charge*.
Ken, *know*.
Kend, *known*.
Kenst, *knowest*.
Kerns, *farmers*.
Kirk, *church*.
Knack, *trick*.





Knaves, *servants*.
Kydst, *knowest*.

Laid, *faint*.
Larded, *fattened*.
Latched, *caught*.
Lays, *leas, fields*.
Leasing, *falsehood, lies*.
Lere, *lore, lesson; learn*.
Lever, *rather*.
Levin, *lightning*.
Lewd, *foolish*.
Lewdly, *foolishly*.
Lief, *dear, beloved*.
Lig, *ligg, liggen, lie*.
Loord, *fellow*.
Lope, *leaped*.
Lorn, *left, lost*.
Lorrell, *ignorant, worthless fellow*.
Louted, *did honour*.
Lust, *wishest*.
Lustihed, *pleasure*.
Lustless, *languid*.

Maintenance, *behaviour*.
Make, *versify*.
Maugre, *in spite of*.
May, *maid*.
May-busquets, *May-bushes*.
Mazer, *bowl*.
Medle, *mingle*.
Meint, *mingled*.
Melling, *meddling*.
Men of the lay, *laymen*.
Ment, *mingled*.
Merciable, *merciful*.
Mickle, *much*.





Miller's round, *a dance*.
Mirk, *very obscure*.
Miscreance, *unbelief*.
Misgone, *gone astray*.
Missay, *say evil*.
Mister men, *kind of men*.
Mister saying, *kind of speech*.
Miswent, *gone astray*.
Mizzle, *to rain a little*.
Mochell, *much*.
Moe, *more*.
Most what, *affairs*.
Most-what, *for the most part*.
Musical, *music*.

Narre, *nearer*.
N'as, *has not*.
Newell, *novelty*.
Nighly, *nearly so much*.
Nill, *will not*.
N'is, *is not*.
N'ote, *know not*.
Nought seemeth, *is unseemly*.
Nould, *would not*.

Overcrowded, *overcrowded*.
Overgone, *surpassed*.
Overhale, *draw over*.
Overture, *open place*.

Paddocks, *toads*.
Pained, *exerted himself*.
Paramours, *lovers*.
Paunce, *pansy*.
Perdie, *in truth, truly*.
Peregall, *equal*.
Perk, *pert*.





Pert, *open*.
Pieced, *imperfect*.
Pight, *put, placed*.
Plainful, *lamentable*.
Prick, *mark*.
Pricket, *buck*.
Prief, *proof*.
Prime, *spring*.
Primrose, *chief flower*.
Pumie, *pumice*.
Purchase, *obtain*.
Purpose, *conversation*.

Quaint, *strange*.
Quell, *abate*.
Queme, *please*.
Quick, *alive*.
Quit, *deliver*.

Rathe, *early*.
Rather, *born early*.
Record, *repeat*.
Rede, *saying; advise, tell*.
Reliven, *live again*.
Ribaudry, *ribaldry*.
Rife, *frequent*.
Rifely, *abundantly*.
Rine, *rind*.
Romish Tityrus, *Virgil*.
Ronts, *young bullocks*.
Roundel, *roundelay*.
Routs, *companies*.
Roved, *shot*.

Sale, *wicker net*.
Sam, *together*.
Sample, *example*.





Saye, *silk*.
Scope, *mark aimed at*.
Seely, *simple*.
Sheen, *bright*.
Shend, *disgrace*.
Shepherd, Abel, p. 56; Endymion, p. 55; Orpheus, p. 84; Paris, p. 57.
Shield, *forbid*.
Sib, *related*.
Sich, *such*.
Sicker, siker, *surely, truly*.
Sike, *such*.
Site, *situation*.
Sithence, sithens, *since, since that time*.
Siths, *times*.
Sits, *becomes*.
Sits not, *is not becoming*.
Skill in making, *in writing poetry*.
Slipper, *slippery, uncertain*.
Smirk, *nice*.
Snebbe, *revile*.
Somdele, *somewhat, in some degree*.
Some quick, *something alive*.
Sommed, *feathered*.
Soote, *sweetly*.
Sooth, *soothsaying*.
Sops-in-wine, *a flower*.
Sovenance, *remembrance*.
So well the wed, *of such sound morals*.
Sperr, *shut*.
Spill, *spoil, ruin, injure*.
Stank, *weary*.
State, *stoutly*.
Steven, *noise*.
Stound, *effort; hour*.
Stounds, *pains; occasions*.
Stour, *assault*.



Stoure, *occasion*.
Stoures, *attacks*.
Stowre, *affliction, violence*.
Strain, *imbody in strains*.
Strait, *strict*.
Strow, *display*.
Stud, *trunk*.
Sullen, *sad*.
Surquedry, *pride*.
Swink, *toil*.

Tabrere, *taborer*.
Teen, *sorrow*.
That, *that which*.
Thereto, *also*.
Thick, *thicket*.
Thilk, *this, these, this same, that same*.
Tickle, *uncertain*.
Tinct, *coloured*.
Tityrus, *Chaucer*.
Tod, *thick bush*.
To-force, *perforce*.
Tooting, *looking about*.
Totty, *wavering*.
Trace, *go*.
Trains, *snares*.
Trode, troad, *tread, path*.
Truss, *bundle*.
Tway, *two*.

Uncouth, *unknown*.
Underfong, *tamper with, undertake*.
Undersay, *say in contradiction*.
Uneath, *scarcely*.
Unkempt, *unpolished*.
Unkent, *unknown*.
Unlustiness, *feebleness*.





Unnethes, *scarcely*.

Unsoot, *unsweet*.

Uprist, *uprisen*.

Utter, *put forth*.

Venteth, *snuffeth*.

Vetchy, *of pease straw*.

Virelays, *songs*.

War, *worse*.

Warre, *ware*.

Weanel wast, *weaned youngling*.

Weed, *dress*.

Weet, *know*.

Weighed, *esteemed*.

Weld, *wield, bear*.

Welked, *decreased, shortened*.

Well apaid, *in good condition*.

Wellaway, *alas!*

Wend, *go*.

What, *matter, thing*.

What is he for a lad? *what sort of lad is he?*

Whilome, *formerly*.

Widder, *wider*.

Wight, *active*.

Wightly, *quickly*.

Wimble, *nimble*.

Wisards, *learned men*.

Wist, *knew*.

Witen, *blame*.

Wonned, *dwelt*.

Wood, *mad, wild*.

Worthy wite, *deserved blame*.

Wot, wote, *know*.

Wot ne, *know not*.

Woundless, *unwounded*.



Wrack, *violence*.
Wroken, *avenged*.

Yblent, *blinded*.
Yconned, *conned*.
Yede, *go, went*.
Yeven, *given*.
Yfere, *together*.
Ygo, ygoe, *gone*.
Yode, *went*.
Yond, *yonder*.
Ypent, *pent, confined*.
Yshend, *disparage*.
Ytake, *taken, overcome*.
Ytost, *be harassed*.
Ywis, *truly*.



Transcriber's Notes:

Variations in spelling, punctuation and hyphenation have been retained except in obvious cases of typographical error:

"puo" has been changed to "può"

"anchora" has been changed to "ancora"

"AEGLOGA" has been changed to "ÆGLOGA"

Emblem images have been moved to end of chapters.

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